/

Bhaktivaibhava Course

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam Cantos 1-3

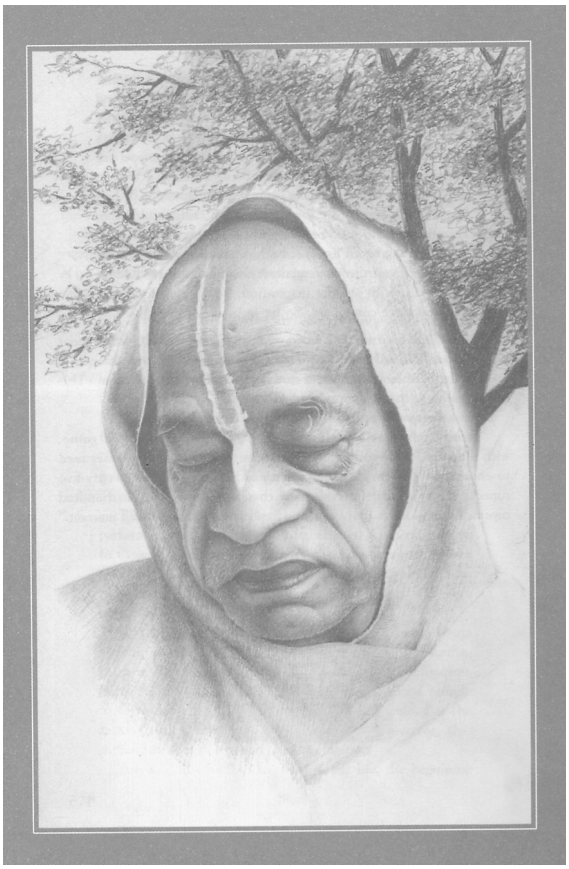
Student Handbook

UTTARA-KHAṆḌA ĀDHYĀYANAM

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness
Founder-Ācārya: His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda

DEDICATION

oṁ ajñāna-timirāndhasya jñānāñjana-śalākayā
cakṣur unmīlitaṁ yena tasmai śrī-gurave namaḥ
nama oṁ viṣṇu-pādāya kṛṣṇa-preṣṭhāya bhū-tale
śrīmate bhaktivedānta-svāmin iti nāmine
namas te sārasvate deve gaura-vāṇī-pracāriṇe
nirviśeṣa-śūnyavādi-pāścātya-deśa-tāriṇe



"If you study Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam perfectly, then all your education is complete. You don't require any other book to read; you get from Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam all material and spiritual knowledge, and at the end, Kṛṣṇa. This is the profit."

Śrīla Prabhupāda, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam Lecture 2.3.22 Los Angeles, June 19, 1972

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INTRODUCTION
UTTARA-KHANDA ĀDHYĀYANAM

The curriculum of the Bhaktivaibhava Course is divided into week long units dealing with respective subjects of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. Each unit consists of 5 lessons of approximately 2 -2.5 hours duration each. The 5 core lessons for each unit are delivered utilizing participatory style exercises to help the students achieve the selected aims & objectives of each lesson. In addition to these 5 lessons, there may be one additional lecture, per unit, given by an invited guest speaker.

Student Materials

During the Ādhyāyanam you will require the following:

- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam Cantos 1-3
- Students Handbook
- Śrīla Prabhupāda Quotes Book

How to use this Student Handbook

This is your handbook for the Uttara-khanda Ādhyāyanam. At the beginning of each Unit you will find the Scheduled Reading Assignments for that Unit. These assignments must be completed before each lesson. Pūrva-svādhyāya (Preliminary Self Study) and Adhyāya-kathā-sāra (Chapter Overview) will be referred to during the lessons. The Paṭhana-prayojanam (educational goals or learning objectives) for each unit are what we are aiming to achieve by the end of each Unit.

Optional Materilas:

You may find the following additional study guides helpful:

- Unveiling His Lotus Feet - Bhūrijana Dāsa
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam At a Glance - Narayani Devi Dasi.
- Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam Condensed – Pūrṇaprajña Dāsa
- Bhagavatam Subodhini- Gauranga Darshan Das

UNIT 1 (PREFACE – 1.3.39)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 1.1.1; 5-8; 10-11
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for 1.1.1
Additional Questions:

1. Explain the relationship between Absolute and relative truths, with reference to the Sanskrit in 1.1.1 & analogies from 1.1.1 purport.
2. List the qualities of a representative of Vyāsadeva. (5-8)
3. List points from the sages analysis of the people in this age of Kali (10)

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 1.1.2; 1.2.1-5
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for 1.1.2.
Overview of 6 questions of the sages & Sūta Goswāmī's respective responses
Additional Questions:

1. Analyze the distinction between real and pretentious religion with reference to the Sanskrit in 1.1.2
2. List examples of cheating religion.

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 1.2.6-11
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya for Chapter 2 questions 1-3
Additional Questions:

1. Present the standard of first class, transcendental religion with reference to 1.2.6
2. Choose verses or parts of the purports in this section, 2.6-11, which you consider most useful in preaching. Explain why and discuss.

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 1.2.23-29; 1.3.1-5; 1.3.28.
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 3 questions 1-4
Additional Questions:

1. List arguments refuting worship of the demigods. (2.23-29)
2. Explain why Śrī Kṛṣṇa is bhagavān svayam. (28)

Lesson 5

Specific texts: Preface 1.1.4; 1.1.16; 1.2.5; 1.2.12-22;
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for 1.1.3 & Chapter 2 questions 4-10
Additional Questions:

1. Explain the role Prabhupāda's Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam plays in his mission. Preface; 1.1.4, 1.1.16; 1.2.5.
2. Identify one verse/passage etc., from 1.2.12-22, that speaks to you directly (i.e. seems just relevant to you, and your current situation, challenges, etc). Write down one thing you could do based on this to improve your spiritual life.

QUESTIONS BY THE SAGES (1.1.1-3)

Pūrva-svādhyāya (Preliminary Self Study)

1.1.1

1. What is the most confidential part of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam?
2. Explain why Śrīla Vyāsadeva purposely invokes a Gāyatrī mantra, dhīmahi.
3. Why does there appear to be reality in the material world?
4. Why are the words abhijñaḥ and svarāṭ significant?
5. Explain how the impersonalist philosophers have given indirect impetus to the abominable mundane sex life.

1.1.2.

6. Religion includes which four primary subjects?
7. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam can only be understood by whom?
8. What is the translation of the phrase '*vāstavam atra vastu śivadaṁ*'?
9. Explain the significance of the statement, "mahā-muni-kṛte kiṁ vā parair"

1.1.3.

10. Explain why Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is described as the ripened fruit of all Vedic knowledge?
11. Why is Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī compared to the parrot?

Analogies:

1.1.1: The modern scientist, for example, has created space satellites, and by some arrangement or other, these satellites are thrown into outer space to fly for some time at the control of the scientist who is far away. Similarly, all the universes with innumerable stars and planets are controlled by the intelligence of the Personality of Godhead.

1.1.1: In the desert mirage there is no actual water. There is only the appearance of water. Real water is somewhere else. The manifested cosmic creation appears as reality. But reality, of which this is but a shadow, is in the spiritual world. Absolute Truth is in the spiritual sky, not the material sky.

1.1.1: The chief engineer of a complicated construction does not personally take part in the construction, but he knows every nook and corner because everything is done under his direction. He knows everything about the construction, both directly and indirectly. Similarly, the Personality of Godhead, who is the supreme engineer of this cosmic creation, knows every nook and corner, although affairs are being carried out by demigods.

1.1.1: He is compared to a mine of gold, and the cosmic creations in so many different forms are compared to objects made from the gold, such as gold rings, necklaces and so on. The gold ring and the gold necklace are qualitatively one with the gold in the mine, but quantitatively the gold in the mine is different.

1.1 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA (CHAPTER OVERVIEW)

Verses 1-3

Prelude: The subject, glories and goal of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.

Śrīla Vyāsadeva offers his obeisances to Lord Sri Krsna, the Absolute Truth, and immediately glorifies the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam as completely pure, free from materially motivated activities, and especially nectarean, having emanated from the lips of Sri Śukadeva Gosvāmī.

Verses 4-8

Once, in the forest of Naimiṣāraṇya, great sages assembled to perform a great thousand-year sacrifice for the satisfaction of the Lord and His devotees. One day after offering a seat of esteem to Śrīla Sūta Gosvāmī, the sages enumerated Sūta Gosvāmī's qualifications to speak.

They particularly appreciated Sūta Gosvāmī's character, which was completely free from all vice, and his learning, as he was well versed in all the scriptures. Also because he was submissive, his spiritual masters had endowed him with all the favors bestowed upon a gentle disciple. The great sages then made inquiries, with great respect, about the following matters.

Verses 9-23

The Questions of the sages: What is the ultimate good, and the essence of all scriptures (11)? They glorify hearing about the Lord and request Sūta Gosvāmī to speak to them about the Lord (12) and His incarnations, in both the process of creation (13), and in other pastimes (17) After Sūta Gosvāmī describes that the Age of Kali has just begun, the sages ask a final question: "Now that Sri Krsna, the Absolute Truth, has departed for His abode, please tell us by whom religious principles are presently protected." (23)

Discussion Topics

(Und) The prelude to Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1-3)
Vasudeva is the symbol of the transcendental position (12)
The 6 Questions of the sages of Naimisaranya (9-23)

(PeA) The importance of acquiring brahminical qualities for understanding Bhāgavatam (1)
Relishing Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (3)
Qualities of a representative of Vyāsa (5-8.)
The importance of honoring saintly devotees and avoiding offending them. (15)

(PrA) The authority of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1)
The distinction between real and pretentious religion (2)
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam as the ripened fruit of the Vedas (3)

(AMI) Nirmatsarāṇāṁ (2)

(M&M) The role of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam in Prabhupāda's mission. (Preface, 4, 16)

(SC) The standard of the people in this age of Kali (10-11)
Slaughterhouses of so-called education (22)

1.1 QUESTIONS BY THE SAGES (1.1.4-23)

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List the qualities of a representative of Vyāsadeva. (5-8)
2. Spiritual wellbeing is automatically followed by what? (9)
3. List points from the sages analysis of the people in this age of Kali (10)
4. Vasudeva is the symbol of what? (12)
5. Why pure devotees more powerful than the waters of the Ganges? (15)
6. Explain the meaning of the titles Prabhupāda and Viṣṇupāda. (15)
7. How are those who are not conversant with the activities of the Lord and His transcendental realm sometimes favored by the Lord? (17)
8. List the requests / questions of the sages to Śrīla Sūta Gosvāmī. (9-23)

Analogies:

1.1.4: Detached branches and leaves dry up gradually despite all watering attempts. Similarly, human society, when it is detached from the Personality of Godhead like detached branches and leaves, is not capable of being watered, and one attempting to do so is simply wasting his energy and resources.

1.1.17: The material creations are manifested for some time as perverted shadows of the spiritual kingdom and can be likened to cinemas. They attract people of less intelligent caliber who are attracted by false things

THE 6 QUESTIONS OF THE SAGES HEADED BY ŚAUNAKA ṚṢI

Question One (1.1.9):
What is the absolute and ultimate good (śreyaḥ) for people in general?

Sūta explains that the ultimate benefit for people in general is to develop love of God through devotional service to Śrī Kṛṣṇa or His plenary parts (especially SB 1.2.6-7)

Question Two: (1.1.11):
What is the essence of all scriptures?

Throughout the Second Chapter of the Bhāgavatam and especially in 1.2.6-7, and continuing on to text 28, Śrī Kṛṣṇa is confirmed as the only object of worship, and establishing one's lost relationship with Him is proclaimed as the essence of the Vedic literatures.

Question Three (1.1.12):
Tell why Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead appeared?

This question is answered in 1.2.34, "to reclaim those in the mode of pure goodness." Also 1.3.28. In addition, this question is answered in 1.8.35, 9.4.61, 10.8.48-50, and 10.33.37.

Question Four (1.1.17):
Tell us of the acts the Lord performs in relationship to creating the material world.

In 1.2.30-33 the Bhāgavatam explains how Lord Vāsudeva creates the material substance and enters into it as the Purusa incarnations. Cantos 2 & 3 explain the creation of the universe.

Question Five (1.1.18):
Describe the activities of the incarnations of the Lord (Lilavataras)

The Lord's incarnations are described within the Canto 1 Chapter 3 & Canto 2 Chapter 7 where many incarnations are listed. Descriptions of the incarnations are expanded throughout the remainder of the Bhāgavatam - īśa-anukathāḥ (One of the 10 subjects of the Bhāgavatam)—the science of God and of His avataras & great devotees.

Question Six (1.1.23):
Where have religious principles gone after Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa's disappearance from this planet?

Sūta Gosvāmī answers this question in 1.3.43 by declaring, “This Bhagavat Purana is as brilliant as the sun, and it has arisen just after the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa to His own abode, accompanied by religion, knowledge, etc. Persons who have lost their vision due to the dense darkness of ignorance in the age of Kali shall get light from this Purana.”

From commentaries on the Bhāgavatam by Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī & Śrīla Visvanath Cakravarti Thākura.

1.2 Divinity and Divine Service

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1 Define dvija, vipra & Vaiṣṇava. (2)
2 Explain the terms pravṛtti-mārga & nivṛtti-mārga (6)
3 Identify 3 levels of occupational duties (8)
4 What is the first qualification of a devotee eligible for entering the kingdom of God? (16)
5 List some of the results of serving the servant of God. (16)
6 List the two very difficult problems for the devotee on the path back to Godhead. (17)
7 What is the remedy for eliminating all inauspicious things within the heart? (18)
8 Explain how a devotee Bhāgavata is as good as the book Bhāgavata. (18)
9 Describe the specialty of devotional service unto Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa (22)
10 Describe the development of consciousness resulting from hearing about Krsna. (17-22)
11 Explain the term Bhāgavata-dharma (27)
12 Briefly analyze the role of the Paramātmā. (31-34)

Analogies:

1.2.8: Without knowing the need of the dormant soul, one cannot be happy simply with emolument of the body and mind. The body and the mind are but superfluous outer coverings of the spirit soul. The spirit soul's needs must be fulfilled. Simply by cleansing the cage of the bird, one does not satisfy the bird. One must actually know the needs of the bird himself.

1.2.23: as maintenance of the prison house is concerned, it is done by Viṣṇu, as much as the state prison house is maintained by the state. Anyone, therefore, who wishes to get out of this prison house of material existence, which is full of miseries like repetition of birth, death, disease and old age, must please Lord Viṣṇu for such liberation.

1.2.28-29: In the prison house there are the prisoners and the managers of the prison house. Both the managers and the prisoners are bound by the laws of the king. But even though the king sometimes comes in the prison, he is not bound by the laws of the prison house. The king is therefore always transcendental to the laws of the prison house, as the Lord is always transcendental to the laws of the material world.

1.2.33: The sufferings and enjoyments of the sons are indirectly the sufferings and enjoyments of the father. Still the father is not in any way affected directly by the suffering and enjoyment of the sons.

1.2 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11

The perfection of religion (Dharma)

Before replying, Sūta Gosvāmī first offers his obeisances to his guru, Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī, and then begins answering the sages' questions. Sūta Gosvāmī begins describing the importance of the sages' inquiries, for they are about Kṛṣṇa. He then stresses pure devotional service to Kṛṣṇa (6) which does not depend on any material qualification (7), in answer to the sages' first two inquiries. He then explains that satisfaction of Kṛṣṇa is the real purpose of occupational duties (8-10). Verse 11 describes the Absolute Truth in 3 features.

Verses 12-22

Hearing: The process of achieving perfection in Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

Sūta Gosvāmī, reiterating the conclusion of 1.2.6, further explains that Kṛṣṇa is attainable (12) by devotional service, hearing & chanting etc ..(14), which is the perfection of Varṇāśrama (13), and which delivers one from bondage to works (karma-granthi) (14). Sūta Gosvāmī then describes the gradual progression of consciousness as one overcomes the effects of the modes of nature and attains pure devotional service through the proper hearing of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam and serving pure devotees.

Verses 23-34

Thus the conclusion is that Kṛṣṇa (Vasudeva) who expands as Visnu, is the supreme goal of everything (23-29), and the only object of worship. The chapter ends with Suta Gosvami's description of how the Lord, although transcendental to the material world, first creates the material world and then maintains His creation (30-34).

Discussion Topics

(PeA) lābho jīveta yāvatā, simple living (10)
The importance of hearing Bhāgavatam (12-22)

(PrA) The qualifications of Śukadeva Gosvāmī as expressed by Sūta Gosvāmī (1-4)
The standard of first class, transcendental religion (6-7)
Three features of the one Absolute Truth (11)
Kṛṣṇa in relation to His various expansions (23-34)

(EvA) Occupational engagements & Kṛṣṇa consciousness (8-13)

1.3 Kṛṣṇa Is the Source of All Incarnations

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Analyze the functions of the three puruṣa-avatāras. (1-2)
2. Explain the relative positions of Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva. (5)
3. All the incarnations within the universe are emanations from which puruṣa-avatāras? (5)
4. List some of the powers displayed by the various the incarnations of the Lord. (28)
5. Explain the term amogha-līlaḥ. (31)
6. Analyze the main point of the verse and purport to text 40.
7. List some of the qualifications mentioned for learning Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. (44)

Analogies:

1.3.2: We should not expect milk from the fleshy bags on the neck of a goat, although they look like breastly nipples. Similarly, we should not expect any creative power from the material ingredients;

1.3.28: When in the room small electric bulbs are displayed, it does not mean that the electric powerhouse is limited by the small bulbs. The same powerhouse can supply power to operate large-scale industrial dynamos with greater volts. Similarly, the incarnations of the Lord display limited powers because so much power is needed at that particular time.

1.3.31: When the President goes out in his particular car, we say, "There is the President." For the time being we identify the car with the President. Similarly, less intelligent men who want to see God immediately without necessary qualification are shown first the gigantic material cosmos as the form of the Lord, although the Lord is within and without.

1.3.34: The example of electrical energy is very appropriate in this connection. The expert electrician can utilize the electrical energy for both heating and cooling by adjustment only. Similarly, the external energy, which now bewilders the living being into continuation of birth and death, is turned into internal potency by the will of the Lord to lead the living being to eternal life.

1.3 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-5
Sūta Gosvāmī describes the three roles of the puruṣa-avatāras in the creation of both the total cosmos and the individual universes.

Verses 6-27
Sūta Gosvāmī briefly describes twenty-two incarnations of God that appear within this universe, but explains that the Lord actually has unlimited incarnations.

Verses 28-29
Although innumerable incarnations exist, Kṛṣṇa is Their fountainhead and is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. One should recite the mysterious appearances of the Lord, with devotion in the morning and in the evening.

Verses 30-39
The material forms (gross and subtle) of both the Lord (virāṭ-rūpa) and the living beings are actually imaginary. Therefore, learned men describe the glories and pastimes of the Lord's incarnations so that the conditioned souls can be freed from ignorance and achieve ecstatic love for the Supreme Lord.

Verses 40-44
Sūta Gosvāmī glorifies the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam as the incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa meant for delivering the conditioned souls of Kali-yuga. He also describes how the Bhāgavatam was transferred from Śrīla Vyāsadeva to Śukadeva Gosvāmī to himself.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Kṛṣṇa in relation to His various expansions (1-28)
Glories of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (40, 43) N.B. Discussed in next Unit

UNIT 1

CANTO1 CHAPTER 1 TO CHAPTER 3 VERSE 39

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

1. Select some of the following qualities:
    a. for relishing Bhāgavatam 1.1.1, 1.2.24.
    b. of a representative of Vyāsa in relation to presenting Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.5-8.
    c. of Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī as expressed by Sūta Gosvāmī 1.2.1-4.

    Discuss how you feel challenged in regard to developing these qualities. How do you intend to overcome these challenges?

2. Explain significant principles presented in 1.2.10. What changes could be made in your life in order to apply these principles? What is the relevance of these principles for leaders in ISKCON?

Academic & Moral Integrity

3. How important is one's attitude, outside of class, in the study of Bhāgavatam? Describe the appropriate attitude for study of Bhāgavatam as described in 1.1.2.

Śāstra-cakṣusā

4. Describe the standard of the people in this age of Kali with reference to the Sanskrit in 1.1.10-11. Give examples from your own experience which reflects this description.

UNIT 1 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present a brief overview of Canto 1 Chapters 1-3.
Describe an overview of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam with reference to different parts of the Lord's body.
Explain the components of the prelude to Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam in verses1.1.1-3
List the 6 questions of the sages & identify Sūta Goswāmī's respective responses 1.1.9-23.
Explain how Vasudeva is the symbol of the transcendental position 1.1.12.

Personal Application

Reflect on the importance of acquiring brahminical qualities for relishing Bhāgavatam 1.1.1, 1.2.24
Identify the benefits of attentive and submissive hearing of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.2
Examine the importance of honoring saintly devotees and avoiding offending them. 1.1.15
Reflect on their experience of relishing Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam with reference to 1.1.3.
Reflect on qualities of a representative of Vyāsa in relation to presenting Bhāgavatam. 1.1.5-8.
Reflect on the qualifications of Śukadeva Gosvāmī as expressed by Sūta Gosvāmī 1.2.1-4
Reflect on the principles of simple living in relation to their personal application1.2.10
Explain the importance of hearing Bhāgavatam with reference to 1.2.12-22

Preaching Application

Present Kṛṣṇa as the Absolute Truth, with reference to the Sanskrit and analogies in 1.1.1
Present the relationship between Absolute and relative truths referring to verse & analogy in 1.1.1
Present the authority of the Bhāgavatam with reference to other Purāṇas, erudite scholars. 1.1.1.
Present the significance of the Bhāgavatam with reference to mahā-muni-kṛte kiṁ vā parair 1.1.1-2
Analyze the distinction between real and pretentious religion with reference to the Sanskrit in 1.1.2
Cite examples of cheating religion with reference to catur-varga, jñāna, karma &upāsanā-kāṇḍa 1.1.2
Present the analogies of Vedas compared to the desire tree, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam compared to the ripened fruit & Śukadeva Gosvāmī compared to the parrot with reference to 1.1.3, verse & purport.
Present the standard of first class, transcendental religion with reference to 1.2.6-7
Present three features of the one Absolute Truth with reference to 1.2.11
Present Kṛṣṇa in relation to His various expansions, with reference to 1.2.23-29; 1.3.1-5 & 1.3.1-28

Academic & Moral Integrity

Reflect on the appropriate attitude for study of Bhāgavatam in relation to nirmatsarāṇāṁ 1.1.2

Mood & Mission

Relate the analogy of Bhāgavatam compared to the ripened fruit to Prabhupāda's mission 1.1.3.
Compare the mood of the sages at Naimiṣāraṇya to Prabhupāda's mood. 1.1.4.
Explain the role Prabhupāda's Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam plays in his mission.
Preface, Intro, 1.1.4, 16. 1.2.5,

Evaluation

Determine the importance of occupational duties & Kṛṣṇa consciousness 1.2.8-11

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Analyze the standard of the people in this age of Kali with reference to the Sanskrit in 1.1.10-11
Comment on the relevance of Prabhupāda's statement regarding modern educational systems 1.1.22

UNIT 2 NARADA'S INSTRUCTIONS TO VYASA (1.3.40 - 1.7.11)
SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 1.3.40-44; Chapter 4.1-25
Overview of Chapter 4
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 3 Questions 6-7 & Chapter 4.
Additional Questions:

1. What general principles can be drawn from:
    a. The damsels' respective reactions to Śukadeva Gosvāmī & Vyāsadeva? (4-5)
    b. Śukadeva Gosvāmī's dealing with householders? (8)
2. Choose one verse or passage from this section which reflects Śrīla Prabhupāda's Mood and Mission (or just one of these). Write a paragraph or two exploring this. (M&M)

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 4.26-32, 1.5.1-15
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 5 Questions 1-9
Additional Questions:

1. What general principles can be drawn from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction?
2. Choose verses (or parts of verses) in this section which you consider most useful in preaching. Explain why and discuss.

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 1.5.10-19; 32-36
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 5 Questions 10-11 & 15
Additional Questions:

1. Choose one verse that you feel is pertinent to Śrīla Prabhupāda's life and/or ISKCON's mission. Explain what it means to you and how it affects your life.
2. Choose a verse or passage from the section which you feel enhances your faith and conviction in Krishna Consciousness.

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 5. 23-31; Chapter 6
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 5 Questions 12-14 & Chapter 6
Additional Questions:

1. Classify principles which can be drawn from the example of Nārada into Personal & Preaching Application.

Lesson 5

Specific texts: 1.7.4-11
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 7 Questions 1-4
Additional Questions:

1. List general philosophical principles drawn from Vyāsadeva's vision. (4-5)
2. What general principles can be drawn from Śukadeva Gosvāmī taking the trouble to undergo the study of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam? (8-11)
3. Choose one verse that you feel is pertinent to Śrīla Prabhupāda's life and/or ISKCON's mission. Explain what it means to you and how it affects your life.

1.4 THE APPEARANCE OF ŚRĪ NĀRADA

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List the qualifications of the congratulator in a meeting of learned men (1)
2. Explain what is meant by 'personal realization'. (1)
3. List Śaunaka Ṛṣi questions in verses 1-12.
4. Compare the different qualifications of the brāhmaṇas and the parivrājakācāryas.(13)
5. How was Vyāsadeva able to see the anomalies of the age? (17-18)
6. Who are the greatest philanthropists? (17-18)
7. List the sages to whom the various parts of the Vedas were entrusted. (21-22)
8. What is the reason for the one Veda being divided into in many parts? (24)
9. What is the meaning of 'dvijabandhūnāṁ'? (25)
10. What is the purpose of the Mahābhārata? (25)
11. Why was Vyāsadeva not satisfied? (26-32)

Analogies:

1.4.4: While the conditioned soul thus dreams about spiritual engagements, the liberated soul is awake. Similarly, the engagement of a conditioned soul appears to be a dream for the liberated soul.

1.4 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-13

Śaunaka Ṛṣi requests Sūta Gosvāmī to relate the pious message of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, which was spoken by the great and powerful sage Śukadeva Gosvāmī (2). Śaunaka Ṛṣi inquires from Sūta Gosvāmī about:

- Where Vyāsa got the inspiration to compile Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (3).
- Qualities of Śukadeva Gosvāmī (4-8)
- His relationship with Mahārāja Parīkṣit (7-8)
- Why Parīkṣit gave up everything to sit by Ganges and fast until death. (9-12)

Verses 14-25

Sūta Gosvāmī explains how Śrīla Vyāsadeva, seeing the anomalies of the age, divided the Veda into four so they may be practically followed by less intelligent persons in the modes of passion and ignorance.

Verses 26-33

Even after his great work is complete, Śrīla Vyāsadeva still feels dissatisfied because in none of his works were the transcendental activities of the Lord properly explained. Just as he is contemplating the cause of his despondency, his spiritual master, Nārada Muni, appears.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) The meaning of 'personal realization'. (1)
Because Vyāsa a householder, he did not pretend to be a liberated soul..(5)
Preacher has no business with householders except to enlighten them (8)

(PrA) Mahārāja Parīkṣit was:
a) a pious king, therefore the kingdom was full of prosperity (11)
b) shelter for others - not allow slaughterhouses or killing of cows (12)
Different qualifications of the brāhmaṇas and the parivrājakācāryas (13)
Division of the Vedas (19-24) Itihāsa & Purāṇas are called the fifth Veda (20)
No one, therefore, can claim independent knowledge beyond the Vedas (23)
Dvijabandhū- born brāhmaṇas, kṣatriyas... .. not equal to their forefathers (25)

(Und) Śukadeva appeared like ignorant person / transcendental to sex, innocent (4)
Overlapping of the twenty-eighth round of the four millenniums (14)
Vyāsadeva saw anomalies in yuga-dharma / divyena cakṣuṣā (14-18)

(MM) Greatest philanthropists represent mission of Vyāsa, Nārada, Madhva, Caitanya, Rūpa, Sarasvatī ..(18)
Persons empowered by Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu can initiate others in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. (25)

1. 5 Nārada's Instructions on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam for Vyāsadeva

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List further reasons for Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction, see verses, purports & quotes. (5.2-9)
2. Explain the meaning of 'tad vāyasaṁ tīrtham'. (10)
3. Where do the all-perfect persons take pleasure? (10)
4. Explain the meaning of the phrase 'janata āgha viplavo' (11)
5. What is the main point of verse and purport to text 12?
6. Explain the meaning of the phrase 'amogha-dṛk' (13)
7. What is the defect in the literatures compiled by Vyāsa? (14)
8. Explain the meaning of the phrase 'jugupsitam' (15)
9. What does the phrase 'compromising spirit of Vyāsadeva' mean? (15)
10. Explain the meaning of 'ko vā artha āpto abhajatāṁ sva-dharmataḥ' (17)
11. Explain how a devotee does of not undergo material existence like others. (19)
12. How can one engage one's gross body in the service of the Lord? (27)
13. List the qualifications of a disciple exemplified by Śrī Nārada..(29)
14. What is the most confidential part of knowledge? (30-31)
15. Explain the process of karma-yoga (32-36)

Analogies

1.5.10: Those words which do not describe the glories of the Lord are considered by saintly persons to be like unto a place of pilgrimage for crows. / decorative language full of mundane similes and metaphorical arrangements. Yet with all that, they do not glorify the Lord. Such poetry and prose.. is considered decoration of a dead body

1.5.15: The expert physician does not make any compromise with the patient by allowing him to take partially what he should not at all take… Vedic literatures on the basis of regulated performances of fruitive activities..

1.5.33: Milk preparations sometimes cause disorder of the bowels, but the very same milk converted into curd and mixed with some other remedial ingredients cures such disorders. Activities have to be spiritualized, just as by fire iron is made red-hot..make the best use of a bad bargain use everything in relation with the supreme spiritual being. Similarly, the material conception of a thing is at once changed as soon as it is put into the service of the Lord.

1.5 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verse 1-9

Nārada Muni, fully understanding the situation, inquires from Vyāsadeva about the root cause of his unhappiness, and hints about the solution. Śrīla Vyāsadeva requests his spiritual master, Nārada Muni, to reveal to him the cause of his despondency. Nārada explains that Vyāsadeva had written many Vedic literatures in which he had broadly described dharma, artha, kāma and mokṣa but he had not described the glories of the Supreme Personality, Vāsudeva. In this way Vyāsadeva had improperly used his valuable time.

Verses 10-19

Nārada compares those words which do not describe the glories of the Lord as a place of pilgrimage for crows. Transcendental literature, however, can bring about a revolution in the world's misdirected civilization. Because Vyāsa had encouraged the people, in the name of religion, to enjoy Nārada condemns Vyāsa's compilation of different Vedic literatures as abominable. What if one gives up prescribed duties, (as recommended by Nārada) but does not achieve complete success? Progress in devotional service is credited forever. However a nondevotee, though fully engaged in occupational duties, does not gain anything. Material happiness comes according to destiny, so don't endeavor for it. Even if a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa falls down, he does not undergo material existence like others.

Verses 20-40

Nārada gives himself as an example of how one can achieve confidential service of the Lord simply by hearing from and serving great Bhaktivedāntas (23-31). Nārada Muni glorifies working in Krsna's service while remembering Him (32-36). Nārada glorifies transcendental sound, and requests Vyāsadeva to directly glorify the Lord's activities for the benefit of suffering humanity.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction (4.32-5.9)
Non devotional literature is a place of pilgrimage for crows….(10)
Defect in Vedic Literature / Compromising spirit of Vyāsa condemned by Nārada (14-15)
Nondevotional occupational duties = no gain / happiness comes as destined. (17-18)
Karma-yoga - Very same milk converted into curd ..cures such disorders (33)

(PeA) Clear vision (amogha-dṛk) required to do welfare activities. (13)
Nārada serving bhaktivedāntas - effect of service to the devotees (23-25)
Qualifications of a disciple exemplified by Śrī Nārada.. (29)

(M+M) Jnatāgha viplavo - revolution in impious lives of misdirected civilization (11)
Expert devotees find competent means inject it into dull brains (16)
Convert hell of pandemonium to abode of Lord/ under guidance of a pure devotee (36)
The Pañcarātra is more important than the Vedānta for this modern age. (38)

(F&C) Serving Kṛṣṇa is credited forever.. never lost …(17-19)

1. 6 Conversation Between Nārada and Vyāsadeva

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain the meaning of 'sad-dharma-pṛcchā'. (2)
2. List Vyāsadeva's questions to Nārada (3-4)
3. Analyze the import of Nārada's mother bitten by a serpent (6-10)
4. What is the duty of a duty of a mendicant (parivrājakācārya)? (12-13)
5. Describe Nārada's experience during meditation. (16-17)
6. What general principles can be drawn from Narada's experience of unsuccessful endeavors to see the form of the Lord a second time? (18-20)
7. What was Nārada's 'material taint? (21)
8. Why did the Lord withdraw Himself from the vision of Nārada? (22)
9. Describe the life of a sincere devotee of the Lord as exemplified by Nārada (26)
10. Describe Nārada's transcendental body and activities. (27- 38)
11. What is the effect of hearing from such an authority as Nārada? (36)

Analogies

1.6.20: we cannot demand the sun to rise whenever we like. The sun rises out of his own accord; so also the Lord is pleased to be present out of His causeless mercy.

1.6.27: Nārada met with death as lightning & illumination occur simultaneously..
Even before death, a pure devotee has no material affection, due to his body's being spiritualized like a red-hot iron in contact with fire.

1.6. 33: the Lord, at once He becomes visible to the transcendental eyes of the pure devotee by reflecting Himself on the mirror of the heart by spiritual television.

1.6. 35: The senses want some engagement. To check them artificially is no check at all because as soon as there is some opportunity for enjoyment, the serpentlike senses will certainly take advantage of it.

1.6 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-20

Vyāsadeva inquires from Nārada about how he passed his life after the departure of the sages. Nārada describes that after his mother was bitten by a snake and died, he began traveling. He passed through many towns, villages, mines, agricultural lands, and natural forests etc. Once, as he sat beneath a banyan tree, he began meditating on the Lord in the heart.. The Supersoul first appeared to him and then quickly departed.

Verses 21-25

To dispel His grief, the Lord spoke to Nārada, explaining that who are not completely free from all material taints can hardly see Him. The Lord revealed that He had once shown His form to Nārada just to increase his desire to achieve Him. After recounting his meeting with the Lord, Nārada tells Vyāsa how he spent the remainder of his life.

Verses 26-38

Nārada then describes his change of body & next birth as the great sage Nārada. He can travel everywhere unrestricted. He is a liberated spaceman. Nārada finishes his instructions to Vyāsadeva, and Sūta Gosvāmī narrates the departure of Nārada. Sūta Gosvāmī then describes Nārada's glories.

Discussion Topics

(SC) See in every step benediction of Lord (6-10, 36)
Freedom in devotional service (37)

(PeA) To inquire from spiritual master is an essential factor to progressive path (2)
Duty of a parivrājakācārya (12-13)
(Lord appeared / disappeared) to increase his intense desire for the Lord (22)
According to personal capacity, to distribute the message for others' welfare (26)

(PrA) no mechanical process to see the Lord - cannot demand the sun to rise (19)
Temple of Lord & preaching process - transcendental to material qualities. (21)
Describe Nārada's transcendental body and activities. (27- 34)
Lord appears in the picture of His glorification, reflecting Himself on the mirror of the heart by spiritual television (33)

(M+M) Mood of a preacher as exemplified by Nārada (26, 38)

1.7 THE SON OF DROṆA PUNISHED

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What did Śrīla Vyāsadeva see in meditation? (4-5)
2. Why is the task of the illusory energy described as a 'thankless task'? (5)
3. Explain the 'both ways' the conditioned souls are being reclaimed by the Lord. (5)
4. How did Vyāsadeva respond after his vision? (5-6)
5. Explain the meaning of brahma-bandhu (19)
6. Explain the analogy of the darkness depends on the existence of the sun (23)
7. What is the standard procedure for presenting something before the Lord? (26)
8. How powerful is the heat produced by the brahmāstra? (30-31)
9. What general principles does Prabhupāda drawn from Arjuna retracted both brahmāstra weapons (32)
10. List the arguments both for and against the execution of Aśvatthāmā (35-52)
11. What pure devotional characteristics are here seen in Draupadī? (43)
12. What was the motive of the Lord in this incidence? (55)

Analogies

1.7.4: The internal energy is there along with the Absolute Person as the moonlight is there with the moon.

1.7.5: An affectionate father does not like his children to be chastised by another agent, yet he puts his disobedient children under the custody of a severe man just to bring them to order….The king puts the disobedient citizens within the walls of the jail, but sometimes the king, desiring the prisoners' relief, personally goes there and pleads for reformation, and on his doing so the prisoners are set free. Similarly, the Supreme Lord descends from His kingdom upon the kingdom of illusory energy and personally gives relief in the form of the Bhagavad-gītā

1.7.23: Darkness is a perverse representation of the sun, and therefore the existence of darkness depends on the existence of the sun, but in the sun proper there is no trace of darkness

1.7 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11

Śaunaka Ṛṣi inquires from Sūta Gosvāmī about Vyāsa's activities after Nārada's departure. Sūta Gosvāmī first describes how through his meditation Vyāsa perfectly understood the Lord, the Lord's internal energy, the living entity, and the Lord's external energy. To save the conditioned souls from misery, Vyāsadeva compiled the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam and taught it to his son Śukadeva Gosvāmī. Śaunaka asks Sūta Gosvāmī why Śukadeva, who was already on the path of self-realization, took the trouble to study Bhāgavatam. Sūta replies that even liberated souls are attracted to the Bhāgavatam

Verses 12-34

Sūta Gosvāmī begins answering Śaunaka Rsi's earlier questions about Sri Krsna, Maharaja Pariksit, and the Pāṇḍavas. He begins by explaining that Aśvatthāmā killed the five sleeping Pandava princes after the Battle of Kurukṣetra. Aśvatthāmā flees and Arjuna sets out to capture him. Aśvatthāmā seeing his life in danger, releases his brahmāstra weapon. Arjuna seeing the brahmāstra threatening him, prays to Krsna, who is driving his chariot, and then follows Krsna's instructions to release his own brahmāstra weapon and then retract them both.

Verses 35-58

Arjuna neutralizes the brahmāstra and then captures and binds Aśvatthāmā. Krsna then tells Arjuna that Aśvatthāmā should be killed. Arjuna brings Aśvatthāmā back to the Pāṇḍava camp. There, Draupadi and the other Pāṇḍavas are appalled to see Aśvatthāmā, the son of their teacher, bound with ropes. They demand his release. Bhima, alone amongst the Pāṇḍavas, demands that Aśvatthāmā be killed for his horrendous misdeed. Krsna hints at the solution, and Arjuna, understanding Krsna's desire, both "kills" and "not kills" Aśvatthāmā by cutting off the jewel from Aśvatthāmā's head. Then, after releasing Aśvatthāmā, Arjuna and the Pāṇḍavas perform the funeral rituals for their relatives who have been slain in the Battle of Kurukṣetra.

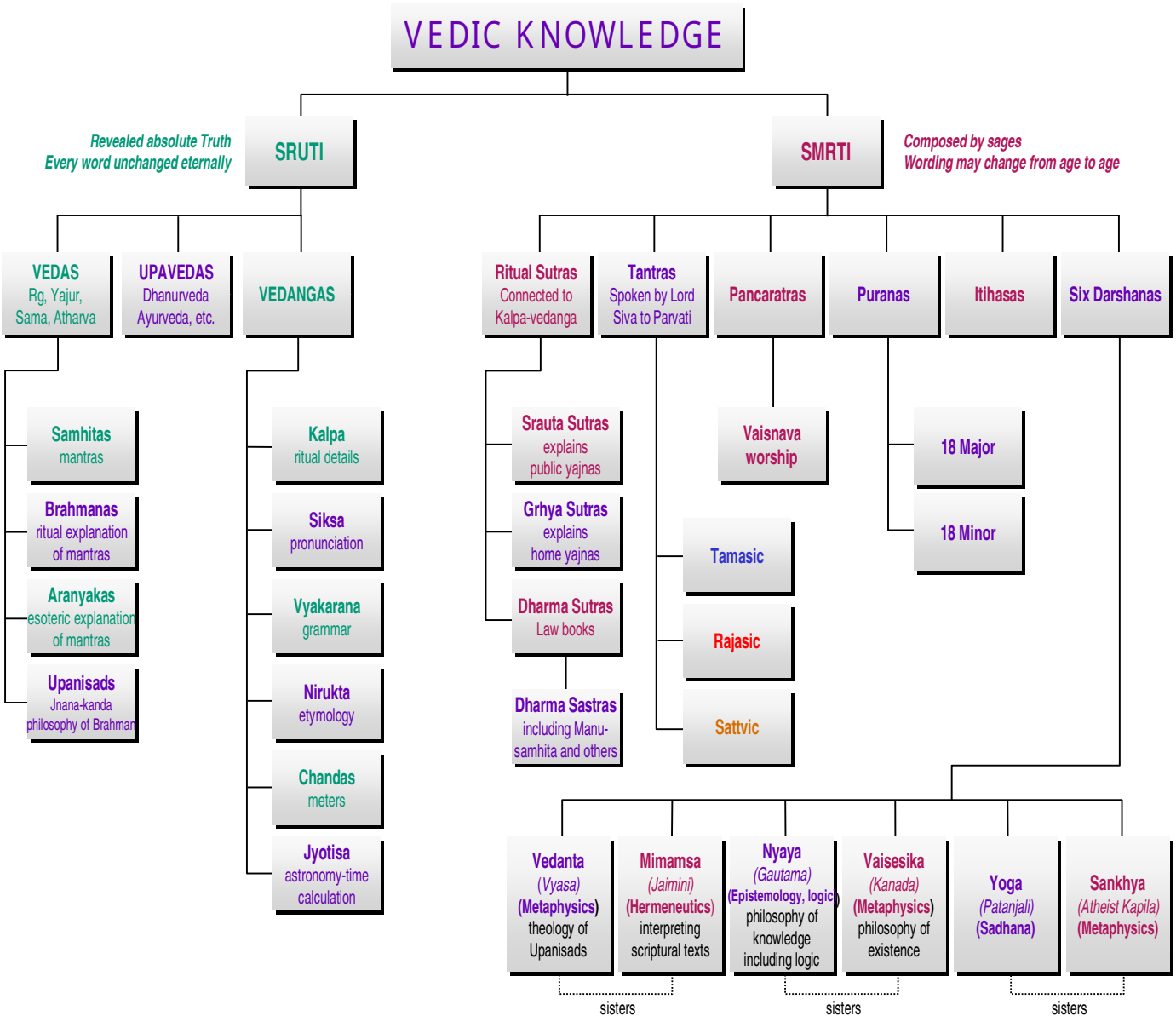
(PeA) Presentation before the Lord should be done after due presentation of respectful prayers (26)

(PrA) Vyāsadeva vision (4-6)
Ātmārāma verse (10)
Aśvatthāmā simultaneously killed and not killed (56)

(M+M) hearing of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam …real peace in society begins (6, 13-14)

(ThA) Arguments for and against the execution of Aśvatthāmā (32-52)
Violence carried out on religious principles is far superior to so-called nonviolence (36)
Manu: murder conspiracy - all of them are liable (37)

(AMI) Women has no discriminatory power like that of a man (42)


VEDIC KNOWLEDGE
SRUTI
Revealed absolute Truth
Every word unchanged eternally
SMRTI
Composed by sages
Wording may change from age to age
VEDAS
Rg, Yajur, Sama, Atharva
UPAVEDAS
Dhanurveda Ayurveda, etc.
VEDANGAS
Samhitas
mantras
Brahmanas
ritual explanation of mantras
Aranyakas
esoteric explanation of mantras
Upanisads
Jnana-kanda philosophy of Brahman
Kalpa
ritual details
Siksa
pronunciation
Vyakarana
grammar
Nirukta
etymology
Chandas
meters
Jyotisa
astronomy-time calculation
Ritual Sutras
Connected to Kalpa-vedanga
Tantras
Spoken by Lord Siva to Parvati
Pancaratras
Puranas
Itihasas
Six Darshanas
Srauta Sutras
explains public yajnas
Grhya Sutras
explains home yajnas
Dharma Sutras
Law books
Dharma Sastras
including Manu-samhita and others
Vaisnava worship
Tamasic
Rajasic
Sattvic
18 Major
18 Minor
Vedanta
(Vyasa)
(Metaphysics)
theology of Upanisads
Mimamsa
(Jaimini)
(Hermeneutics)
interpreting scriptural texts
Nyaya
(Gautama)
(Epistemology, logic)
philosophy of knowledge including logic
Vaisesika
(Kanada)
(Metaphysics)
philosophy of existence
Yoga
(Patanjali)
(Sadhana)
Sankhya
(Atheist Kapila)
(Metaphysics)
sisters
sisters
sisters

UNIT 2

CANTO1 CHAPTER 3 VERSE 40 TO CHAPTER 7 VERSE 11

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

(Respond in 800 -1000 words, 2-3 pages).

Explain the reasons for Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction as described in Chapters 4 & 5, with appropriate analogies & Sanskrit phrases from appropriate verses. Identify some general principles which can be drawn from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction (Chapters 4 & 5) and the life example of Nārada (5.23- 6.38), and explain the relevance of these principles in terms of personal & preaching application. Select Sanskrit phrases and statements from purports & lectures from 5.10-15, which reflect Śrīla Prabhupāda's mood and mission. Explain what these statements mean to you and how they affect your life.

Assessment Criteria	Out of 10		
Understanding Identifies reasons for Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction with references Explains appropriate analogies & Sanskrit phrases from appropriate verses. Identifies some general principles which can be drawn from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction and the example of Nārada's life.		**3**	
Personal Application Explains the relevence of some general principles drawn from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction, & Nārada's life, in their own lives.		**2**	
Preaching Application Give examples of how some general principles from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction, & Nārada's life, can be used in preaching		**2**	
Mood & Mission Identifies important aspects of Prabhupāda's mood and mission Selects appropriate Sanskri phrases & statements from purports & lectures. Explains how these statements affects life personally		**3**	

Marks out of ten: 4 Poor 5 Borderline 6 Below average 7 Average 8 Above average 9 Outstanding

UNIT 2 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Explain in their own words the reasons for Vyāsadeva's division of Vedas 4.14-25
Identify reasons for Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction with references from 4.26- 5.9
Draw general principles from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction.
Summarize Nārada's instructions to Vyāsadeva 5.10-19
Explain the meaning of key phrases from 5.10.
Explain the analogies 'tad vāyasaṁ tīrtham' & of decoration of a dead body 5.10
Explain the main point of verse and purport to text 5.12
Explain in their own words the term 'jugupsitam' and the statement 'compromising spirit of Vyāsadeva' 5.15
Explain karma-yoga as instructed by Nārada 5. 32-36
Identify from 1.7.4-7

- General philosophical principles drawn from Vyāsadeva's vision in
- Particular Sanskrit phrases related to the general principles
- Supportive statements from Prabhupāda's purports & lectures for this section
- Analogies given in this section
- Some appropriate Bg supportive verses

Summarize Śrīla Vyāsadeva contribution in their own words 7.4-7

Personal Application

List and appreciate varieties of benefits derived from worshiping Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam1.3.40- 44
Discuss general principles drawn from the examples of Śukadeva Gosvāmī & Vyāsadeva & explain how these principles could be applied personally (4.4-8)
Explain the relevance of the general principles drawn from Vyāsadeva's dissatisfaction
In their own lives 4.26- 5.9

Preaching Application

Identify guidelines for effective preaching given in purport to 1.4.1.
Give examples of how general principles from Vyāsa's dissatisfaction can be applied in preaching 4.26- 5.9
Appropriately explain the defect in the literatures compiled by Vyāsa 5.14
Effectively cite the expert physician analogy to validate Nārada's view 5.15
Classify principles which can be drawn from the example of Nārada (5. 23-31 & Chapter 6) into Personal & Preaching Application and explain how they can be applied
Explain the meaning of key phrases in Ātmārāma verse (1.7.10)
Present Śrīla Vyāsadeva contribution in a preaching context 7.4-7

Mood & Mission

Identify statements from Śrīla Prabhupāda's translations and purports to 1.5.verses 11,16 & 36, which give insight into his mission and that of ISKCON.
Explain in their own words the importance of these aspects of Prabhupāda's mission.

Faith & Conviction

Select statements from verse, translation, purport & respective lecture quotes, which increase their faith & conviction in the process of Krsna consciousness. 1.5.17-19

UNIT 3

PRAYERS BY QUEEN KUNTĪ & THE PASSING AWAY OF BHĪṢMADEVA

(CANTO 1 CHAPTER 7 VERSE 12 - CHAPTER 9)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 7.16-56
Overview of Chapter 7
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 7 Questions 5-12
Additional Questions:

1. List the arguments both for and against the execution of Aśvatthāmā (35-52)
2. Identify one statement which appears to be contradictory to popular contemporary thought (values, opinions, etc.). Explain how you would present it to an audience of non-devotees in such a way as to be tactful but not compromising our principles.

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 8.1-24
Overview of Chapter 8
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya Questions for Chapter 8 Questions 1-11

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 8.26-31; 9.11-17
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questionsÖ:
Chapter 8 Questions 12-16/ Chapter 9 Questions 2 & 3.

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 8.46-51; 9.9; 9.25-28
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions:
Chapter 8 Questions 17-19 / Chapter 9 Question 1.
Additional QuestionÖ:
Select significant points from Bhismadeva's instructions on Varṇāśrama (9.25-28)

Lesson 5

Reading Assignment: 9.22-24; 9.32-44
Overview of Chapter 9
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions: Chapter 9 Question 3 -11.
Additional QuestionÖ:
Identify points relevant for personal & preaching application from the passing away of Bhīṣmadeva.

1.8 PRAYERS BY QUEEN KUNTĪ AND PARĪKṢIT SAVED

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why were the unscrupulous kings who joined with Duryodhana killed by the Lord? (5)
2. List and briefly explain the 5 groups of people who were properly given protection. (5)
3. What was the reason the Lord established the rule of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira? (11)
4. Why did Uttarā, Abhimanyu's widow, not follow the path of her husband? (10)
5. What does Śrī Kṛṣṇa taking up His Sudarśana cakra indicate? (13)
6. Describe the nature of a chaste devotee of the Lord. (17)
7. Why are demons reluctant to accept the Lord as the Absolute Truth? (19)
8. Explain why women generally assemble in great number in religious functions. (20)
9. Why does Queen Kuntī specifically adore the incarnation of Krishna? (21)
10. What does the name *Govinda* indicate? (21)
11. What general principle can be drawn from Krsna's treatment of Kuntīdevī & Devakī? (23)
12. Explain why so-called calamities are welcome. (25)
13. Explain the meaning of *akiñcana-gocaram* (26)
14. Explain why the four principles of material advancement are disqualifications. (26)
15. Why is the specific example of Śrīla Sanātana Gosvāmī and the touchstone given? (27)
16. Draw general principles from Kuntī's expression of bewilderment in verse 31.
17. Explain the import of the words anātha & sanātha. (37-38)
18. Why did Kuntīdevī pray to cut off the affectionate tie from her own kinsmen? (41-42)
19. Identify reasons for Yudhiṣṭhira's dejection (8.46-51)

Analogies:

1.8.25: A man may see a tiger swallowing him in a dream, and he may cry for this calamity. Actually there is no tiger and there is no suffering; it is simply a case of dreams. In the same way, all calamities of life are said to be dreams

1.8.29: He is never partial, as much as the sun is never partial to anyone. By utilizing the sun rays, sometimes even the stones become valuable, whereas a blind man cannot see the sun, although there are enough sun rays before him.

1.8.32: He is known as Yādava, Yaduvīra, Yadunandana, etc., although the Lord is always independent of such obligation. He is just like the sandalwood that grows in the Malaya hills. Trees can grow anywhere and everywhere, yet because the sandalwood trees grow mostly in the area of the Malaya hills, the name sandalwood and the Malaya hills are interrelated.

1.8.44: No amount of chosen words is sufficient to enumerate the Lord's glory, and yet He is satisfied by such prayers as the father is satisfied even by the broken linguistic attempts of the growing child.

1.8 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16
Just after Lord Kṛṣṇa and the Pāṇḍavas perform the funeral rituals for their relatives killed in the Battle of Kurukṣetra, Kṛṣṇa prepares to leave for Dvārakā. Suddenly Uttarā approaches Kṛṣṇa in great fear. Aśvatthāmā has hurled a brahmāstra to kill the unborn child within her womb. Kṛṣṇa, as the Supersoul, covers the embryo from within and saves Uttarā.

Verses 17-43 Prayers by Queen Kuntī.
Śrīmatī Kuntīdevī approaches Kṛṣṇa along with her sons and offers obeisances. After glorifying the Lord, Kuntīdevī describes His descent and greatness, and wonders how she can possibly understand His unfathomable position. Kuntīdevī retells how the Lord protected her and her family during their calamitous years of exile. She then explains that only one who has no material shelter can easily approach Kṛṣṇa. Kuntīdevī explains the mysterious nature of Kṛṣṇa's birth and activities, as well as the reason for His advent. She begs Kṛṣṇa to remain in Hastināpura, as the welfare and opulence of the Pāṇḍava kingdom depend upon His presence. Finally, Kuntīdevī expresses her desire to sever her affection for all but Kṛṣṇa and she declares her complete dependence upon Him.

Verses 44-52
After Kuntīdevī ends her prayers, Kṛṣṇa again attempts to leave Hastināpura. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, overwhelmed by the death of his kinsman, approaches Kṛṣṇa in a dejected mood and is filled with lamentation.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Lord accepts the loving service of His devotees more relishably when rendered spontaneously out of pure affection, without anything of reverential admiration. (31)
the whole prayer of the Queen is to try to persuade the Lord to stay with them (38)

(PeA) To cut off all family affection means to broaden the field of activities (41-42)

(PrA) He preferred to continue as bhakta-vatsala than to be a worldly moralist who never breaks his solemn vow. (13)
Kṛṣṇa endows more favor to a devotee who is in greater dangers (17, 23)
Material advancement are disqualifications for progress on the path of spiritual advancement (25-27)
the Lord is never partial (29)
Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira’s dejection. (42-53)

(ThA) the brāhmaṇas, cows, women, children and old men were properly given protection (5)
Human prosperity flourishes by natural gifts. (40)

1.9 The Passing Away of Bhīṣmadeva in the Presence of Lord Kṛṣṇa

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why did Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa want the Pāṇḍavas to be present at Bhīṣmadeva's death? (3)
2. Summarize Bhīṣmadeva's explanation of the sufferings of the Pāṇḍavas. (11-17)
3. Why did Bhīṣmadeva choose to fight against the Pāṇḍavas? (16)
4. List reasons for Kṛṣṇa wanting Bhīṣmadeva to instruct Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira. (25)
5. Describe Bhīṣmadeva's relationship with the Lord. (33-34, 38)
6. Explain how Lord enjoyed the wounds created by His great devotee Bhīṣmadeva. (34)
7. Why did Kṛṣṇa seemingly break His own promise? (37)
8. Explain how Bhīṣmadeva observed Pārtha-sārathi with more relish than Arjuna. (39)
9. What was the destination of all those who saw Kṛṣṇa on Battlefield of Kurukṣetra? (39)
10. What destination was achieved by Bhīṣmadeva? (44)
11. Why do the votes cast by the mass of people actually have no value? (49)

Analogies:

1.9.17: The popular saying is that a housewife teaches the daughter-in-law by teaching the daughter. Similarly, the Lord teaches the world by teaching the devotee.

1.9.34: Śrī Bhīṣmadeva throwing of sharp arrows at the transcendental body of the Lord is as good as the worship of another devotee who throws soft roses upon Him.

1.9.34: the wounds created on the body of the Lord by the sharpened arrows of Bhīṣmadeva were as pleasing to the Lord as the biting of a fiancee who bites the body of the Lord directed by a strong sense of sex desire. (Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī Ṭhākura)

1.9.35: By executing the order of a devotee, the Lord becomes pleased, as a father is pleased to carry out the order of his small child.

1.9 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-10
Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, Kṛṣṇa, and the Pāṇḍavas go to the battlefield where Bhīṣmadeva is lying on a bed of arrows. Many great ṛṣis also arrive, and Bhīṣmadeva properly receives them all, especially Lord Kṛṣṇa, for Bhīṣmadeva is aware of His glorious position.

Verses 11-24
Bhīṣmadeva enumerates the sufferings the Pāṇḍavas tolerated prior to the battle. He explains that such things could only have happened due to the actions of eternal time and Kṛṣṇa 's inconceivable plan. Bhīṣmadeva describes the glories and actual position of Kṛṣṇa. Bhīṣmadeva appreciates that Kṛṣṇa has personally come to be present before him at the time of his death.

Verses 25-28
Bhīṣmadeva's instructions on Varṇāśrama–dharma.

Verses 29-34
Bhīṣmadeva notices that the auspicious time for his departure has arrived. He thus withdraws his consciousness from this world and focuses it on Kṛṣṇa.

Verses 35-49
Bhīṣmadeva especially fixes his mind on remembering Cri Kṛṣṇa on the battlefield as the chariot driver of Arjuna. Bhīṣmadeva further glorifies Kṛṣṇa's wonderful reciprocations with His other devotees. Bhīṣmadeva breathes his last. After the great sages and the Pāṇḍavas depart, Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira begins ruling the kingdom according to the instructions he has received from Bhīṣmadeva.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Bhīṣmadeva's relationship with the Lord (22-24; 32-44)

(PrA) Bhīṣmadeva's explanation of the reverses on the side of the Pāṇḍavas (11-19)
Bhismadeva's instructions on Varṇāśrama-dharma (25-28)

(M&M) Adjustment of religious principles in terms of time and place in relation to his mission and that of the previous great ācāryas.(9)

UNIT 3

CANTO1 CHAPTER 7 VERSE 12 TO CHAPTER 9

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application /Preaching Application

1. List priciples relevant for personal & preaching application from the passing away of Bhīṣmadeva.

Mood & Mission

2. Discuss how Prabhupāda's purport to 8.5 gives insight into his mission and that of ISKCON. Summarize how effectively we have been in implementing the guidelines in ISKCON.

3. *Select only one of the following two questions:*

    a. Identify aspects of Prabhupāda's mood and mission reflected in purport to verse 8.40. Discuss their relevance for ISKCON members & society in general.

    b. Identify significant points from Bhismadeva's instructions on Varṇāśrama-dharma. Discuss their relevance for ISKCON members & society in general.

UNIT 3 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of the story line of Chapters 7- 9 & an overview of Queen Kuntī Prayers
Explain Kuntī's bewilderment in remembering the devotional attitude of Yaśodā (8.31)
Describe Bhīṣmadeva's relationship with the Lord with reference to 9.22-24 & 9.32-44

Personal Application

Describe Queen Kuntī & the Pāṇḍavas dependence on and chastity to the Lord.
Share experiences from their own life, of how Krsna

- reciprocates with dependant & chaste devotees (8.17)
- endows more favor to a devotee who is in greater dangers.(8.23)

Discuss ways they can improve the quality of their uttering the Holy Name with reference to 8. 26
Identify points relevant for personal & preaching application from the passing away of Bhīṣmadeva.
Reflect on the example of the Pāṇḍavas as ideal executors of 'work with valor but at the same time depend completely on the Lord' & discuss its relevance in their lives (8.37)

Preaching/Theological Application

Effectively present the principles behind:

- violence on religious principles, /death sentence by the state & the conspiracy of animal killing, in in a tactful but not compromising manner (7.32-38)

Explain Yudhiṣṭhira's dejection and list reasons why he could not be convinced by the Lord (8.46-51).
Present significant points from Bhismadeva's instructions on Varṇāśrama-dharma which are relevant for ISKCON members & society in general. (9.25-28)

Mood & Mission

Discuss:

- The relevance for ISKCON in general of Prabhupāda's statement that 'to insult a chaste woman means to bring about disaster in the duration of life.' (8.5)
- How Prabhupāda's purport to 8.5 give insight into his mission and that of ISKCON.
- How effectively we have implemented the 5 guidelines listed in 8.5 purport in ISKCON.

Identify attitudes, alternative to akiñcana, which may have entered into ISKCON.
Discuss ways to develop the mood of akiñcana within ISKCON. (8. 26)
Discuss how the following statements reflect Prabhupāda's mood and mission:

- 8.40: Human prosperity flourishes by natural gifts
- 9.9 regarding adjustment of religious principles in terms of time and place,

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Identify general principles & analogies from within:

- Kunti devi's teaching that so-called calamities are welcome (8.25-26)
- Bhīṣmadeva's explanation of the reverses on the side of the Pāṇḍavas (9.11-19)

Discuss how application of these principles can help us to improve our approach to difficulties in life.

Evaluation

Discuss the principles behind the arguments for and against the execution of Aśvatthāmā (7.16-56)
Differentiate between appropriate & in appropriate application for ISKCON devotees, of Kuntī's prayer in 8.41, to cut off all family affection.

Academic Integrity

Discuss how Prabhupāda's statement in 7.42 regarding discriminatory power of women, may be misused.

UNIT 4 LORD KṚṢṆA IN HASTINĀPURA & DVĀRAKĀ

(CANTO 1 CHAPTERS 10-13)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: Chapter 10.1-6
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya for Chapter 10 questions 1-5
Additional Question:

1. Select passages from 10.1-6 reflecting Śrīla Prabhupāda's Mood and Mission.

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 10.16; 10.27-30
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 10 questions 6-13

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 11.13-23; 11.30-39
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 11
Additional Questions:

1. Identify different elements of a Vedic reception. 11.13-23
2. Analyze the relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His queens in Dvārakā. 11.30-39

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 12.4-6; 12.12; 13.1; 13.12-25;
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 12
Additional Question:

1. Identify general principles which can be drawn from the example of Dhṛtarāṣṭra's attachment. (13.23-25)

Lesson 5

Specific texts: (13.12-23); 13.35-37; 13.47-48; 13.53-57
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 13
Additional Questions:

1. Select statements from verses 36-37 & 47-48 which reflect Prabhupāda's mood & Mission
2. List general principles we can learn from can we learn from Dhṛtarāṣṭra's practice of yoga & Gāndhārī's entering his funeral pyre. (53-57)

1.10 Departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa for Dvārakā

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why Yudhiṣṭhira Mahārāja could not enjoy the results of his victory? (1)
2. Why was the Battle of Kurukṣetra fought? (2)
3. List some aspects of the world situation created by Maharaja Yudhisthira's reign (3-6)
4. Explain how an autocracy like Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira's is superior to a democracy. (4)
5. Why is there is always the strain of cold or hot war between men? (6)
6. Why did the Lord decide to stay Hastināpura for a few months more? (7)
7. Describe the extra-natural beauty of the fair sex & how it should be utilized. (16)
8. Explain why the talk of the ladies on the roofs of all the houses of Hastināpura was more attractive than the hymns of the Vedas. (20)
9. List some of the superhuman acts the Lord performs to prove His supreme right. (25)
10. Explain how Dvārakā is certainly more important than the heavenly planets. (27)
11. Why is a person engaged in the devotional service of the Lord is recommended to live in Dvārakā, Mathurā or Vṛndāvana? (27)
12. Describe the two classes of devotees of the Lord in the stage of conjugal love. (28)
13. Explain why the Lord accepted the fallen girls under the clutches of Bhaumāsura as His wives. (30)

Analogies:

1.10.21: When a man is asleep at night, he forgets himself, what he is, what his duty is and everything of his waking state. But as soon as he awakens from slumber, he remembers all that he has to do and thus engages himself again in his prescribed activities. The living beings also remain merged in the body of Mahā-Viṣṇu during the period of annihilation, but as soon as there is another creation they arise to take up their unfinished work.

1.10.25: The material world is created to satisfy the whims of the nitya-baddha, or everlasting conditioned souls, just as naughty boys are provided with playing cradles.

1.10 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6
Saunaka Rsi questions Suta Gosvami about Maharaja Yudhisthira's rule of the kingdom after the Kuruksetra battle, and Suta Gosvami answers by describing the wonderful world situation created by Maharaja Yudhisthira's reign.

Verses 7-30
Suta Gosvami then narrates Krsna's departure from Hastinapura to Dvaraka and describes the expressions of affection by the residents of Hastinapura.
The ladies appreciate their fortune in seeing the Lord and creator of the universe, Krsna, who is usually only seen by great, pure devotees and who mercifully descends to the material world in different ages. The ladies describe the glories of the land in which Krsna descends, as well as the great fortune of the wives of Sri Krsna, who so intimately relate with Him.

Verses 31-36
The Lord accepts the prayers of the ladies and leaves Hastinapura for Dvaraka.
Section Summary: Krsna's leaves Hastinapura for Dvaraka.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) The conditions of the world during the reign of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira. (1-6)
cow used to moisten the grazing ground with milk.(4)
if the Lord is pleased, every part of nature will be pleased (5)
Shyness - extra-natural beauty of the fair sex / enhances their beauty and prestige (16)
Vedic civilization allows very restricted mixing of woman and man (16)
their sincerity of purpose made them at once pure by virtue of devotion (30)
becomes master, friend, son husband to fulfill intense love of devotee concerned…(28)
svakīya, parakīya …(28)

(M&M) Lord therefore wants His bona fide representative to rule the world (2)
autocracy like Yudhiṣṭhira's by far superior to so-called democracy in which animals are killed and man less than an animal cast votes for another less-than-animal man (4)
to produce a new species of humanity at the present moment on the basis of God consciousness and perfection of human life, the ideology of godly communism, the world has to again follow in the footsteps of kings like Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira or Parīkṣit (5)

(Rea) devotional service in these three places is magnified (27)
achieve the same result as obtained during the presence of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa (27)

1.11 LORD KṚṢṆA'S ENTRANCE INTO DVĀRAKĀ

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Out of the four problems of material existence which problem gives us most trouble? (3)
2. List some of the opulence of Dvārakāpurī. (12)
3. Describe the difference between pious & impious trees. (12)
4. List the different elements of a Vedic reception. (13-18)
5. Explain how It is better that prostitutes be available in the marketplace. (19)
6. What general principle does Prabhupāda draw from the fact that the prostitutes of Dvārakā were all unalloyed devotees? (19)
7. The festivities in the temple of the Lord are like what? (24)
8. Explain how female respectability is preserved more elegantly? (24)
9. List some of the aspects of the Lord's form you find particularly attractive. (26-27)
10. List the seven mothers. (28)
11. What is the meaning of "vaibhava" (31)
12. What general principle can be drawn from the Lord marrying 16,000 wives? (31)
13. Analyze the relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His queens in Dvārakā. (36-39)

Analogies:

1.11.2: The white and fat-boweled conchshell, being gripped by the hand of Lord Kṛṣṇa and sounded by Him, appeared to be reddened by the touch of His transcendental lips. It seemed that a white swan was playing in the stems of red lotus flowers.

1.11.3: The citizens of Dvārakā were thus in a state of melancholy due to the Lord's absence from the transcendental city, as much as we are put in a state of melancholy at night because of the absence of the sun.

1.11.4: The citizens arrived before the Lord with their respective presentations, offering them to the fully satisfied and self-sufficient one, who, by His own potency, incessantly supplies others. These presentations were like the offering of a lamp to the sun.

1.11.34: The fire in the forest takes place automatically by the force of the air, and similarly the hostility between different groups of politicians takes place by the unseen design of the Lord…

1.11 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-10
Krsna reaches Dvaraka and blows His conch shell, which heralds the citizens to gather before the Lord. Various citizens offer prayers and the Lord accepts their offerings.

Verses 11-23
The beauty of Dvaraka, resplendent with natural opulence's, is described. Prior to entering Dvaraka's boundaries, the Lord accepts a reception and further reciprocates with the citizens of Dvaraka

Verses 24-29
Krsna enters the city, greets more citizens, and exchanges affection with His mothers.

Verses 30-39
Finally the Lord enters into each of His 16,108 palaces and sees each of His queens. The transcendental character of the Lord and the spiritual nature of Krsna's relationships with His queens are described.

Discussion Topics

(SC) Elements of a Vedic reception. (13-23)
The description of Dvārakā-dhāma is the ideal of human civilization. (12)
process of Vedic reception is not at all dry / like dry reception of these modern days (15)
We may not hate even the prostitutes if they are devotees of the Lord…(19)

(PrA) The relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His queens in Dvārakā. (30-39)
Married 16,000 wives - Lord is never equal to / less than human being (31)
One indirectly embraces the husband by sending the son (32)
Queens' beautiful smiles and furtive glances could not agitate senses of the Lord (36)
they accept one side of the picture while disbelieving the other (37)
He is in contact with qualities yet above actions of such qualities (38)

Lord reciprocated the service just like a devout husband……(36)
Lord was a henpecked husband → wives made to forget the immeasurable glories of Lord (39)

1.12 Birth of Emperor Parīkṣit

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What was the first sign that the age of Kali had arrived? (2)
2. List two reasons Mahārāja Parīkṣit didn't counteract the curse of the brāhmaṇa boy? (2)
3. What does Prabhupāda indicate is " perfect management of state administration"? (4)
4. How is the Lord the indirect protector of the unrighteous? (11)
5. Why is wealth distributed to the brāhmaṇas? (14)
6. For what two reasons did the Lord save Mahārāja Parīkṣit in the womb? (16)
7. How does the Lord help the conditioned souls go back to Godhead? (16)
8. Who are the three famous Bharatas? (20)
9. List 6 qualities possessed by Mahārāja Parīkṣit and who he is compared to.(19-24)
10. What is the difference between a vipra and a brāhmaṇa?
11. What is the significance of the name Parīkṣit? (30)

Analogies:

1.12 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6

The sages of Naimisaranya turn their questions back to topics about Maharaja Pariksit. Suta Gosvami explains the glories of Maharaja Yudhisthira and the glories of Maharaja Yudhisthira's reign over the earth.

Verses 7-17

Suta Gosvami explains the vision of the Lord that Maharaja Pariksit saw while still in the womb. He then narrates the birth of Maharaja Pariksit and King Yudhisthira's observance of Maharaja Pariksit's birth ceremony, which was attended by learned brahmanas who described the Lord's protection of Maharaja Pariksit.

Verses 18-29

In answer to King Yudhisthira's inquiry about how Maharaja Pariksit will compare to his ancestors, the brahmanas glorify the future qualities of Maharaja Pariksit. The brahmanas describe his future and then, after being sufficiently remunerated, return home.

Verses 30-36

Maharaja Pariksit grows, and his qualities develop under King Yudhisthira's guardianship. Maharaja Yudhisthira decides to perform a sacrifice to atone for his own sins. His brothers collect the needed money, and Yudhisthira performs the sacrifice in the presence of Lord Krsna. Following the sacrifice, Arjuna returns to Hastinapura with Krsna.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Characteristics required for a leader (4-6)
Importance of of vedic astronomical calculations in our life (12)

1.13 DHṚTARĀṢṬRA QUITS HOME

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Very briefly sketch the history of Vidura. (1)
2. Why didn't Vidura tell the Pāṇḍavas of the disappearance of the Yadu dynasty? (13)
3. Why was Yamarāja anxious to appear as Vidura? (15)
4. Who is Aryamā? (15)
5. Why did Vidura specifically mention Bhima in his criticism of Dhṛtarāṣṭra? (23)
6. What is the process of stabilizing one's renunciation? (26)
7. What are the three classes of transcendentalists? (27)
8. Explain the difference between dhīra & narottama. (28, 31)
9. Why did Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira consider himself ungrateful? (33)
10. Why is Devarṣi Nārada described herein as 'bhagavān'? (38)
11. List reasons why Gāndhārī is considered an ideal woman. (39)
12. What analogy does Nārada use to pacify Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira in verse 43?
13. Why is the example of a player suitable in this analogy? (43)
14. Give two reasons Nārada said we can't protect others? (45 and 46)
15. In what three ways does the Lord rectify the conditioned souls? (48)
16. Why wasn't Vidura able to turn Dhṛtarāṣṭra into a pure devotee? (59)

Analogies:

1.13.17: a hungry man cannot be made happy by all comforts of life minus foodstuff, so the man hungry for eternal absolute happiness cannot be satisfied by any amount of material happiness.

1.13.29: A cloud in the sky undoubtedly appears to be a reality because it rains, and due to rains so many temporary green things appear, but in the ultimate issue, everything disappears, namely the cloud, rain and green vegetation, all in due course. But the sky remains, and the varieties of sky or luminaries also remain forever. Similarly, the Absolute Truth, which is compared to the sky, remains eternally, and the temporary cloudlike illusion comes and goes away.

1.13.42: As a cow, bound through the nose by a long rope, is conditioned, so also human beings are bound by different Vedic injunctions and are conditioned to obey the orders of the Supreme

1.13 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16

Vidura returns to Hastināpura. after learning the science of the self from Maitreya Muni. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira questions Vidura about his travels. Vidura, after replying, stays in Hastināpura. for some time.

Verses 17-37

While in Hastināpura., Vidura preaches to Dhṛtarāṣṭra, his elder brother, to give up his material attachments. Vidura pushes Dhṛtarāṣṭra to leave home immediately and pursue self-realization. Dhṛtarāṣṭra finally leaves with his chaste wife (Gāndhārī,) and Vidura. When their absence is detected by King Yudhiṣṭhira, he inquires from Sanjaya, Dhṛtarāṣṭra's servant, about Dhṛtarāṣṭra's whereabouts.

Verses 38-50

Nārada Muni appears, and King Yudhiṣṭhira questions the sage.
Nārada instructs Yudhiṣṭhira about the true situation of the living entity in this world.
Nārada Muni instructs King Yudhiṣṭhira to take shelter of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Krsna, who has descended upon the earth. Nārada hints that the Lord's pastimes on this planet may be coming to an end.

Verses 51-60

Before Nārada departs, he explains that Dhṛtarāṣṭra, after going to the Ganges, will give up his body while performing mystic yoga.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Attitude to renunciation as exemplified by Dhṛtarāṣṭra (35)

(PrA) Yamarāja, being cursed by Maṇḍūka Muni, became a śūdra. (1; 15)
It is the duty of enlightened souls to deliver the fallen ones….(14)
devotee is transcendental to divisions of mundane society (15)
Dhṛtarāṣṭra's attachment (.23-25)
A sādhu is to speak to the householders about the naked truth of life ... (23)
Dhṛtarāṣṭra's practice of yoga & Gāndhārī's entering his funeral pyre. (53-57)

(M&M) there is an absolute need for the Viduras to educate such Dhṛtarāṣṭras, even at the present moment. (25)
Cheating for the satisfaction of the Lord (37)

(EvA) Vidura's dealings with the Pāṇḍavas and with Dhṛtarāṣṭra (12-23)

UNIT 4

CANTO1 CHAPTERS10 TO13

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

1. Discuss the proper attitude to renunciation as exemplified by Dhṛtarāṣṭra. How is relevant for you in your current āśrama? (13.35)

Preaching Application

2. Explain with reference to 10.28-30 &11.30-39, of the relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His queens in Dvārakā & effectively defeat the misunderstanding that Kṛṣṇa is immoral.

Mood Mission

3. Select passages from 10.1-6 reflecting Śrīla Prabhupāda's Mood and Mission. Discuss the relevance of these statements for ISKCON and for society in general.

Select only one of the following two questions.

Preaching Application

4.

a. Appropriately present the principles of shyness & gender separation, mentioned in purport to 10.16, to a modern western audience.

Evaluation

b. Compare Vidura's dealings with the Pāṇḍavas, when not disclosing the news of the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty (13.12-13), and his dealings with Dhṛtarāṣṭra when awakening him from his slumber of disease and old age (13.18-23). What general principles can be drawn from Vidura's behaviour in these instances?

UNIT 4 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Knowledge

Answer the given knowledge questions on Chapters 10-13

Understanding

Present an Overview of Chapters 9 to13 and explain the links between chapters.
Explain how the talk ladies of Hastināpura was more attractive than the hymns of the Vedas (10.20)
Explain the significance of the Lord accepting the princesses held captive by Bhaumāsura. (10.28-30)
Explain how Yamarāja, being cursed by Maṇḍūka Muni, became a śūdra. (13.1 &15)

Personal Application

Discuss the proper attitude to renunciation as exemplified by Dhṛtarāṣṭra (13.35)

Preaching Application

Summarize the conditions of the world during the reign of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira. (10.1-6)
Appropriately present the principles of shyness & gender separation, mentioned in purport to 10.16, to a modern western audience.
Present an analysis, with reference to 11.30-39, of the relationship between Kṛṣṇa and His queens in Dvārakā & effectively defeat the misunderstanding that Kṛṣṇa is immoral.
Identify reasons why Vidura was competent to occupy the post of an ācārya. (13.14-15)
Discuss general principles drawn from the example of Dhṛtarāṣṭra's attachment (13.23-25)
Discuss general principles we can learn from can we learn from Dhṛtarāṣṭra's practice of yoga & Gāndhārī's entering his funeral pyre. (13.53-57)

Theological Application

Drawing from the example of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, list characteristics required for a leader (12.4-6)
Present the value of vedic astronomical calculations in our life to a modern western audience (12.12)

Mood Mission

Select passages from 10.1-6 reflecting Śrīla Prabhupāda's Mood and Mission. Discuss the relevance of these statements for ISKCON and for society in general.
Select statements from verses 13.36-37 & 47-48 which reflect Prabhupāda's mood & Mission.
List other examples from sastra of cheating for the satisfaction of the Lord (13.37)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Present, with reference to 11.13-23, different aspects of a Vedic reception.

Evaluation

Evaluate Vidura's dealings with the Pāṇḍavas, when not disclosing the news of the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty (13.12-13), and his dealings with Dhṛtarāṣṭra when awakening him from his slumber of disease and old age (13.18-23)

Realization

Explain how Dvārakā has defeated the glories of the heavenly planets
Express appreciation of residing in the Holy Dhama (11.27)

UNIT 5
THE DISAPPEARANCE OF LORD KṚṢṆA
THE PĀṆḌAVAS RETIRE TIMELY
MAHĀRĀJA PARĪKṢIT & KALI YUGA
(CANTO 1 CHAPTERS 14-19)
SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson1

Specific texts: 14.2-20, 14.40-43, 15.5-21
Overviews of Chapter 14 & 15
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions
- Chapter 14
- Chapter 15 questions 1-4

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 15.32-51, 16.1, 16.10, 16.15
Overviews of
- Chapter 15 Verses 32-51
- Chapter 16 Verses 1-16

Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions
- Chapter 15 questions 5-13
- Chapter 16 questions 1-7

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 16.18-24, 17. 3-13, 24-31, 38-45
Overviews of
- Chapter 16 Verses 17-36
- Chapter 17

Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions
- Chapter 16 questions 2, 7-10
- Chapter 17 all questions

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 18.18-19, 18.25-37; 19.2-4
Overview of Chapter 18
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions
- Chapter 18 all questions

Lesson 5

Specific texts: 19. 25-33
Overview of Chapter 19
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions
- Chapter 19 all questions

1.14 The Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List some of the inauspicious omens noticed by Yudhiṣṭhira Mahārāja. (2-5, 12-20)
2. Why was Arjuna sent to Dvārakā? (6-8)
3. What example does Prabhupāda give for the necessity of having the Lord's sanction in achieving success? (9)
4. When a man's eyes, arms and thighs all quiver constantly, what one must know? (11)
5. Why is Balaram mentioned as "the protector of the devotees"? (29)
6. How many family members did Lord Krsna have in Dvārakā? (31)
7. What two necessities are required for a society to prosper? (34)
8. Why didn't Yudhiṣṭhira Mahārāja inquire about Lord Krsna's welfare? (34)
9. What general principles can be drawn from the Yadu's assembly house in Dvārakā? (38)
10. List some of Yudhiṣṭhira's suggested reasons for Arjuna's dejection. (40-43)
11. Which citizens are given special protection by the state? (41)
12. What is uttama and adhama? (42)
13. Explain why Karṇa was killed even by crooked means. (42)
14. The neglect of what prescribed duty of a householder is unpardonable? (43)

Analogies:

1.14.1: Therefore, during the personal presence of the Lord on the earth, all paraphernalia for our peace and prosperity, especially religion and knowledge, were in full display because of the Lord's presence, just as there is a full flood of light in the presence of the glowing sun.

1.14.33: This dependence of the liberated soul is constitutional, for the liberated souls are like sparks of a fire that are able to exhibit the glow of fire along with the fire and not independently.

1.14.34: A society devoid of cow protection and brahminical culture is not under the direct protection of the Lord, just as the prisoners in the jails are not under the protection of the king but under the protection of a severe agent of the king.

1.14.38: A forgetful, conditioned soul is fearful. But a liberated soul is never fearful, just as a small child completely dependent on the mercy of his father is never fearful of anyone.

1.14 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-21

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira sent Arjuna to Dvārakā to meet his friends and to learn from the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa of His future program of work. Seven months has past and his return to Hastināpura is over due. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, after noticing inauspicious signs, reveals to Bhīmasena his fears that Lord Krsna, upon whom the Pāṇḍavas, completely depend, has departed from this earth. King Yudhiṣṭhira describes the omens he has seen to Bhīmasena and concludes that Krsna's footprints will no longer grace this earth.

Verses 22-44

Arjuna returns from Dvārakā, and King Yudhiṣṭhira, in anxiety, questions him about the welfare of the Yadus. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira's questions turn to Arjuna's dejected countenance, and King Yudhiṣṭhira concludes that the only possible cause could be that Lord Krsna has disappeared.

Discussion Topics

PeA Any successful man should feel grateful to the Lord for all he has achieved." (9)
Transcendental affection of the Lord, does not develop unless one has developed the qualities of a brāhmaṇa. (34)

PrA The apparent departure of Lord Krsna from this world. (8)
The difference between the viṣṇu-tattva and jīva-tattva (32-33)

M&M .the powerful sun is there to distribute light in the shape of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. (2-5)

SC Inauspicious omens noticed by Yudhiṣṭhira Mahārāja (12-20)
…Children, the cow, the diseased person, the woman and the old man specifically require the protection of the state or a kṣatriya king (41)

Eva Contemporary relevance of duties of a kṣatriya in relation to Arjuna's dejection (40-42)

1.15 THE PĀṆḌAVAS RETIRE TIMELY

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List some ways the Lord perfected his mood of friendship with Arjuna? (4)
2. Why did the Lord withdraw Arjuna's special powers? (5)
3. List examples of the Lord's showing favor to Arjuna & the Pāṇḍavas. (7-18)
4. Explain how the cowherd men were able to defeat Arjuna. (20)
5. How is an action judged? (24)
6. How was Arjuna's mind pacified? (28)
7. How did Sūta Gosvāmī give relief to the sages of Naimiṣāraṇya in reference to the disappearance of the Yadu dynasty? (34)
8. In what way is the Lord like a magician? (35)
9. How can one neutralize the effects of kali? (36)
10. Explain what lessons can be drawn from Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira retirement? (37-44)
11. Why was the King of Hastināpura accepted as the Emperor of the world? (38)
12. Explain the difference between the Pāṇḍavas and Vidura (49)

Analogies:

1.15. 21: All electrical energies are received from the powerhouse, and as soon as the powerhouse stops supplying energy, the bulbs are of no use. In a moment's time such energies can be generated or withdrawn by the supreme will of the Lord.

1.15. 21: Material civilization without the blessing of the Lord is child's play only. As long as the parents allow the child to play, it is all right. As soon as the parents withdraw, the child has to stop.

1.15. 32: He is like the sun. The sun appears and disappears on its own accord at any place without disturbing its presence in other places.

1.15. 50: When flying an airplane, one cannot take care of other planes. Everyone has to take care of his own plane, and if there is any danger, no other plane can help another in that condition. Similarly, at the end of life, when one has to go back home, back to Godhead, everyone has to take care of himself without help rendered by another.

1.15 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-17

Arjuna, grief-stricken and overwhelmed, could hardly utter a word in reply to Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira's inquiries. Arjuna remembers Kṛṣṇa and begins explaining that Kṛṣṇa, his dear friend, is now lost to him. Arjuna retells incidents in which Kṛṣṇa empowered and protected him and the other Pāṇḍavas.

Verses 18-31

Arjuna speaks about the intimacy of his relationship with Kṛṣṇa and how, in the absence of Kṛṣṇa, he has lost his powers and has been defeated by some insignificant cowherd men. Arjuna relates to Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira the news of the destruction of the Yadu dynasty. Feeling great grief, Arjuna remembers Kṛṣṇa's instructions in the Bhagavad-gītā and becomes situated in transcendence, beyond the modes of material nature.

Verses 32-44

After hearing from Arjuna, about Kṛṣṇa's returning to His abode, and upon understanding the end of the Yadu dynasty's earthly manifestation King Yudhiṣṭhira and Kunti decided to retire. Understanding that Kali has entered, Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira enthrones Mahārāja Parīkṣit as emperor. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira dressed himself in torn clothing, gave up eating all solid foods, voluntarily became dumb and let his hair hang loose. He did not depend on his brothers for anything. And, just like a deaf man, he heard nothing. to devote himself completely to the thought of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He then started towards the north to devote himself completely to the thought of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Verses 45-51

The younger brothers of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira seeing that the age of Kali had already arrived decided to follow in the footsteps of their elder brother. They attained the abode of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa in their very same bodies. After describing how the departure of Vidura at Prabhāsa and hw he returned to his original post, the chapter ends with a benediction.

Discussion Topics

PeA

Arjuna took shelter of the instructions of the Bhagavad-gītā. (27-32)
Everyone has to take care of his own plane (50)

PrA endowment of powers and withdrawal of powers by the Lord (5, 21)
Transcendental acting of the Lord with a pure, unalloyed devotee like Arjuna.(.17)
The Lord relishes reproaches of friends.. more than the Vedic hymns (19)
The entrance of the age of Kali (36-37)
Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira exemplary retirement (37-40)
The Pāṇḍavas attained the abode of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa in their very same bodies. (43-51)

1.16 How Parīkṣit Received the Age of Kali

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List three characteristics of the King's advisors. (1)
2. List symptoms of the age of Kali (4, 10, 19-22)
3. Describe the connection between brahminical culture and cow protection. (4, 18)
4. Why it is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa has lotus feet? (6)
5. What is the surest remedy for avoiding death? (7)
6. Describe the difference between welcome addresses today and in those days (16)
7. What do the bull and cow symbolize? (18)
8. Give two reasons why offering sacrifice is recommended in the scriptures. (20)
9. What is the first attack on the Varṇāśrama system? (31)
10. Why were the Earth's feelings of separation more acute than the Lord's queens? (35)

Analogies:

1.16.2: The kings used to spend lavishly during such sacrifices, as a cloud distributes rains. A cloud is nothing but another form of water, or, in other words, the waters of the earth transform into clouds. Similarly, the charity made by the kings in such sacrifices are but another form of the taxes collected from the citizens.

1.16.10: In the rainy season, rain is predestined, and yet people take precautions to protect themselves. Similarly, in the age of Kali the symptoms as above mentioned are sure to infiltrate into social life, but it is the duty of the state to save the citizens from the association of the agents of the age of Kali.

1.16.20: The demigods are pleased when such sacrifices are performed, just as prison officers are satisfied when the prisoners are turned into obedient subjects.

1.16 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-9

Sūta Gosvāmī describes Mahārāja Parīkṣit welfare state reigning under the guidance of the brāhmaṇas. Once, when Mahārāja Parīkṣit was touring the state he saw the master of Kali-yuga, who was lower than a śūdra, disguised as a king and hurting the legs of a cow and bull. The King at once caught hold of him to deal sufficient punishment. (4) Śaunaka Rsi inquires about the punishment of Kali and explains the glories of hearing about topics relating to Kṛṣṇa.

Verses 10-16

Sūta Gosvāmī, to further explaining the above incident, relates that after Mahārāja Parīkṣit perceives the influence of the age of Kali within his kingdom, he initiates a tour. While touring, Maharaja Parīkṣit hears the glories of his great relatives, the Pāṇḍavas.

Verses 17-36

While Mahārāja Parīkṣit was passing his days hearing of the good occupations of his forefathers and being absorbed in thought of them, the personality of religious principles, Dharma, was wandering about in the form of a bull and he met the personality of earth, Dharaṇy, in the form of a cow . She appeared to grieve like a mother who had lost her child. Dharma questions the earth (19-24) about the cause of the earth's miserable condition, referring to the degraded conditions of Kali-yuga. The earth replies (25-35) that the cause of her misery is separation from Kṛṣṇa and by an increase of Kali's influence due to Kṛṣṇa's absence. King Parīkṣit then arrives.

Discussion Topics

PrA ‘Welfare state in the real sense of the term’ (1)
The root cause of mismanagement and quarrel in the age of Kali (4)
The difference between welcome addresses today and in those days (16)
The unfathomable transcendental qualities of the Lord (26-30)

SC Symptom of the age of Kali (4, 10, 19-22)

MM Movement of pure devotees all over world can change troublesome face of world (32)

1.17 Punishment and Reward of Kali

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Identify the principal signs of the age of Kali? (1-3)
2. What is the meaning of Prajā? (10)
3. Describe the prime duty of the state. (14)
4. Explain the concept of āpad-dharma (16)
5. Describe a devotee's attitude toward suffering (18)
6. List the four principles of religion in English & Sanskrit. (24)
7. List the activities that destroy the principles of religion (24-25, 38)
8. Describe what should be the state's the attitude toward religion? (32)
9. Where did Kali receive permission to reside? (38-39)
10. Explain why the scriptures allow meat eating and intoxication? (38)

Analogies:

1.17.10: When there is some disturbance caused by wild animals in a village or town, the police or others take action to kill them. Similarly, it is the duty of the government to kill at once all bad social elements such as thieves, dacoits and murderers.

1.17.24: Moths are captivated by the glaring brightness of light, and thus they become prey to the fire. Similarly, the deluding energy is always captivating the conditioned souls to become prey to the fire of delusion.

1.17.28: In the rainy season certainly there will be profuse rainfalls, but that does not mean that men should not take means to protect themselves from the rains. It is the duty of the executive heads of state and others to take all necessary actions against the activities of Kali or the persons influenced by the age of Kali;

1.17 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16

Mahārāja Parīkṣit arrives and witnesses the scene first described in verse 4 of Chapter 16. Mahārāja Parīkṣit challenges and threatens the śūdra (4-6), dressed like a king, beating a cow and a bull with a club. Mahārāja Parīkṣit then (7-16) questions the cow and the bull why they are grieving with tears in their eyes. Who has cut off your three legs? Parīkṣi requests, “Please tell me of the perpetrator of these mutilations.”

Verses 17-28

The bull answers Maharaja's inquiries about the cause of his difficulties without identifying a perpetrator. After hearing the bull's reply, Mahārāja Parīkṣit recognizes the bull as the personality of religion and replied, “In the age of Satya your four legs were established by the four principles of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, but it appears that three of your legs are broken due to rampant irreligion in the form of pride, lust for women, and intoxication.You are now standing on one leg only, which is your truthfulness. Mahārāja Parīkṣit thus took up his sharp sword to kill the personality of Kali.

Verses 29-45

Whilst Mahārāja Parīkṣit prepares to kill Kali, Kali at once abandoned the dress of a king and completely surrenders to him. Mahārāja Parīkṣit spares Kali's life but banishes him. Kali then requests a place where he can fearlessly live. Mahārāja Parīkṣit gives Kali permission to dwell in five places-where gambling, drinking, prostitution, and animal slaughter take place, and where gold is hoarded-all places with which brāhmaṇas and sannyasis should never come in contact. Mahārāja Parīkṣit drives Kali from his kingdom, re-establishes religion and begins his reign.

Discussion Topics

PeA Devotees tolerate sufferings, thinking them to be God-given in small doses (18)
The destination intended for the perpetrator is also intended for the identifier (22)
4 leaders of the human society…must be tested crucially by character& qualification (41)

PrA **Principle** symptoms of the Age of Kali (1-3)
duties executed by the Lord for His devotee are always very pleasing to the Lord (17)
The question of who is responsible for our suffering (18-22)

M&M See the cows and the bulls happy in all respects (3)
Educate people systematically in teaching of Bhāgavatam (24, 27)
Be ready with sharp swords to kill the persons creating corruptions (28)
Friends of irreligiosity should be banished from the state (31)
Guidelines for the state which wants to eradicate corruption (38)
Purge out from state all activities of immorality introduced by the personality of Kali (44)
Without state support, no … religious principles can progressively advance (45)

1.18 Mahārāja Parīkṣit Cursed by a Brāhmaṇa Boy

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Describe Mahārāja Parīkṣit's attitude in response to being cursed. (2, 48)
2. What is the technique for driving away Kali? (6)
3. List some of the great advantages of the age of Kali (7)
4. Give one evidence that personalism is higher than impersonalism (16)
5. Give proof that the caste system by birth was not practiced in the puranic period. (18)
6. What argument do the dvija bandhus give to support the caste system? (19)
7. Explain the reasons for Mahārāja Parīkṣit to become fatigued..(25)
8. Describe the Vedic principles for receiving a guest (28)
9. Who is beyond the jurisdiction of punishment? (29)
10. Explain how the age of Kali was able to enter. (32-37)
11. Why did the Lord arrange for a young boy to commit the offense? (47)

Analogies:

1.18.12: They were factually perceiving the result of hearing these transcendental activities. One can feel this practically, as one can feel the result of eating food.

1.18.22: Haṁsas, or swans, accept only milk out of a mixture of milk and water. Similarly, those who accept the service of the Lord instead of māyā's service are called the paramahaṁsas.

1.18.23: As the birds fly in the sky as far as their capacity allows, so do the learned devotees describe the Lord as far as their realization allows.

1.18 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-9

Sūta Gosvāmī describes Mahārāja Parīkṣit's attitude in response to being cursed, his surrender to Śukadeva and his dealing with personality of Kali.

Verses 10-23

The sages of Naimiṣāraṇya express their frustration with the 1000 year sacrificial performance they underwent. They explain how their bodies have become black from the smoke. They glorify Sūta Gosvāmī and the value of hearing about Krsna from great devotees and request him to describe the pastimes of the Lord.

Verses 24-31

Sūta Gosvāmī narrates how Mahārāja Parīkṣit while engaged in hunting in the forest became extremely fatigued. While searching for water, he entered the hermitage of Śamīka Ṛṣi who was sitting silently in meditation. Not being received by the Ṛṣi, Parīkṣit Mahārāja, by the will of the Lord, became angry. The King thought that the sage, who had coldly received him, thus should be coldly rewarded so he garlanded the Ṛṣi with a dead snake.

Verses 32-50

Samika Rsi's son, Srngi, after hearing about his father being insulted, impudently curses Mahārāja Parīkṣit to die in seven days being bitten by a snake-bird. Samika Rsi laments when he hears what his son has done and accepts responsibility for the injustice towards Mahārāja Parīkṣit. Samika Rsi prays to the Supreme Lord to forgive his son's foolishness.

Discussion Topics

PeA anything sent by God is a blessing for the devotee (2)
Reasons for Mahārāja Parīkṣit to become fatigued (25, 29, and 31)
Lord creates awkward positions for devotees in order to drag them towards Himself (29)
Repentance comes mind of good soul as soon as he commits something wrong (18.31)

PrA Great advantages of the age of Kali (7)
Sages of Naimiṣāraṇya bodies have become black from the smoke (12)
Vedic principles for receiving a guest (28)
Hatred of the lower orders of life began from this brāhmaṇa boy (32)
Downfall of the brahminical powers .. importance to birthright without culture (33)
Personality of Kali found a hole in the puffed-up, inexperienced son of a brāhmaṇa (35)

M&M Purify the whole atmosphere … send qualified preachers all over the world (18)
Chanting of the holy name can deliver one from the disadvantages of low birth (19)

1.19 THE APPEARANCE OF ŚUKADEVA GOSVĀMĪ

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What is the process for being delivered from accidental sins? (1)
2. Why didn't Maharaj Pariksit ask to be pardoned? (4)
3. In the Varāha Purāṇa what is mentioned about the Ganges and the Yamunā? (6)
4. How can the first-grade be offender is excused? (11)
5. Why did the King inform the sages of his decision to fast till death? (12)
6. How do the demigods feel in seeing someone go back to Godhead? (18)
7. To whom did Mahārāja Parīkṣit give up the imperial throne? (20)
8. Why is there both nothing to be lamented, every reason to be sorry, with a devotee's departure? (21)
9. What two questions does the King ask the sages? (24)
10. Describe how householders should feel when sages appear at their doors. (33)

Analogies:

1.19.16: As a good son of the father behaves in a friendly way with all his other brothers, so also the devotee of the Lord, being a good son of the supreme father, Lord Kṛṣṇa, sees all other living beings in relation with the supreme father.

1.19.23: In the material world these attributes (up to seventy-eight percent of the Lord's attributes) are covered by the material energy, as the sun is covered by a cloud. The covered strength of the sun is very dim, compared to the original glare, and similarly the original color of the living beings with such attributes becomes almost extinct.

1.19.25: As doctors differ, so also sages differ in their different prescriptions.

1.19.30: Śukadeva Gosvāmī was then surrounded by saintly sages and demigods just as the moon is surrounded by stars, planets and other heavenly bodies.

1.19 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-7
Mahārāja Parīkṣit laments that he insulted the sage. Mahārāja Parīkṣit could have gone to the muni to beg his pardon, but the news of imminent death was conveyed to the King with so much regret by the muni that the King did not want to shame the muni further by his presence there. He decided to prepare himself for his imminent death. Fasting, he sat down at the bank of the Ganges and gave himself up to the lotus feet of the Lord.

Verses 8-24
Many rsis arrive. Mahārāja Parīkṣit welcomes them, by bowing his head to the ground, and tells them of his decision to fast until death. The demigods scattered flowers over the earth and beat celestial drums and the sages glorify the king's decision.Mahārāja Parīkṣit inquiries from the sages of the duty of everyone in all circumstances, and specifically of those who are about to die.

Verses 25-40
The great sages were not unanimous in their response to these questions. Then Śukadeva Gosvāmī, inspired by Lord Kṛṣṇa, approached the assembly.Śukadeva, was only sixteen years old and he did not manifest any symptoms of belonging to any social order or status of life. He was surrounded with women and children. He was naked and his bodily hue resembled that of Lord Kṛṣṇa. On Śukadeva Gosvāmī's arrival at the meeting, everyone, except Vyāsadeva, Nārada and a few others, stood up. Śukadeva was offered the presidential seat at the meeting. The King thus questioned the sage, using sweet language about the duty of one about to die.

Discussion Topics

PeA sins unwillingly committed by a devotee are burnt in the fire of repentance. (1)
Family members of a devotee share the effects of a devotee's service unto the Lord. (2)
Any decision, however important, should be confirmed by some authority (12)
A householder who dishonors such holy orders is a great offender (33)

PrA A person can be older by experience and not by age (Śukadeva) (26)
One can render better service to the family by becoming a devotee of the Lord (35)
Question of Mahārāja Parīkṣit is basic principle of complete thesis of Bhāgavatam (37)

AMI For a devotee.. two things are strictly prohibited: worldly enjoyers and women. (32)
The devotee has no need to bother about his family members (35)

UNIT 5
CANTO1 CHAPTERS 14 TO 19

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

Choose one of the following two questions:

1.
   a. Discuss a devotee's attitude toward suffering, with reference to the response of Dharma (17.18). How can you personally apply these principles?

   b. Draw general principles from, and explain the personal relevance of, the example of Mahārāja Parīkṣit's attitude in response to being cursed. (18.2, 48, 19.2-4).

Preaching Application

Choose one of the following two questions:

2.
   a. Draw lessons, applicable for preaching, from Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira retirement (15.37-40)

   b. Describe the connection between brahminical culture and cow protection (16.4, 16.18). How is this relevant for ISKCON?

Mood & Mission

3. Explain how the age of Kali was able to enter with reference to 15.32-37 & 18.32-37. Summarize Prabhupāda's guidelines to defeat the Kali, and bring about peace and harmony in human society, with reference to Chapter 17.

UNIT 5 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present overviews of Chapters 14 -19, with connecting links between chapters

Personal Application

Reflect on the importance of developing the qualities of a brāhmaṇa (14.34)
Discuss relevance of Prabhupada's comment "Everyone has to take care of his own plane" (15.50)
Discuss a devotee's attitude toward suffering, with reference to the response of Dharma (17.18).
Draw general principles from and explain the personal relevance of the examples of:

a. Mahārāja Parīkṣit becoming fatigued etc. (18.25, 29, 31)
b. Mahārāja Parīkṣit's attitude in response to being cursed. (18.2, 48, 19.2-4).

Discuss the personal relevance of:

- How householders should feel when sages appear at their doors. (19.33)
- How can the first-grade be offender is excused (19.11)
- Why the King discussed with the sages of his decision to fast till death. (19.12)

Preaching Application

Discuss the apparent departure of Krsna (14.8, 15.32)
List examples of the Lord's showing favor to Arjuna & the Pāṇḍavas. (15.7-18)
Explain the transcendental acting of the Lord with a pure devotee like Arjuna (15.17-19)
Present the concept that "without the Lord's benediction no one is successful simply by personal labor…" citing examples and analogies from 14.9, 15.5 & 15.21, with reference to the endowment and withdrawal of powers by the Lord upon Arjuna.
Draw lessons from Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira exemplary retirement (15.37-40)
Explain the 'welfare state in the real sense' and compare this with modern day states (16.1)
Describe the connection between brahminical culture and cow protection (16.4, 16.18)
List the 4 principles of religion & the activities that destroy them (17.25, 38)
List Advantages of the age of Kali (18.7)
Discuss the sages of Naimiṣāraṇya feelings about their performance of yajña (18.12-13)
Present the Vedic principles of receiving a guest (18.28)
Draw general principles, applicable for preaching, from the arrival of Śukadeva Gosvāmī (19.25-31)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

List some of the inauspicious omens noticed by Yudhiṣṭhira Mahārāja and discuss those which are commonly seen in modern times. (14.3-5, 14.12-20)
List the general symptoms of the Age of Kali from Chapters 16 & 17

Evaluation

Comment on the contempory relevance of the duties of a kṣatriya as inferred by Yudhiṣṭhira in relation to Arjuna's apparent dejection (14.40-42).

Mood & Mission

Discuss how Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam can remove the anomalies in human society (14.2-5)
Present an outline of Prabhupāda's guidelines to defeat the Kali, and bring about peace and harmony in human society, in Chapter 17, and describe what they can personally do to execute this mission.
Explain how the age of Kali was able to enter (15.32-37;18.32-37)
Discuss the relevance for ISKCON of the example of the brāhmaṇa boy curising Parīkṣit.
Discuss what we can personally do to protect yourself from the influence of Kali.

UNIT 6
PRAYERS OF ŚUKADEVA GOSVĀMĪ
& THE UNIVERSAL FORM
(CANTO 2 CHAPTERS 1 – 7)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1
Specific texts: 1.1-12

Lesson 2
Specific texts: Overview of Chapters 1 & 2
2.3-5, 2.18-28,

Lesson 3
Specific texts: Overview of Chapter 3
3.1-10, 3.17-28

Lesson 4
Specific texts: Overview of Chapters 4-5
4.17-18

Lesson 5
Specific texts: Overview of Chapters 6-7
6.6, 6.20, 7.6, 7.38, 7.51-53

2

2.1 THE FIRST STEP IN GOD REALIZATION

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1 What was Mahārāja Parīkṣit's question? (1.19.37-38) Why is it described as loka-hitaṁ? (1)
2 Describe at least 5 symptoms of gṛhamedhīs. (2-4)
3 Remembering the Personality of Godhead is recommended. What are the benefits? What is achieved? (5-6)
4 For what reasons does Śukadeva Gosvāmī cite his own life's example? (8-9)
5 What is the significance of the story of Mahārāja Khaṭvāṅga? (12-13)
6 Briefly describe the process of detachment recommended by Śukadeva Gosvāmī. (14-19)

Analogies:

2.1.1: The topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa are so auspicious that they purify the speaker, the hearer and the inquirer. They are compared to the Ganges waters, which flow from the toe of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Wherever the Ganges waters go, they purify the land and the person who bathes in them.

2.1.4: The great ocean of material nature is tossing with the waves of time, and the so-called living conditions are something like foaming bubbles, which appear before us as bodily self, wife, children, society, countrymen, etc.

2.1.8: One has to be admitted to the medical college and study the books under the guidance of learned professors. Similarly, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, the postgraduate study of the science of Godhead, can only be learned by studying it at the feet of a realized soul like Śrīla Vyāsadeva.

2.1.15: After death one forgets everything about the present bodily relations; we have a little experience of this at night when we go to sleep. While sleeping, we forget everything about this body and bodily relations, although this forgetfulness is a temporary situation for only a few hours.

2.1 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6

Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes Mahārāja Parīkṣit's question as glorious and beneficial to all. People who are too attached to materialistic life and family are *gṛhamedhī*s. He describes their symptoms and then points out one's actual duty, to hear about, glorify and also remember the Personality of Godhead. This will lead to perfection of life.

Verses 7-13

Śukadeva Gosvāmī cites his own life as an example to demonstrate how even the topmost transcendentalists take pleasure in describing the glories of the Lord. Śukadeva Gosvāmī will now recite that very Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam he heard from his father for Mahārāja Parīkṣit. He recommends the process of constant chanting of the holy name of the Lord for all, whether free from desires, desirous or self-satisfied, and cites the story of Mahārāja Khaṭvāṅga to demonstrate that even a moment of full consciousness can bring perfection of life.

Verses 14-21

Śukadeva Gosvāmī recommends detachment from material life and fear of death. One should leave home and practice self-control in a sacred place, bathing regularly. Sitting alone, one should chant the *praṇava* mantra (*oṁkāra*), and the mind will become progressively spiritualised. Thereafter, one can progress to meditation on the form of Viṣṇu and come to the level of devotional service.

Verses 22-39

In answer to Mahārāja Parīkṣit's inquiry regarding how and where to fix the mind so that it can become purified of 'dirty things', Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes meditation on the gross universal form of the Lord, because there is nothing more than this in the material world. One who does not concentrate his mind upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead will be misled and will cause his own degradation.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Qualifications for hearing Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1, 5-10)
Avoiding the offenses in hearing and chanting. (11)

(PrA) The position of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (8)
Aṣṭāṅga-yoga may lead to bhakti (16-18)

(M&M) Many subjects for hearing (2)

(TA) Taste for hari-kathā (3-4)

2.2 THE LORD IN THE HEART

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why are the Vedic sounds described as bewildering? (2)
2. List those things Śukadeva Gosvāmī recommends to save us from endeavouring for unwanted things? (4-5)
3. What is the first duty of a person in the renounced order of life? (5)
4. Give a brief description of the Paramātmā or Supersoul. (8-12)
5. Briefly describe the yogic process of leaving the body when one likes. Why does this process supersede chosen times in Bhagavad-gītā 8.23-26? (15-21)
6. What are the special qualities of Satyaloka? (26-28)
7. How does one purify the polluted aim of life? (37)
8. Write a brief overview of the chapter.

Analogies

2.2.7: In the Vedas it is said that persons who are attached to demigods to the exclusion of the Supreme Personality of Godhead are like the animals who follow the herdsman even though they are taken to the slaughterhouse.

2.2.12: As a person feels his hunger satisfied after eating each morsel of foodstuff, he must similarly be able to see the degree to which he has been freed from sex desire.

2.2.27: It is said that one should become a brāhmaṇa before one can understand the Vedic statements, and this stricture is as important as the stricture that no one shall become a lawyer who has not qualified himself as a graduate.

2.2.31: The impersonalists… may be compared to certain species of fish, who, being born in the rivers and rivulets, migrate to the great ocean. They cannot stay in the ocean indefinitely, for their urge for sense gratification brings them back to the rivers and streams to spawn.

2.2 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-7

Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes the futility of fruitive endeavour. The conditioned souls hover in dreams of such heavenly illusory pleasures, but actually they do not relish any tangible happiness. He thus recommends that the necessities of life be kept at a bare minimum so that one can become fixed in devotional service, by which one can end the conditioned state of existence.

Verses 8-14

The Lord in the heart is described. The process of meditation should begin from the lotus feet of the Lord and progress to His smiling face. This gradual process will purify the intelligence. The *virāṭ-rūpa* meditation (2.1.22-39) is a prerequisite to meditation on the personal form for those who have not yet developed a sense of loving service unto the Supreme Lord.

Verses 15-32

Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes how the a successful *bhakti-yogī* who is able to quit his body as he likes can purify himself of material gross and subtle bodies, extinguishing all material desires. After pushing his life air through the cerebral hole and gradually ascending through the higher planets, he can at last pierce the outer coverings of the universe and enter into the kingdom of God. This process was described personally by Lord Kṛṣṇa unto Brahmā.

Verses 33-37

Śukadeva Gosvāmī recommends direct devotional service (*bhakti-yoga*) as the most auspicious means of deliverance for those who are wandering in the material universe. He explains that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Supersoul, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and that devotional service to Him is the perfection of religion; therefore, one should hear about, glorify and remember the Supreme Lord.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Paramātmā darśana (8-12, 35)

(SC) World of names (3, 7)

(Eva) minimum necessities of life (3-5)

(TA) the importance of relishing (36-37)

2.3 PURE DEVOTIONAL SERVICE: THE CHANGE IN HEART

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List five of the various demigods worshipped for material desires and the respective results of such worship. (2-9)
2. What are the gains of worshipping the Supreme Personality of Godhead rather than the demigods? (9-12)
3. List similarities and differences between Mahārāja Parīkṣit and Śukadeva Gosvāmī. (15-16)
4. List and explain five of the analogies that Śaunaka Ṛṣi gives to condemn those who are averse to devotional service. (17-24)

Analogies:

2.3.17: As a highly potent drug injected intravenously acts at once on the whole body, the transcendental topics of the Lord injected through the ear of the pure devotee of the Lord can act very efficiently…

2.3.19: Men who are like dogs, hogs, camels and asses… p. the so-called educated persons move like dogs from door to door with applications for some service… Persons who have no discrimination in the matter of foodstuff and who eat all sorts of rubbish are compared to hogs… The thorns, mixed with fresh blood, create a taste for the foolish camel. Similarly, the great business magnates… eat the thorny results of their actions mixed with their own blood... In this age the human being is actually engaged in the work of an ass.

2.3.20: …considered to possess earholes like the holes of snakes and a tongue like the tongue of a frog. p The human tongue is especially given for chanting the Vedic hymns and not for croaking like frogs.. Similarly, the tongue… will be considered a prostitute when engaged in chanting some mundane nonsense.

2.3.21: The upper portion of the body, though crowned with a silk turban, is only a heavy burden if not bowed down before the Personality of Godhead… And the hands... are like those of a dead man if not engaged in the service of the Personality of Godhead Hari.

2.3.22: The eyes which do not look at the symbolic representations of the Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu… are like those printed on the plumes of the peacock, and the legs which do not move to the holy places… are considered to be like tree trunks.

2.3 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-12

Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes benefits of worshipping various demigods to fulfil various material desires, but he recommends that a person of intelligence, whether full of material desire, without material desire, or desiring liberation, should worship the Personality of Godhead. Only by the association of the pure devotee of the Lord can one achieve the highest perfectional benediction, which is unflinching attraction for the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Verses 13-16

Śaunaka Ṛṣi implores Sūta Gosvāmī to continue narrating the dialogue about the Supreme Lord between Śukadeva Gosvāmī and Mahārāja Parīkṣit. Mahārāja Parīkṣit was a great devotee of the Lord from his very birth, and so was Śukadeva Gosvāmī. When such devotees are assembled together, there can be no topics save discussions of the glories of the Lord, or *bhakti-yoga*.

Verses 17-25

Both by rising and by setting, the sun decreases the duration of life of everyone, except one who utilizes the time by discussing topics of the all-good Personality of Godhead. Śaunaka Ṛṣi gives many analogies to support his appeal that engagement in the service of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is the only beneficial activity for a human being, and that all other occupation places one as either animalistic or lifeless.

Discussion Topics

(Und) nitya-siddhas & sādhana-siddhas (15)

(PeA) the importance of sādhu-saṅga by means of hari-kathā. (14)

(PrA) Kṛṣṇa is superior to the devas (1-11)
'sun fails to rob the pure devotee of his duration of life'…(17)

(SC) hogs, dogs, camels & asses (19-23)
Śaunaka ṛṣi's analysis of neglect devotional practices. (17-28)

(M&M) people of the world should be taught to hear transcendental topics.. devotee of the Lord must speak loudly so that they can hear." (20)

2.4 The Process of Creation

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain why the word satīm applies well to Mahārāja Parīkṣit. (1)
2. Explain how Mahārāja Parīkṣit was able to give up all family attachments and the regulated activities of religion, economic development and sense gratification. (2-4)
3. Why does Mahārāja Parīkṣit ask about the process of creation? (6-10)
4. Analyze the prayers of Śukadeva Gosvāmī. (12-24)

Analogies:

2.4.5: When a hungry man is given food to eat, he feels satiation of hunger and the pleasure of dining simultaneously. Thus he does not have to ask whether he has actually been fed or not. The crucial test of hearing Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is that one should get positive enlightenment by such an act.

2.4.6: The common man also knows that the creation is made by some creator and is not created automatically. We have no experience in the practical world that a thing is created automatically. Foolish people say that the creative energy is independent and acts automatically, as electrical energy works. But the intelligent man knows that even the electrical energy is generated by an expert engineer in the localized powerhouse

2.4.10: The expansions of different forms of the Lord, as from Kṛṣṇa to Baladeva to Saṅkarṣaṇa, … and innumerable other forms, which are compared to the constant flowing of the uncountable waves of a river, are all one and the same. They are like lamps of equal power which kindle from one lamp to another

2.4 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-4

Sūta Gosvāmī describes how Mahārāja Parīkṣit, who had a natural attraction for Lord Kṛṣṇa, fixed his mind upon Him with rapt attention, giving up all family attachments and the regulated activities of religion, economic development and sense gratification, after hearing from Śukadeva Gosvāmī.

Verses 5-10

Mahārāja Parīkṣit praises Śukadeva Gosvāmī because he is without material contamination and is narrating the topics of the Lord. He then inquires about the Personality of Godhead creative activities by His different energies and expansions. He concludes by praising the transcendental activities of the Lord, and Śukadeva Gosvāmī who, being a great devotee of the Lord, is therefore as good as the Personality of Godhead.

Verses 11-25

Śukadeva Gosvāmī glorifies Lord Kṛṣṇa and prays for the ability to answer Mahārāja Parīkṣit's inquiry. Then he begins to describe a conversation between Nārada Muni and Lord Brahmā.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Vaiṣṇavas must be keenly interested in His pastimes in connection with sṛṣṭi-tattva" (10)

(M&M) leadership of world affairs is entrusted to the devotees of the Lord (17-18)
A Vaiṣṇava, therefore, can accept disciple from any part of the world (17-18)

2.5 THE CAUSE OF ALL CAUSES

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What makes Nārada wonder about the existence of someone more powerful than Lord Brahmā (5-7)?
2. Explain the analogy of “the frog in the well” logic (10)
3. What is the meaning of sva-rociṣā, and what is its role in the creation as described in this verse?
4. Compare the description of the deluding energy given in verse 13 with that in 1.7.4-5 (13).
5. At what point is kāla (eternal time) manifested. What is its role? (22)
6. What is tan-mātrā? (25)
7. Describe the transformations from the modes of ignorance, goodness and passion (25-31).
8. Name the fourteen planetary systems (39-41, 2.1.26-28).

Analogies:

2.5.5: The best example of self-sufficiency is the sun. The sun does not require to be illuminated by any other body… Nārada compared the position of Brahmā to the self-sufficiency of the spider, who creates its own field of activities without any other's help by employment of its own energetic creation of saliva.

2.5.10: “The frog in the well” logic illustrates that a frog residing in the atmosphere and boundary of a well cannot imagine the length and breadth of the gigantic ocean… Similarly, the material scientists also want to challenge the inconceivable potency of the Lord by measuring Him with their froglike brains and their scientific achievements…

2.5.11: Just as the small seed of a banyan fruit has the potency to create a big banyan tree, the Lord disseminates all varieties of seeds by His potential brahmajyoti (sva-rociṣā), and the seeds are made to develop by the watering process of persons like Brahmā… just as a gardener helps plants and orchards to grow by the watering process.

2.5.18: In other words, the material modes of nature, being products of the energy of the Lord, are certainly connected with the Lord, but the connection is just like that between the master and the servants.

2.5.21: As the rainy season appears and disappears regularly, the creation takes place and is again annihilated under the control of the Lord.

2.5 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-13
Nārada Muni questions Lord Brahma about the phenomenal world, its creation, and Brahma's own position. When Nārada realizes that Brahma attained his creative energy through the performance of austerities, he asks Brahma if someone exists who is more powerful than Brahma and from whom Brahma received his powers. Brahma thus explains how the living entity becomes bewildered about the identity of the Supreme Creator.

Verses 14-31
Lord Brahma explains that Lord Narayana is the Supreme Lord. Lord Brahma explains how the material world manifests in perpetual reactions from Maha-Visnu.

Verses 32-45
Lord Brahma explains how the Lord manifests again as Garbhodakasayi Visnu to animate the creation and to assume the universal form, on which the fourteen planetary systems are situated.

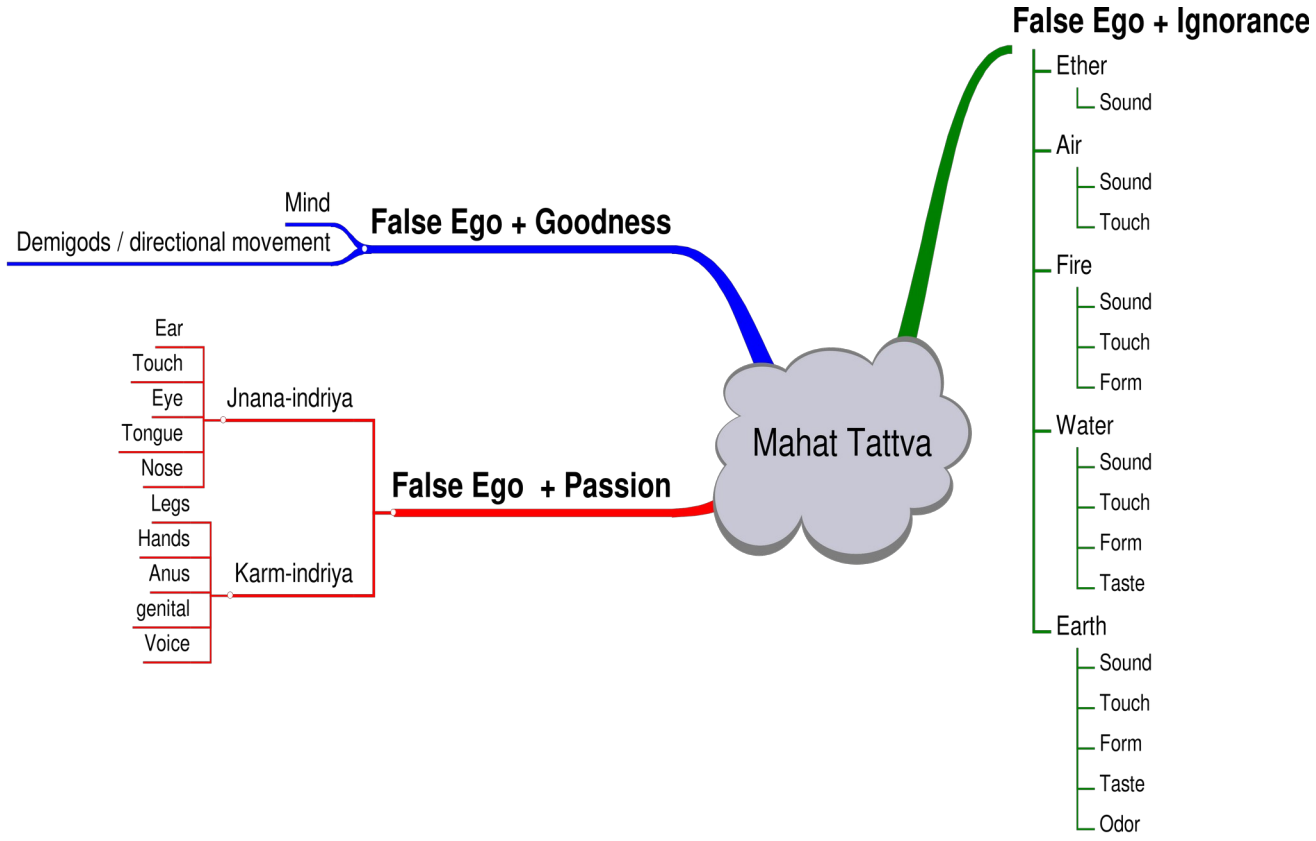
Discussion Topics

(Und) Creation of: 25. Elements / 26-29. Sense objects / 30-31. Mind & Senses (24-32)
Creation of Universes…(33-42)
Description of Planetary Systems as Virāṭ-rūpa…(38-42.)

(PeA) "Lord will empower the doer in proportion to his surrender" (17)

(PrA) frog in the well analogy (10)

INGREDIENTS OF CREATION (5. 22-32)



2.6 PURUṢA-SŪKTA CONFIRMED

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What is the significance of the virāṭ-puruṣa's arms? (6)
2. Where are the centres for inauspicious and irreligious activities on the virāṭ-puruṣa? (9-10)
3. Give a brief comparison of the one fourth and three fourths energies of the Lord (19-20)
4. To perform a sacrifice successfully, at least four expert priests are needed. What are their roles? (25)
5. What is the import of *hṛdautkaṇṭhyavatā*? (34-35)
6. List some of the qualities of the Personality of Godhead and His puruṣaḥ incarnation (39-45)
7. Why is Lord Brahmā going to relate stories of the Lord's līlā-avatāras to Nārada? (46)

Analogies:

2.6.6: The obedient son of the father never goes against the will of the father and therefore passes life very peacefully in concurrence with the head of the family, the father. Similarly, the Lord being the father, all living beings should fully and satisfactorily discharge the duty and will of the father, as faithful sons.

2.6.17: The sun illuminates both internally and externally by expanding its radiation; similarly, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by expanding His universal form, maintains everything in the creation both internally and externally.

2.6.22: The ekapād-vibhūti manifestation of the material energy of the Lord is just like one of the many mistresses of the Lord, by whom the Lord is not so much attracted

2.6.37: As the mother is the only authority to identify the father of a child, so the mother Vedas, presented by the recognized authority such as Brahmā, Nārada or Śiva, is the only authority to inform us about the Absolute Truth.

2.6 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-17

Lord Brahmā explains how the Lord's universal form contains all manifested opulences, which are the perverted reflection of their original spiritual identity in the spiritual world. The Lord's universal form is the source of all facilities for the living entities – both the regulated and the irreligious. The universal form is expanded from His partial representation, the Supersoul.

Verses 18-22

All these material opulences and facilities, in which living entities exist, amount to one fourth of the Lord's energies. Lord Brahmā explains the transcendental nature of the Lord and His abode (the three fourths spiritual energy) and explains that He is ever aloof although He controls everything spiritual and material. The spiritual world is beyond the higher planetary systems and outer coverings, and is for those who will never be reborn, while the material worlds are for those who are attached.

Verses 23-32

Lord Brahmā explains how he created the ingredients and paraphernalia for offering sacrifice out of the parts of the body of the Supreme Lord and performed sacrifice to satisfy the Lord, thus establishing the proper method of worship accepted by the Lord for all to follow. The Supreme Person is the controller and maintainer, by His will Lord Brahmā is empowered to create and Lord Śiva to destroy.

Verses 33-46

Lord Brahmā explains that because the Lord's potency is inconceivable, even a powerful personality such as he cannot estimate the Lord's glories. He therefore concludes that one should surrender to the Lord and hear the glories of His incarnations. He then describes some of the transcendental qualities of the Lord and His incarnation Lord Viṣṇu.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) instructions on celibacy (6, 20)

(PrA) 75% tripād-vibhūti / 25% pāda-vibhūti (18-22.)

2.7 Scheduled Incarnations With Specific Functions

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. How does a devotee become more than the Lord? (4)
2. What are the special qualities of the planet awarded to Prince Dhruva Mahārāja? (8)
3. List the main philosophical points of Gajendra's prayer to the Lord. Include Sanskrit phrases. (15,16)
4. In what way is the body is the symbol of diseases? (21)
5. List a few of the extraordinary feats of the Lord that help to establish Him as the Supreme Lord. (26-35)

Analogies:

> **2.7.48:** In such a transcendental state there is no need of artificial control of the mind, mental speculation or meditation, as performed by the jñānīs and yogīs. One gives up such processes, as the heavenly King, Indra, forgoes the trouble to dig a well.

2.7 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-38

Lord Brahmā explains the scheduled incarnations and their specific functions to Nārada Muni. The incarnation of the Lord appears under certain extraordinary circumstances and performs a task which is not even imaginable by the tiny brain of mankind. Lord Kṛṣṇa, in His personal appearance in this material world, exhibits many extraordinary feats and thereby establishes without doubt His Supreme Godhood for those who are in knowledge.

Verses 39-50

Brahmā explains to Nārada Muni that only by surrendering to the Supreme Lord can one understand His unlimited potencies. Surrendered souls, even from groups leading sinful lives, can know about the science of Godhead and become liberated from the clutches of the illusory energy by surrendering unto the pure devotees of the Lord and by following in their footsteps in devotional service. The Personality of Godhead is the ultimate benefactor.

Verses 51-54

Brahmā requests Nārada Muni to describe for the enlightenment of human society the activities of the Lord in relation to His different energies. Brahmājī received this science of Godhead from the Lord directly, and he handed over the same to Nārada. Nārada is requested or ordered by his spiritual master to present this science with determination and in good plan for the fallen people in this age of Kali.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Lord will send a bona fide person who can guide…
more kind and more easy to approach…(46)

(PrA) Kṛṣṇa's extraordinary qualities (7.26-35)

(M&M) preserving and distributing the message of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (51-53)

UNIT 6

CANTO 2 CHAPTER 1 TO CHAPTER 7

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

1. Identify your challenges in avoiding the offenses in hearing and chanting. How has your study of this unit helped you to overcome these challenges? (1.11)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

2. Discuss Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam's description of society in terms of hogs, dogs, camels & asses with reference to 2.3.19-23. How has studying this description changed your perception of modern society?

Mood & Mission

3. Comment on how Prabhupāda's statements in 2.1.2, regarding 'many subjects for hearing,' reflect his mood & mission.

4. Discuss the importance of preserving and distributing the message of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam with reference to 7.51-53. How is this mission relevant to you?

UNIT 6 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Explain the connection between Cantos 1 & 2
Present overviews of Canto 2 Chapters 1 -7, with connecting links between chapters.

Personal Application

Discuss how they can improve their hearing with reference to 1.5-10
Identify qualities of a speaker and listener of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. (1.1; 10; & 3.16)
Identify their challenges in avoiding the offenses in hearing and chanting. (1.11)
Discuss the relevance of service and surrender in their lives, with reference to 5.17.

Preaching Application

Describe the nature of the virāṭ-rūpa with reference to Unit 6 of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.
Explain the process of Paramātmā darśana (2.8-12)
Explain how Kṛṣṇa is superior to the devas (3.1-11)
Discuss Kṛṣṇa's extraordinary qualities (7.26-35)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Discuss relevance of 'world of names', 2.3, in their view of reality.
Discuss Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam's description of society in terms of hogs, dogs, camels & asses (3.19-23)

Taste & Appreciation

Discuss how to develop their taste for hari-kathā (1.3-4)
Reflect on the importance of relishing with reference to 2.36-37

Mood & Mission

Comment on how Prabhupāda's statements in 1.2, regarding 'many subjects for hearing,' reflect his mood & mission.
Discuss the importance of preserving and distributing the message of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam with reference to 7.51-53.

UNIT 7 CATUR SLOKI; VIDURA, UDDHAVA & MAITREYA

(CANTO 2 CHAPTER 8 – CANTO 3 CHAPTER 4)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 8.7-23; 9.1-9; 9.23-24
Overview of Chapter 8 & Chapter 9 to verse 23
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 8
Additional Questions:

1. Briefly summarize Mahārāja Parīkṣit's questions. (8.7-23)
2. Select statements from 9.5-9 & 9.23-24 which are particularly relevant to you, and your current situation, challenges, etc. Write down one thing you could do based on this to improve your spiritual life.

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 9.26-44
Overview of Chapter 9
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya for Chapter 9
Additional Question:

1. Identify statements from 9.36-44, verses & purports, which reflect Prabhupāda's mood & mission.

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 9.10-17; 10.1-7; 10.33-44
Overview of Chapter10
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 10.
Additional Question:

1. Select statements from verses & purports 9.10-17 (Description of Vaikuṇṭha) & 10.33-44, which can be applied in a preaching context

Lesson 4

(No Specific texts)
Overview of Canto 3 Chapters 1 & 2
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Canto 3 Chapters 1 & 2

Lesson 5

(No Specific texts)
Overviews of Chapters 3 & 4
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya for Chapters 3 & 4

2.8 Questions By King Parīkṣit

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why is the Lord described as aguṇa, or without any quality? (1)
2. Summarize Mahārāja Parīkṣit's questions. (7-23)
3. Give reasons why Mahārāja Parīkṣit wanted to hear about the yugāvatāras? (17)
4. List some examples of pūrta prescribed pious works (21)
5. Why can the knowledge of the philosophical speculators never be perfect? (25-26)

Analogies:

2.8.3: Lord Kṛṣṇa is like the sun, and material contamination is like darkness. As the presence of the sun dissipates darkness, constant engagement in the association of the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa frees one from the contamination of the material qualities.

2.8.5: The sound incarnation of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Soul [i.e. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam], enters into the heart of a self-realized devotee, sits on the lotus flower of his loving relationship, and thus cleanses the dust of material association, such as lust, anger and hankering. Thus it acts like autumnal rains upon pools of muddy water.

2.8.6: A pure devotee of the Lord whose heart has once been cleansed by the process of devotional service never relinquishes the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, for they fully satisfy him, as a traveler is satisfied at home after a troubled journey.

2.8.21: Living the conditional life is just like plying a boat in the middle of the ocean. One is completely at the mercy of the ocean, and at every moment there is every chance of being drowned in the ocean by slight agitation. If the atmosphere is all right, the boat can ply very easily, undoubtedly, but if there is some storm, fog, wind or cloud, there is every possibility of being drowned in the ocean.

2.8 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6

Mahārāja Parīkṣit asked Śukadeva Gosvāmī: How did Nārada Muni explain the transcendental qualities of the Lord as requested by Brahmā at the end of Chapter 6. Mahārāja Parīkṣit glorifies the hearing of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, by which a serious person will have the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa manifested in their hearts within a short time, and thus become relieved of material contamination.

Verses 7-24

Mahārāja Parīkṣit wants to hear all about the science of God and His creation. He asks about the differences between the nature of the Supreme Person and the conditioned state of the living entities, the planetary systems, time and duration of life, and reactions of the three modes and transmigration of the soul. He then asks about the great souls, the yugāvatāras of the Lord, religious principles, devotional service, and the conditioned and unconditioned living entities.

Verses 25-29

Mahārāja Parīkṣit concludes his inquiry by a glorification of Śukadeva Gosvāmī's quality (as good as Brahmājī, who is ātma-bhūḥ, born of and educated by the Almighty Personality of Godhead.) and the message of the infallible Lord (acyuta-kathā) that he is speaking. Sūta Gosvāmī describes Śukadeva Gosvāmī's pleasure at hearing the questions of Mahārāja Parīkṣit, which Śukadeva then prepares to answer.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Questions of Mahārāja Parīkṣit (7-23)

(M&M) a single pure devotee of the Lord can deliver all the fallen souls of the world. (5)
Every devotee should be very enthusiastic, not only in performing his daily rituals of devotional service, but in trying to preach the cult (21)

(PeA) inquiry is essential for immunity to all of offenses on the path of devotional service (7)

(ThA) Persons addicted to the habits of passion and ignorance have no chance of entering the higher planetary systems simply by an electronic mechanism. (14)

2.9 Answers By Citing The Lord's Version

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List Lord Brahmā's 4 questions (26-29)
2. Summarize the Catur-ślokī of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. (33-36)

Analogies:

2.9.1: The child cries to have the moon from the mother, and the mother gives the child a mirror to satisfy the crying and disturbing child with the reflection of the moon. Similarly, the crying child of the Lord is given over to the reflection, the material world.

2.9.2: The living entity's desiring is like dreaming of a golden mountain. A person knows what a mountain is, and he knows also what gold is. Out of his desire only, he dreams of a golden mountain, and when the dream is over he sees something else in his presence. He finds in his awakened state that there is neither gold nor a mountain, and what to speak of a golden mountain.

2.9.28: But all such agents and creative energies are emanations from the Lord, and as such there is nothing except the Lord, or the one supreme source of different diversities. The exact example is the spider and spider's web. The web is created by the spider, and it is maintained by the spider, and as soon as the spider likes, the whole thing is wound up within the spider.

2.9 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-8

Śrī Śukadeva Gosvāmī explains that due to ignorance the conditioned soul is encaged in the temporary varieties of material forms. But the Supreme Lord is always possessed of an eternal form of knowledge and bliss. Śukadeva Gosvāmī cites Lord Brahmā's example to show that one can understand this difference by the process of bhakti-yoga. Lord Brahmā heard the words "tapa tapa", immediately recognized them as the instruction of the Lord and sat down on his lotus seat to engage in tapasya for 1000 celestial years.

Verses 9-30

The Lord being thus very much satisfied with the penance of Lord Brahmā, manifest His personal abode, Vaikuṇṭha. The Lord then confirms that it was He Himself who had previously ordered Brahmā to undergo penance and that penance is His heart and soul. Lord Brahmā asks 4 questions (26-29) so that he may act instrumentally to generate living entities, without being conditioned by such activities nor victimized by pride.

Verses 31-37

The Lord first tells Brahmā that knowledge about Him is confidential and must be realized by devotional service. (31-32) The Lord then explains four essential points about Himself in four verses (Catuḥ-ślokī Bhāgavatam). By understanding this, one can remain free from pride.

(33) The Supreme Lord alone exists before, during, and after the creation.
(34) Whatever appears to exist without relation to Him is His illusory energy.
(35) The Lord exists within and outside of everything.
(36) One must always search for Him, the Personality of Godhead.

Verses 38-46

Śukadeva Gosvāmī relates that after the Lord disappeared, Brahmā proceeded with the creation. Later Brahmā narrated Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam to Nārada Muni. Nārada later instructed the same to Śrīla Vyāsadeva in the disciplic succession.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Penance is the beauty and wealth of the brāhmaṇas (6)
Following the order of ..spiritual master is only duty of disciple… secret of success. (8-9)
Penance and I are nondifferent. (23)
He wants to see how painstaking the devotee is in devotional service. (24)
Love and penance combined can please the Lord (23-24)

(PrA) The history of conditional existence (1-3)
Catur-ślokī Bhāgavatam (33-36)
Description of Vaikuṇṭha (9.10-17)

(M&M) Devotional service to the Lord is open for all (36)
One who is now the disciple is the next spiritual master (43)
We are just trying to follow in the footsteps of all these authorities. (44)

2.10 Bhāgavatam Is The Answer To All Questions

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List the ten divisions of the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam.(1)
2. What is the definition given for liberation (mukti) by Śukadeva Gosvāmī? (6)
3. Explain what is meant by the terms mahā-samaṣṭi, samaṣṭi, and vyaṣṭi (13)
4. Explain ajā-gala-stana-nyāya (45)
5. Briefly describe what is meant by mahā-kalpa, vikalpa and kalpa. (46)

Analogies:

2.10.43: This creation is very appropriately compared to clouds. Clouds are created or situated in the sky, and when they are displaced they remain in the same sky without manifestation.

2.10.51: The best lawyer gives evidence from the past judgment of the court without taking much trouble to establish his case. This is called the paramparā system, and learned authorities follow it without manufacturing rubbish interpretations.

2.10 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA)

Verses 1-7

Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes the ten divisions of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, which are the limitation of all questions. In order to fully explain the āśrayaḥ — the summum bonum — the first nine divisions are described sometimes by Vedic inference (śrutena), sometimes by direct explanation (arthena), and sometimes by summary explanations given by the great sages (añjasā).

Verses 8-32

Śukadeva Gosvāmī presents analysis of the differences between the Supreme Lord (the āśraya) and other living entities and thus the prime necessity for devotional serice to the Lord. He then describes the supreme independence of the puruṣa-avatāras, and by implication the complete dependence of the conditioned living entities, by describing the gradual manifestation of the virāṭ-puruṣa.

Verses 33-51

Śukadeva Gosvāmī explains that the Supreme Lord is beyond both the material manifestations and Brahman. Śaunaka Rsi inquires about Mahātma Vidura and his discussions with Maitreya Muni, which Sūta Gosvāmī had mentioned earlier (1.13.1- 2).

Discussion Topics

(Und) Chronological Order of Speakers of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (1)
Ten divisions of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam / Mahā-Purāṇa (1-7)
Mahā-kalpa, vikalpa and kalpa (45-46)

EXPLANATION OF CATUḤ-ŚLOKĪ BHĀGAVATAM
IN RELATION TO SAMBANDHA, ABIDHEYA, PRAYOJANA ADI 1.51-56 & MAD 25.105-131

These were Brahmā's questions: (from 9.31 purport)

sambandha

(1) What are the forms of the Lord both in matter and in transcendence? 9.26
(2) How are the different energies of the Lord working? 9.27

prayojana

(3) How does the Lord play with His different energies? 9.28

(4) How may Brahmā be instructed to discharge the duty entrusted to Him? 9.29

Abidheya

The prelude to the answers is this verse under discussion….9.31

jñānaṁ parama-guhyaṁ me

Knowledge about Me as described in the scriptures is very confidential

Sambandha

yad vijñāna samanvitam sarahasyaṁ

it has to be realized in conjunction with devotional service.

Prayojana

tad-aṅgaṁ ca gṛhāṇa gaditaṁ mayā

The necessary paraphernalia for that process is being explained by Me.

Abidheya

Catuḥ-ślokī Bhāgavatam Summary Adi 1.56

Sambandha 9.33-34:
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam has eighteen thousand verses, which are summarized in the four verses beginning with aham evāsam evāgre (33) and concluding with yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā (36). In the first of these verses (33) the transcendental nature of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is explained. The second verse (34) further explains that the Lord is detached from the workings of the material energy, māyā. The living entities, although parts and parcels of Lord Kṛṣṇa, are prone to be controlled by the external energy; therefore, although they are spiritual, in the material world they are encased in bodies of material energy. The **eternal relationship** of the living entities with the Supreme Lord is explained in that verse.

Prayojana 9.35:
The next verse (35) instructs that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by His inconceivable energies, is simultaneously one with and different from the living entities and the material energy. This knowledge is called acintya-bhedābheda-tattva. When an individual living entity surrenders to the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa, he can then develop natural transcendental love for Him. This surrendering process should be the **primary concern** of a human being.

Abidheya 9.36:
In the next verse (36) it is said that a conditioned soul must ultimately **approach** a bona fide spiritual master and try to understand perfectly the material and spiritual worlds and his own existential position.

CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER OF SPEAKERS OF ŚRĪMAD-BHĀGAVATAM (9.45 & 10.1)

1. Lord Kṛṣṇa to Brahma

   (catuḥ-ślokī: 2.9.33-36)

2. Brahma to Nārada Muni

   (2.5-7)

3. Nārada Muni to Śrīla Vyāsadeva

   (1.4-7)

4. Śrīla Vyāsadeva to Śukadeva Gosvāmī
   Jīva Gosvāmī in Tattva-sandarbha, states that Vyāsadeva spoke the entire Bhāgavatam in 18,000 verses to Śukadeva Gosvāmī

5. Śukadeva Gosvāmī to Maharaja Parīkṣit (and Suta Gosvāmī)
   Śrīla Vyāsadeva explained Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam unto Śukadeva Gosvāmī from the very beginning of the janmādy asya [SB 1.1.1] verse, and so Śukadeva Gosvāmī also explained it to the king.

   SB 2.1.10 Purport

6. Suta Gosvāmī to the sages at Naimiṣāraṇya (headed by Śaunaka ṛṣi)

3.1 Questions by Vidura

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Describe the incident which caused the War of Kurukṣetra (8)
2. What reasons does Vidura give for:
    a. Returning the legitimate share of the kingdom to the Pandavas?
    b. Expelling Duryodhana? (12-13)
3. Why does Vidura call Duryodhana “offense personified”. (13)
4. Explain how māyā acted here both internally and externally. (16)
5. Why didn’t Vidura approach Kṛṣṇa directly? (17)
6. Identify some of the facilities offered by holy places of pilgrimage (17, 45)
7. Explain the significance of the Lord's cakra (23)
8. List the three features of His internal potency (31)
9. List members of the Yadu Dynasty mentioned by Uddhava in verses 26 to 35.
10. List reasons why Lord Kṛṣṇa did not chastise the Kurus immediately after they insulted Draupadī in the assembly at Hastināpura. (43)

Analogies

3.1.9: The message of Godhead is always like nectar to the devotees, but it is just the opposite to the nondevotees. Sugar candy is always sweet to a healthy man, but it tastes very bitter to persons suffering from jaundice.

3.1.14: It is said that giving good counsel to a foolish person causes the fool to become angry, just as feeding milk to a snake only increases its venomous poison.

3.1.18: If one puts letters in postboxes authorized by the general post office, the function of carrying letters is performed without a doubt. Similarly, the arcā-mūrti can also deliver the same unlimited potency of the Lord as when He is personally present.

3.1. 21: At the place of pilgrimage at Prabhāsa, it came to his knowledge that all his relatives had died due to violent passion, just as an entire forest burns due to fire produced by the friction of bamboos. See SB 3.4.2 ; SB 3.24.27

3.1 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Introduction to 3rd Canto
After hearing all about the creation, as discussed between Śukadeva Gosvāmī and Mahārāja Parīkṣit in the Second Canto, Śaunaka Rsi inquires about Mahātma Vidura and his discussions with Maitreya Muni, which Sūta Gosvāmī had mentioned earlier (1.13.1- 2).

Verses 1-16:
Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes the events leading up to Vidura's departure from the palace in Hastināpura. When Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira requested the return of his rightful share of the kingdom, having returned from exile in the forest, he was refused. Dhṛtarāṣṭra requested Vidura for his opinion and Vidura recommended that Yudhiṣṭhira's legitimate share of the kingdom be returned to him and that Duryodhana be expelled. Hearing Vidura's advice, Duryodhana angrily responded by insulting Vidura and ordering him to be thrown out of the palace. Hearing Duryodhana's insulting words, Vidura placed his bow on the door and left his brother's palace.

Verses 17- 24:
Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes Vidura's travels on pilgrimage. At Prabhāsa-kṣetra Vidura heard the Kauravas and Yādavas extinction. Eventually he reached the bank of the Yamunā, where he met Uddhava (who was traveling to Badrikasram on the order of the Lord).

Verses 25- 45:
Vidura inquires from Uddhava about the welfare of the Yādava's in Dvārakā & about the welfare of the Pandavas. Vidura describes the transcendental nature of the Lords appearance and requests Uddhava to chant the glories of the Lord.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) māyā acted in Duryodhana's insulting Vidura both internally and externally. (16)

(PrA) Vidura's advice to Dhṛtarāṣṭra. (12-13)
Lord Kṛṣṇa and His remembrance are on the absolute plane. (24, 32, 3.2.4)

(ThA) Piety & impiety as explained in this section. (6, 9, 17)

(Rea) Vidura's realizations on his journey. (42)

3.2 Remembrance of Lord Kṛṣṇa

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List some of Uddhava's transcendental qualities. (1-6)
2. Compare the Kṛṣṇa consciousness of the residents of Dvārakā with that of the residents of Vṛndāvana. (7-11)
3. Why did Kṛṣṇa not appear in human society in His Vaikuṇṭha feature? Define the terms prakaṭa & aprakaṭa. (12)
4. Explain how the pastimes the lord displays in the mortal world excel His mercy displayed in the Vaikuṇṭhalokas. (12)
5. Explain why Kṛṣṇa never goes beyond the boundary of Vṛndāvana. (12-15)
6. Compare the results achieved by Śiśupāla , the soldiers killed on the battlefield of Kurukṣetra and Pūtanā (19-23)

Analogies

3.2.8. The urine of a cow is salty, and according to Āyur-vedic medicine the cow's urine is very effective in treating patients suffering from liver trouble. Such patients may not have any experience of the cow's milk because milk is never given to liver patients. But the liver patient may know that the cow has milk also, although he has never tasted it. Similarly, men who have experience only of this tiny planet where the saltwater ocean exists may take information from the revealed scriptures that there is also an ocean of milk, although we have never seen it.

3.2.8. From this ocean of milk the moon was born, but the fish in the milk ocean could not recognize that the moon was not another fish and was different from them. The fish took the moon to be one of them or maybe something illuminating, but nothing more. The unfortunate persons who do not recognize Lord Kṛṣṇa are like such fish

3.2.15. As electricity is generated by friction of matter anywhere and everywhere, the Lord, being all-pervading, appears because of the friction of devotees and nondevotees.

3.2.30. Children play with toy lions, elephants, boars and many similar dolls, which are broken by the children in the course of their playing with them. Before the Almighty Lord, any powerful living being is just like a toy lion in the hands of a playing child.

3.2 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6

Śukadeva Gosvāmī describes how upon being requested by Vidura to speak about Kṛṣṇa, Uddhava, a nitya-siddha devotee of the Lord, became absorbed in ecstasy.

Verses 7-34

Uddhava informs Vidura about Kṛṣṇa's disappearance and describes the super excellent nature of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's pastimes in the material world. Uddhava then describes Kṛṣṇa's appearance as the son of Vasudeva and Devakī in the prison of Kaṁsa, and then goes on to describe Kṛṣṇa's Vṛndāvana pastimes

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Apparent contradictions in Kṛṣṇa (16-17, 26)
Comparison of mood in Dvārakā & Vṛndāvana & view of atheists. (7-11, 22, 27-29)
The Lord accepts the least qualification of the living entity (Putana). (23)

(Aut) Ocean of milk (8)

3.3 The Lord's Pastimes Out of Vṛndāvana

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What general principle does Prabhupāda draw from the incident in which Sāndīpani Muni requested something which was impossible from Kṛṣṇa? (2)
2. What does the Lord's fulfilling the request of Satyabhāmā indicate? (5)
3. What does the example of Narakāsura indicate about human nature? (6)
4. Explain why Lord referred to the Yadus as "more unbearable burden." (14)
5. Why did the Lord established Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira as the world emperor? (18)
6. What lesson can be drawn from the cursing of the princes? (28)

Analogies

3.3.21: Lord Kṛṣṇa is just like the moon and the internal potential damsels are like the stars around the moon.

3.3 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-5:
Śrī Uddhava explained how Lord Kṛṣṇa and Śrī Baladeva went to Mathurā and killed Kaṁsa. Lord Kṛṣṇa learned all the Vedas from His teacher, Sāndīpani Muni and how He married His queens beginning with Rukmiṇī.

Verses 6-15:
The Lord defeated the demon Narakāsura and expanded Himself to marry the princesses who he had held captive. He also killed other demons and left some demons to be killed by His devotees. Uddhava mentions how the Lord arranged the Battle of Kurukṣetra and the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty.

Verses 16-28:
Kṛṣṇa was the King of Dvārakā, acting as a subordinate king under the regime of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, enjoyed pastimes displaying His internal energy. The Lord manifested His detachment from ephemeral sex. This chapter concludes with Uddhava describing the events leading up to the fratricidal war of the Yadu dynasty at Prabhāsa.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Destruction of Yadu dynasty by the will of the Lord (15, 24-28, 4.2-3)
The earth became overburdened due to dharma-glāni (14)
Attachments of the Lord are manifestations of internal potency (21-22)

(PeA) Devotees utilize their individuality in pursuit of the desires of Lord (15)

(AMI) Pure devotees..not enthusiastic to put aside their service to the Lord in order to go visit holy places of pilgrimage. (26)

3.4 Vidura Approaches Maitreya

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Analyze the good fortune of Maitreya's meeting with the Lord. (9-11)
2. Explain the difference between the catuḥ-ślokī Bhāgavatam enunciated first to Brahmājī and that spoken to Uddhava. (19)
3. According to Lord Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya preached the Māyāvāda philosophy for what particular purpose? (20)
4. Why did Śaṅkarācārya not dare write any commentary on Bhāgavatam? (20)
5. What did Uddhava do to mitigate his unbearable separation from the Lord? (21)
6. Explain the offense of maryādā-vyatikrama (24-26)
7. Why was Uddhava advised to go to Badarikāśrama? (4) (30-31)

Analogies

3.4.8 The material energies represented by the banyan tree are all products of His external potency and are therefore kept to His back. And because this particular universe is the smallest of all, the banyan tree is therefore designated as small, or as a child.

3.4 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-12:
The Lord advised Uddhava to go to Badarikāśrama to avoid the distresses which were to follow the disappearance of the Lord and the destruction of the Yadu dynasty. Uddhava however followed the Lord to the bank of the River Sarasvatī where the Lord went to prepare to leave this material world. Uddhava & Maitreya approach the Lord who informs Uddhava that he is eligible to return to Vaikuṇṭha.

Verses 13-22:
Uddhava offers prayers to the Lord and requests from the Lord to be enlightened in the catuḥ-ślokī Bhāgavatam. Uddhava was thus aggrieved by feelings of separation.

Verses 23-27:
After hearing from Uddhava all about the annihilation of his friends and relatives Vidura pacified his bereavement by transcendental knowledge. Uddhava, before departing to Badarikāśrama, advised Vidura to approach Maitreya Ṛṣi to receive transcendental knowledge.

Verses 28-36:
Śukadeva Gosvāmī explains to Maharaja Parīkṣit the purpose of Uddhava's journey. After reaching the pilgrimage site of Badarikāśrama, Uddhava engaged himself there in trance to satisfy the Lord. Vidura Understanding that he was remembered by Lord Kṛṣṇa [while quitting this world], was overwhelmed by the ecstasy of love and began to cry loudly.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) The order of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical (21)
Offense of maryādā-vyatikrama (24-26)

(M&M) The servants of the Lord are actually the servants of society. (25)
Authorization to preach the devotional service of the Lord. (32)

UNIT 7

CANTO 2 CHAPTER S 8-10
CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 1-4

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

1. Select statements from 9.5-9 & 9.23-24, the tapasya of Lord Brahmā, which are particularly relevant to your current situation, challenges, etc. Discuss how application of these statements can help to improve your spiritual life.

2. Discuss, with reference to 2.4.24-26, the relevance for ISKCON of the offense of maryādā-vyatikrama .

Preaching Application

3. Discuss the relevance for preaching of the destruction of Yadu dynasty with reference to 3.14-15, 3. 24-28, 4.2-3.

Mood & Mission

4. Discuss how Uddhava being advised to go to Badarikāśrama:
    b. Reflects Prabhupada's mood.
    c. Is relevant for our practice of spiritual life.

In your answer give reference to 4.4, 21, 30-32.

UNIT 7 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of Chapters 8-10
Summarize Mahārāja Parīkṣit's questions. (8.7-23)
Present a overview of:

- Brahmā's questions & the prelude to Catur-ślokī Bhāgavatam (9.25-32)
- Catur-ślokī Bhāgavatam in terms of Sambandha, Abidheya & Prayojana Delineate the Chronological Order of Speakers of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam (10.1)

Explain the daśa-lakṣaṇam (10.1-7)
Explain the connection between catuḥ-ślokī & daśa-lakṣaṇam (9.44)
Explain the meaning of the following concepts:

- Samaṣṭi & Vyaṣṭi (13-14/18)
- ajā-gala-stana-nyāya (45)
- mahā-kalpa, vikalpa and kalpa (45-46)

Explain the connection between 2nd & 3rd Cantos

Preaching/ Theological Application

Make a presentation, using analogies, examples & Sanskrit phrases from 9.1-3, explaining the history of conditional existence and related philosophical concepts.
Identify points from Catur-ślokī Bhāgavatam relevant for preaching
Select statements from verses & purports 9.10-17 (Description of Vaikuṇṭha) & 10.33-44 which can be applied in a preaching context
Explain the how the destruction of Yadu dynasty (3.14-15, 3. 24-28, 4.2-3), was by the will of the Lord, and discuss how this incident is relevant for preaching
Present statements from Uddhava's remembrances of Kṛṣṇa in a preaching context.

Personal Application

Select statements from 9.5-9 & 9.23-24, the tapasya of Lord Brahmā, which are particularly relevant to our current situation, challenges, etc. Discuss how application of this can help to improve our spiritual life.
Discuss how the offense of maryādā-vyatikrama (4.24-26) is relevant for ISKCON.

Mood & Mission

Discuss how statements in relation to catur-ślokī Bhāgavatam, 9.36-44,

- Reflect Prabhupāda's mood & mission.
- Are relevant to ISKCON in general.

Discuss how the statement…. "We are just trying to follow in the footsteps" 9.44 reflects Prabhupāda's mood & Mission & how to perpetuate this in ISKCON…
Discuss how Uddhava being advised to go to Badarikāśrama (4.4, 21, 30-32):

- Reflects Prabhupada's mood.
- Is relevant for our practice of spiritual life.

Śāstra-Cakṣusā

Discuss how māyā acted internally and externally, in Duryodhana insulting Vidura (1.16). Discuss how this example is relevant fro us.

UNIT 8 (CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 5 –12)

SEE FACILITATOR FOR PRESENTATION SCHEDULE

3.5 VIDURA'S TALKS WITH MAITREYA

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why did Vidura not immediately ask Maitreya Muni about the Lord? (2)
2. Examine the platforms of vaidhī-bhakti & rāga-bhakti (4)
3. Comment on scarcity in the world (5, 49)
4. Explain how there are different descriptions of creation etc. mentioned in the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam. (6)
5. Why is a civilized man expected to give all protection to the bulls and cows? (7)
6. Examine the difference between mundane literature & Kṛṣṇa-kathā (7-16)
7. What is the meaning of Adhokṣaja? (18)
8. Describe the process by which living entities appear? (24-26)
9. What is the mahat-tattva? (27-29)
10. What is the role of the false ego? (28)
11. Which items are produced by the interaction of false ego and the mode of goodness, passion & ignorance? (30-37)
12. What are the River Ganges and Bhagavad-gītā considered to be? (41)
13. Examine the results of hearing kṛṣṇa-kathā (42, 44)
14. Compare the results of jñāna and yoga with the results of bhakti. (45-47)

Analogies

3.5.5: Thinking material nature to be independent is like seeking milk from the nipplelike bags on the neck of a goat.

3.5.10: As fire is never satisfied in its consumption of firewood, so a pure devotee of the Lord never hears enough about Kṛṣṇa.

3.5.24: Although the creation of the internal potency was manifested, the other potency appeared to be sleeping, and the Lord wanted to awaken her to activity, just as a husband wants to awaken his wife from the sleeping state for enjoyment.

3.5.47: The devotees derive more transcendental pleasure while engaged continuously in the service of the Lord than when they have no such engagement. In the family combination of a man and a woman there is much labor and responsibility for both of them, yet when they are single they feel more trouble for want of their united activities.

3.5.51: As some of the old prisoners in government jails are entrusted with some responsible work of prison management, so the demigods are improved conditioned souls acting as representatives of the Lord in the material creation.

3.5 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16

Vidura reached Hardwar and there began to inquire from the great sage Maitreya. Vidura's inquiry about: a) the puruṣa-avatāra b) the virāṭ-rūpa c) the līlā-avatāras d) the different living creatures created by Nārāyaṇa. Vidura extensively glorifies the Lord and the process of devotional service to Him, especially hearing and chanting *Kṛṣṇa-kathā*.

Verses 17-37:

Maitreya respectfully thanks Vidura for his wonderful question and glorifies his compassion, transcendental vision, parentage, position as Yamarāja, and eternal servitude to the Lord. Maitreya begins to describe the Lord's expansion as the puruṣa-avatāra who impregnates the material energy thus producing the living entities by the force of eternal time. His material energy manifests mahat-tattva which transforms in false ego. False ego in the mode of goodness generates the mind and the demigods, false ego in passion generates the senses, and false ego in ignorance generates the sense objects and the five gross elements, one after the other, beginning with sound and sky, each by the glance of the Lord upon the previous.

Verses 38-51:

In order to become empowered to do their respective duties, the demigods offer prayers to the Lord, glorifying His lotus feet as giving knowledge, detachment, and freedom from misery. They say that hearing about the Lord's topics easily elevates His devotees to the spiritual planets, while those who try by their own power and knowledge, only attain the spiritual effulgence after much difficulty. They glorify the Lord, briefly describing His creation, and ask Him for directions, knowledge, and potency to perform their duties to Him.

Discussion Topics

(Und) The process by which living entities appear (24-26, 50-51)
Mahat-tattva, its products & the 3 modes. (27-38)
Position of the demigods (51)

(PrA) Comparing mundane literature & Kṛṣṇa-kathā. (7,10-16)
By hearing .. devotees perceive increased knowledge and detachment. (42, 44)
Compare the results of jñāna and yoga with the results of bhakti. (45-47)

(M+M) Pure devotees compassionately travel all over the world. (3)
bestow the blessings of devotion upon offenders without hesitation. (45)

(ThA) Garbhādhāna-saṁskāra for generating good population. (19)

(AUT, AMI) Higher classes of men are white, and the lower classes of men are black. (9)

3.6 Creation of the Universal Form

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Summarize the main point of verses 2-10
2. After the 23 principal elements were set in action by the Lord, what came into existence? (4-5)
3. What happened after the entrance of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu in the universe? (6)
4. Explain the examples of the frog in a well & Plough Department (10)
5. What is the difference between the demigods and ordinary living entities? (12)
6. What is the most important source of knowledge and why? (17)
7. List some of the directors of material affairs in the universal Form (12-26)
8. Why is the mouth is the most important of the bodily parts? (30)
9. The problems of modern human society are due to what? (31)
10. What is he meaning of viśa? (32)
11. List the different subsections of the vaiśyas. (32)
12. What does the tridaṇḍa of the Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī represent? (36)

Analogies

3.6.39: A small banyan fruit contains thousands of small seeds, and each seed holds the potency of another tree, which again holds the potency of many millions of such fruits as causes and effects. But the speculators can never appreciate the simple potential activities of the banyan tree.

3.6 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-10:
Maitreya explains that when the Lord realized the elements were not combining, He entered into the elements, arousing the living entities and bringing into existence His universal form (Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu). This universal form divided into the consciousness of the living entities, the life of activity, and self-identification, which are subdivided into one (the heart, the source of the energy of life), ten (the airs of life) and three (the body, mind, and senses).

Verses 11-26:
The Lord creates different demigods from the different parts of the body of His universal form to assist in universal functions: Agni from His mouth is in charge of speech; Varuṇa from His palate facilitates taste; Aśvinī-kumāras from His two nostril direct the smelling of the living entities; the sun, His eyes, sight; Anila (the wind god), His skin, touch; the deities of the directions, His ears, hearing; deities of sensations, His skin, itching and happiness due to touch; Prajāpati, His genitals, sex pleasure; Mitra, His evacuation channel, ability to pass stool and urine; Indra, His hands, ability to transact business for his livelihood, Viṣṇu (not the Personality of Godhead), His legs, movement; Brahmā, His intelligence, ability to understand; moon god, His heart, mental activity; Rudra, His materialistic ego, ability to transact objective actions; mahat-tattva, His consciousness, ability to conceive knowledge.

Verses 27-40:
The upper planets come from the head of the Lord, inhabited by the demigods, born of goodness. From His legs the earthly planets, inhabited by the humans, born of passion. In the sky between the earthly planets and the heavenly planets associates of Rudra are manifest, born of ignorance. Maitreya explains how the four varṇas come from the universal form of the Lord: brāhmaṇas, the teachers of society who are expert in Vedic wisdom, from His mouth; the kṣatriyas, the protectors of society, from His arms; vaiśyas, the productive class, from His waist; and the śūdras, the working class, from His legs. He explains how all can attain perfection by worship of the Lord .Maitreya concludes by reminding us the highest perfection can be obtained simply hearing the Lord's glories.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Matter is a product of spirit and increases only by the touch of spirit. (2-10)
Ph.D.'s and frog in the wel (10, 35, 38-40)

(PeA) Vedic knowledge received by hearing, sound most important knowledge source. (17)
The main qualification of a brāhmaṇa is to be inclined to the Vedic wisdom. (30)
Highest perfectional state attained by hearing and reciting Bhāgavatam (37-38)

(M&M) Anyone from any part of the world may become a real brāhmaṇa.. (30)
The different varṇas are essential for maintaining a peaceful human society. (32-33)

(Und) Demigods in charge of material affairs (12-26)

3. 7 Further Inquires by Vidura

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What misconceptions are Vidura's inquiries clearing? (2)
2. How has the pure soul become engaged in nescience? (5)
3. List some analogies from verses 9-11 which explain how:
    a. The Lord is always unaffected by the influence of the material energy,
    b. How the living entity misidentifies with matter
4. Which two classes of persons do not suffer the material pangs? (17)

Analogies

3.7.2: Prison rules apply to prisoners but not the king, who visits the prison out of good will.

3.7.9: The sun is all light and though clouds, darkness and snowfall come from it, it is aloof. Clouds, darkness, and snowfall can cover some of the sun rays, but never the whole sun.

3.7.11: Material taints cause soul to seem to quiver like the moon's reflection on water.

3.7.13: Artificially stopping a mischievous child is not the real remedy. The child must be given some better engagement so that he will automatically stop causing mischief. In the same way, the mischievous activities of the senses can be stopped only by better engagement in relation with the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

3.7 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-7:
Vidura asked further questions of Maitreya: (1) Since the Lord is unchangeable how is He connected with the material modes and their activities? How do the activities of the unchangeable take place and exhibit qualities without the modes of nature? (2) How has the pure soul become engaged in nescience? (3) God is in every living being's heart, why then do their activities result in misfortune and misery?

Verses 8-20:
Maitreya explains that the idea that the Lord is overpowered by the illusory energy is against all logic. He explains conditioned souls are in distress about their self-identity, like a man who dreams that he sees his head cut off. When the soul identifies with matter, he quivers like the reflection of the moon on water. Maitreya then glories devotional service to Vāsudeva which can gradually diminish this misconception of self-identity. Vidura thanks Maitreya for his convincing words and glories the service and association of pure devotees.

Verses 21-42:
Vidura inquires from Maitreya about the creation, planetary systems and their time scales, species of life, the Lord and His incarnations, the divisions and orders of human society, the great sages, the *Vedas* and their divisions, sacrifices, the paths of mystic yoga, knowledge, and devotion, contradictions in atheistic theories, the movements of the living entities, religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and salvation and also the different means of livelihood and different processes of law and order as mentioned in the revealed scriptures, offering respects to the forefathers, the results of fruitive activities, how to satisfy the Lord, as well as anything important that he neglected to ask about. He asked about the dissolutions and the Lord and His devotees, Vedic knowledge, the necessity for the spiritual master and his disciples. All this he inquired about with a view to know Hari, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Rāga-bhakti, automatically serves Lord out of sincere attachment. (14)
Higher planets, moon and Venus different time measurements from the earth. (33)

(PeA) The power of associating with and serving pure devotees (18-20)
Guru and disciples duties & guru's qualification. (36, 38-39)
Without brahminical qualifications, one cannot understand Vedic hymns. (29)

(PrA) Material world to facilitate the living entity's unlawful desire to imitate God. (16)
Jīva potency influenced by the avidyā potency (5, 9-11)
Misconceptions diminish through process of devotional service (12-14)
Neither dull animals nor liberated souls feel material pangs. (17)

(M&M) Give people in general immunity from the anxieties of material existence. (41)

3. 8 Manifestation of Brahmā from Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. How can a perfect yogī can at once transport himself from one place to another? (5)
2. What is the result of touching the water of the Ganges to one's head? (5)
3. Trace the narration of the Bhāgavatam from Lord Sankarsana to Maitreya? (7-9)
4. What point does Prabhupada establish on the basis of the above disciplic succession? (9)
5. For what reason was Parāśara given the blessing that he would be a great speaker on the Vedic literatures? (9)
6. What does the analogy of fire that lies latent within fuel wood indicate? (11)
7. Why is Garbhodakasayi Visnu's body seen to be bluish ?(12)
8. How did Lord Brahma acquire four heads? (16)
9. What does Lord Brahma's perplexity about his circumstances indicate? (17,19)
10. When was the Brahma-saṁhitā composed? (22, 26)

Analogies

3.8 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-9:
Maitreya glorifies Vidura's devotional family heritage and his eagerness to hear the glories of the Lord. Maitreya then said he would answer Vidura's inquires by speaking Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, which he had heard in the line of succession coming from Lord Saṅkarṣaṇa, through Sanat-kumāra, to Sāṅkhyāyana Muni, and to his spiritual master, Parāśara Muni.

Verses 10-23:
When the three worlds were submerged in water, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu was alone, lying on His bedstead, Ananta, for four thousand yuga cycles. He appeared to be in slumber in His own internal potency. The subtle subject matter of creation was agitated by the material mode of passion, and thus the subtle form of creation pierced through His abdomen. This sum total form of the fruitive activity of the living entities took the shape of the bud of a lotus flower generated, and by His supreme will it illuminated everything, and dried up the vast waters of devastation. Into that universal lotus flower Lord Viṣṇu personally entered as the Supersoul, and when it was thus impregnated with all the modes of material nature, Brahmā was generated. Brahmā achieved four heads in terms of the four directions by looking at the world around him. Lord Brahmā, in spite of entering the stem and going nearer to the navel of Viṣṇu, could not trace out the root. Then he returned to the top of the lotus and concentrated his mind on the Supreme Lord. At the end of Brahmā's one hundred years, he could see in his heart the Supreme within himself. Brahmā could see that on the water there was a gigantic lotuslike white bedstead, the body of Śeṣa-nāga, on which the Personality of Godhead was lying alone. The whole atmosphere was illuminated by the rays of the jewels bedecking the hood of Śeṣa-nāga.

Verses 24-33:
The Lord's unparalleled beauty is described in detail. The Lord showed His lotus feet by raising them. He also acknowledged the service of the devotees and vanquished their distress by His beautiful smile. In addition to seeing the Lord, Brahmā could also understand his surroundings. He then became inclined to create by the mode of passion, and began to offer to the Lord 'respectful prayers..

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Without hearing nicely, one cannot preach the message of Vedic knowledge.(7)
Personal endeavor & God's mercy (17,19, 22)
Competition between devotees and Lord (27)

(AUT) Great sages travel all over the universe via the sacred Ganges (3)

3.9 Brahmā's Prayers for Creative Energy

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. How are persons addicted to the impersonal feature of the Lord described? (4)
2. How can one achieve parā bhakti (5)
3. Examine the difference between a pure devotee and an ordinary man in regard to accumulating wealth (6)
4. "Factory" is another name for what? (10)
5. Explain svarūpa-siddhi (11)
6. Why is the Lord dissatisfied with the demigods in the heavenly planets, and many devotees on this planet also? (12)
7. Examine the difference between sakāma & niṣkāma devotees (12)
8. List some reasons why Brahmā takes shelter of the Lord. (14-19)
9. Draw, from Brahmā's requests in verses 20-26, points which you can personally apply.
10. Why was Brahmā depressed? (27-28)
11. Examine the difference between transcendental service & service in the material world. (33)
12. Explain how the Supreme Lord is the dearest in both the conditioned and liberated states. (42)

Analogies

3.9.6: If a snake has its poison removed and bites a man, there is no fatal effect. Similarly, wealth accumulated in the cause of the Lord has no poisonous teeth,..effect is not fatal.

3.9.12: .. the nondevotees commit offense after offense, to both the Lord and His pure devotees engaged in missionary work. As a result of such acts, they become as barren as an alkaline field, where there is no strength to produce.

3.9 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-21

After many years of penance, Brahmā glorifies the Lord. Those who hear from the Vedas serve the Lord by hearing and chanting about Him, while others, who Brahmā pities, are embarrassed by material anxieties, while briefly enjoying material happiness. For those accepting devotional service, the Lord appears in their purified hearts in the form they like to worship. Creation, maintenance, and annihilation of the worlds, are His pastime. Those chanting the Lord's name at death attain Him. He incarnates in various species to perform pastimes but remains unaffected by material association. His sleep during the devastation is yet another pastime.

Verses 22-26

Brahmā continues to pray so that, as before, he may be empowered to create. Brahmā prays not be materially affected by his works, and to give up the false prestige of being the creator.

Verses 27-38

The Lord reassures Brahmā that he needn't be anxious or depressed as what he is begging for has been granted before. By penance all will be revealed. Brahmā, while acting, will be able to see everything within the Lord, and see the Lord everywhere. By the Lord's mercy upon him, he will increase the population unlimitedly, yet not be victimized by the mode of passion. The Lord explained how He manifested His form from within after Brahmā was unsuccessful in searching for his origin within the lotus stem.

Verses 39-44

The Lord was pleased by Brahmā's prayers and so granted him all benedictions. The Lord also promised any human being who prays like Brahmā will be similarly blessed. The Lord ends by telling Brahmā that by following His instructions he could now generate the living entities as before and then He disappeared.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Svarūpa-siddhi. (11)
Bewilderment of God's pure devotees is meant to further their knowledge of Him. (35)

(PeA) A pure devotee's attitude to accumulating wealth…(6)
Always look for the mercy of the Lord for successful execution of duty (29-30)
Transcendental service compared to service in the material world. (33,42)

(M+M) Missionary spirit, persuade unfortunate persons, take pity on them (7-8)
Niṣkāma devotees accept missionary responsibility (12)
Pure devotees like Brahmā, etc., always desire God be known by everyone ... (39)

3.10 Divisions of the Creation

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Briefly describe Brahma's creation of the planetary systems (4-9)
2. Explain why the living entities are sometimes called pratibimbas (9)
3. Time is considered to be what? (11)
4. List in brief some interesting features of the nine varieties of creations (14-29)

3.11 Calculation of Time, from the Atom

5. What is the material manifestation's ultimate particle? (1)
6. What general observation does Prabhupāda make from the description of measuring time given in verse 9?
7. What conclusion does Prabhupāda draw from the subject matters in verses 6-14?
8. What does Brahmā do in his sleeping condition? (22)
9. How long is the duration of Manu's life? (24)
10. Who appears simultaneously with Manu? (25-27)
11. Briefly describe reactions which appear at the beginning of the partial devastation (31)
12. Explain the meaning of 'yoga-nidrā' (32)
13. Briefly describe the coverings of the universes (41)

Analogies

3.10.12 (Material world) is something like the tape-recorded voice of a person who is now separated from the voice. As the tape recording is situated on the tape, so the whole cosmic manifestation is situated on the material energy and appears separate by means of kāla.

3.10-11 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 10.1-9:
Vidura inquires how Brahmā created the living beings, and Maitreya replies that Brahmā performed penance and then received inspiration and created the fourteen divisions of planetary systems.

Verses 10.10-30:
Vidura inquires about eternal time, and Maitreya describes time as the impersonal feature of the Lord and the source of the interactions of the three modes of material nature. He then describes the ten kinds of creations, the six natural creations by the external energy of the Lord, followed by four creations by Brahmā. These are: (1) *mahat-tattva,* (2) false ego, (3) sense perceptions, (4) knowledge and working capacity, (5) the controlling deities, (6) the ignorance that covers living beings, (7) trees and plants, (8) animals, (9) human beings, and (10) the remaining demigods.

Verses 11.1-15:
The material manifestation is made of fundamental irreducible atoms that are invisible. These join to form double atoms and three double atoms join to form a hexatoms, the hexatoms being visible in the sunlight going through a window screen. Bodies are formed from large groups of atoms.

Verses 11.16-42:
Vidura asks about the life span of those beings who live for more than a *kalpa*, and Maitreya explains about the duration of the four *yugas* and the *yuga-sandhyās.* Brahmā's day is one thousand cycles of the four *yugas,* and such also is the duration of his night. Fourteen Manu's reign for the duration of Brahmā's day, each for just over seventy-one *yuga* cycles. At the end of Brahmā's day, devastation takes place due to the fire emanating from the mouth of Saṅkarṣaṇa, and thus great sages like Bhṛgu and other inhabitants of Maharloka transport themselves to Janaloka, being distressed by the heat. During Brahmā's night remain merged in dissolution. There is also a partial devastation after each Manu. The duration of Brahmā's life is considered to be no more than a second for the Supreme Lord. Eternal time controls all the different divisions, but it only controls those who are body conscious, even up to Satyaloka. The universe is described to be four billion miles, and surrounded by layers of elements ten times bigger than the previous. Lord Krishna is glorified by Maitreya as the cause of all.

Discussion Topics

(Sc) Declaration of war between the two parties, the illusory energy and devotee (10.5-6)

(Und) The atom is the ultimate indivisible particle of which the universe is composed. (11.1)

(PrA) People forget all these devastations and think themselves happy. (11.31)
Human being without a sense of responsibility is no better than the madman (11.33)

(Aut) Universal coverings - earth to ether, each ten times thicker than the previous. 11.41

3. 12 Creation of the Kumāras and Others

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Why is the first condition of material life forgetfulness of one's real identity? (2)
2. What general principle can be drawn from the example of the 4 Kumāras? (5)
3. Why did Brahmā become angry on the refusal of his sons to obey his order? (6)
4. Why Lord Śiva is called Rudra? (10)
5. List some examples of where the Rudra principle is manifest. (11)
6. Why, in pictures, is Rudra always sitting in meditation? (17-19)
7. What does the name 'Nārada' suggest? (23)
8. Why are ordinary men advised to concentrate the mind by focusing on the place between the eyebrows? (26)
9. What general principles can be drawn from the incident wherein Brahmā became attracted to Vāk for sexual intercourse? (26-35)
10. What is the *Upapurāṇa* and the *pañcamaṁ vedam*? (38-39)
11. How do *vidyā dānaṁ tapaḥ & satyaṁ* relate to the 4 four social orders. (41)
12. Who is qualified to occupy the post of Brahmā? (48)

Analogies

3.12.31: The sun evaporates water from filthy places and yet is not infected with the quality of the filth. Similarly, Brahmā remains unimpeachable in all conditions.

3.12 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-24:
Brahmā first created the nescient engagements. Then feeling contaminated he meditated on the Lord for purification. Brahmā then created the Kumāras, who refused his order to generate progeny, being absorbed in spiritual pursuits, thus angering him. From his anger, Rudra and his expansions were born and assigned names, wives, and residences by Brahma. When asked to generate progeny, they produced unlimited progeny who attempted to devour the universe. Brahma out of fear told them to stop devouring and engage in penance. Then Brahmā created ten sons to help with generation Marīci, Atri, Aṅgirā, Pulastya, Pulaha, Kratu, Bhṛgu, Vasiṣṭha, Dakṣa, and Nārada, to deliver the path of bhakt.

Verses 25-35:
Brahmā manifested religion from his chest, irreligion from his back, lust and desire from his heart, anger from between his eyebrows, greed from between his lips, the power of speaking from his mouth, the ocean from his penis, and low and abominable activities from his anus. Sage Kardama was manifested from his shadow. Brahmā had a daughter named Vāk, born from his body, who attracted his mind toward sex. Brahmā sons respectfully appealed to Brahmā to give up the idea. Brahmā, very much ashamed, gave up the body he had accepted which later turned into fog in the darkness. Brahmā then manifested the Vedas, the paraphernalia for fire sacrifice, the 4 principles of religion, and social orders.

Verses 36-48:
Maitreya described how Brahmā gradually the manifest the four Vedas. Thereafter, Vedic hymns which had not been pronounced before, priestly rituals, the subject matters of the recitation, and transcendental activities were all established, one after another. Then came other arts and sciences, and the fifth Veda, namely, the *Purāṇas* and the histories. After that Brahmā manifest the four pillars of religion and the four spiritual orders of life and their divisions. Then he produced different types of verses, alphabets, and musical notes.

Verses 49-57:
Brahmā was lamenting the lack of population growth and considering what to do when Manu and Śatarūpā manifest from his body and united in a sexual relationship, producing children who married and populated the universe with their descendents.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) 4 Kumāras who are vāsudeva-parāyaṇa need not care for any other obligation (5,14)
Brahmā became attracted to Vāk for sexual intercourse. (26-35)

(M+M) Śrīman Nārada Muni is the highest among all the sons of Brahmā (22)

(PrA) 5 kinds of ignorance. (2-3)
Varṇāśrama produced from Brahmā. (41-44)

UNIT 8 GROUP PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

In your groups prepare a **40** minute presentation on the given sections from Unit 8.
Your presentation will be assessed by both your peers & class facilitator. [1]
Each group member will receive the same mark. [2]
Presentation guidelines and assessment percentages are given below.

30% Understanding

Present an Overview of your section & clearly explain the main philosophical concepts.
Use charts, diagrams or other visual aids in your explanation.
Identify any concepts which are particularly difficult to understand, if appropriate.
Support philosophical points with Sanskrit verses from the Bhāgavatam Cantos 1-3 and other bhakti-śāstras. (*e.g. Bhagavad-Gita, etc.*)
Present points within **30-35** minutes, leaving **5-10** minutes (**40** mins total)[3] for questions & answers. Satisfactorily answer questions in relation to the selected topic.

15% Personal Application

Present material which is particularly relevant to challenges faced by ISKCON members.
Explain how applying the selected material we can improve our spiritual lives.

20% Preaching (Theological) Application

Identify points, verses, concepts or issues particularly relevant for contemporary preaching or theological application.

15% Mood and Mission

Present material from the topic which gives insight into Prabhupāda's mood and mission and that of ISKCON. Briefly discuss the relevant importance of the particular aspects of Prabhupāda's mood and mission presented.

20% Śāstra-cakṣusā

Identify points, verses, concepts related to the world we see around us.
Discuss seeing our world from the view point presented in your section.

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[1] All students are expected to be present for all presentations.
Aggregate grade will be calculated 40% from the mean of the peer assessment and 60% from the facilitator. There will be **no closed book assessment** for Unit 8.

[2] Absentees will not be awarded a grade.

[3] Penalty of 5% may be deducted for late starting & finishing presentations at the discretion of the facilitator.

UNIT 8 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of a given section & clearly explain the main philosophical concepts.
Use charts, diagrams or other visual aids in their explanation.
Identify any concepts which are particularly difficult to understand, if appropriate.
Support philosophical points with Sanskrit verses from the Bhāgavatam Cantos 1-3 and other bhakti-śāstras. (*e.g. Bhagavad-Gita, etc.*)
Present points within 25 minutes, leaving 5 minutes (30 mins total) for questions & answers.
Satisfactorily answer questions in relation to the selected topic.

Personal Application

Present material which is particularly relevant to challenges faced by ISKCON members. Explain how applying the selected material we can improve our spiritual lives.

Preaching (Theological) Application

Identify points, verses, concepts or issues particularly relevant for contemporary preaching or theological application.

Mood and Mission

Present material from the topic which gives insight into Prabhupāda's mood and mission and that of ISKCON. Briefly discuss the relevant importance of the particular aspects of Prabhupāda's mood and mission presented.

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Identify points, verses, concepts related to the world we see around us.
Discuss seeing our world from the view point presented in your section.

UNIT 9 VARĀHA AVATARA

(CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 13-19)

Scheduled Reading Assignments

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 13.7-11; 17.19-29; 18.1-9;
Overview of Chapters 13; 17-19
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 13; 17-19
Additional Questions:

1. What general principles can be drawn from:
    a. Manu's acceptance of Brahma's order
    b. The Kumāra's rejection of Brahma's order (7-11)
2. List specific examples of demoniac qualities (as enumerated in *Bhagavad-gītā* Chapter 16) exhibited by Hiraṇyākṣa (17.19-29; 18.1-9)

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 14.10-16; 38-50
Overview of Chapter 14
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 14
Additional Question:

1. What general principles, relevant for Krsna conscious gṛhastha life, can be drawn from the incident between Diti & Kaśyapa?

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 15.13-28; 32-50;
Overview of Chapter 15
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 15
Additional Question:

1. List some features of the Vaikuṇṭha planets. (13-28)

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 16.6-37
Overview of Chapter 16
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapters 16
Additional Question:

1. Identify statements from verses and purports related to the issue of falling down from Vaikuṇṭha.

Lesson 5

Individual Presentation preparation.

3.13 The Appearance of Lord Varāha

Pūrva-svādhyāya (Preliminary Self Study)

1. Explain why worship of devotees is more potent than the Lord's worship. (3-4)
2. Describe the proper protection the head of a state must provide to the living beings in the material world. (12)
3. Explain the significance of Lord Varāha's appearing,
    a. from the nostril of Brahmā (21- 26)
    b. in the form of a boar (26 -28, 44)
4. Explain how by hearing narrations of the Lord's pastimes, one is relieved of material existence. (48-50).

Analogies:

3.13.40: As a lotus flower with leaves is very beautifully situated, so the world, with its many beautiful mountains, appeared on the tusks of the Lord Boar.

3.13 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA (CHAPTER OVERVIEWS)

Verses 1-13:
Vidura inquired from Maitreya about the activities of Svāyambhuva Manu after obtaining a wife. Manu respectfully requests direction from Brahmā. Brahmā instructs Svāyambhuva Manu to create qualified progeny and protect them.

Verses 14-17:
Manu accepts the order of Brahmā and inquires about a place for himself and the living entities born of him. While Brahmā was engaged in the process of creation, the earth had been inundated by a deluge and had gone down into the depths of the Garbhodaka ocean Manu requests Brahmā to lift the earth from the Garbhodaka ocean. Brahmā considers it best to let the Lord give direction.

Verses 18-25:
While Brahmā was contemplating a solution, a small boar, the size of the upper portion of a thumb, came out of his nostril. The boar then became situated in the sky in a wonderful manifestation as gigantic as a great elephant. After roaring, Lord Varāha (1st incarnation in Day of Brahmā) entered into the Garbhodaka ocean. Lord Varāha searched after the earth by smell. The Lord found the earth on the bottom of the Garbhodaka Ocean, where the planets rest during the devastation at the end of Brahmā's day. Lord Varāha took the earth on His tusks and got it out of the water.

Verses 34-50:
The inhabitants of Jana, Tapas and Satya lokas chanted Vedic hymns to glorify the Lord. Lord Varāha then killed the demon Hiraṇyākṣa & suspended the earth on the edge of His curved white tusks. Maitreya explained that Lord Varāha then placed the earth afloat on surface of the water and He returned to His own abode. Maitreya then glorifies the benefits of hearing the narrations of the Lord's pastimes.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Transcendental body of the Lord in the form of a boar (28, 34-35, 44, 48)

(T/A/R) Hearing pastimes of Lord deliver one from material existence (48-50)
Topics of pure devotee are as good as topics of the Lord. (1-5)

(Eva) Father & son relationship (7-11)

3.14 Pregnancy of Diti in the Evening

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List reasons for Diti's appeal. (10-14)
2. Kaśyapa married how many of Dakṣa's daughters? Explain how the marriages were arranged. (13-14)
3. Explain how husband & wife should cooperate for spiritual advancement. (17)
4. Examine how boys & girls were differently trained in Vedic culture. (17)
5. Why is the wife considered the better half of a man's body? (19)
6. What guidelines given here could help to reduce the divorce rate? (19)
7. Explain why the gṛhastha asram is considered safe? (20-21)
8. What was the main reason for Kaśyapa agreeing to his wife's proposal? (16, 31)
9. Why do ghosts worship Lord Śiva? How does Śiva help them? (24)
10. What is the significance of Śiva's 3 eyes? (25)
11. What can be learnt from Lord Śiva's uncivilized behavior? (27-29)
12. Sex with one's wife, contrary to religious principles, is equivalent to what? (33)
13. Why are dogs considered a condemned species of life? (43)
14. List some of the qualities of Prahlāda Mahārāja. (46-50)

Analogies

3.14.20: The bodily senses are considered plunderers of the fort of the body. The wife is supposed to be the commander of the fort, and therefore whenever there is an attack on the body by the senses, it is the wife who protects the body from being smashed.

3.14.25: Although seen by the police, a criminal is sometimes not immediately punished; the police wait for the proper time to apprehend him. The forbidden time for sexual intercourse would be noted by Lord Śiva, and Diti would meet with proper punishment by giving birth to a child of ghostly character or a godless impersonalist.

3.14.10: Diti, frankly said that her whole body was distressed by sex desire because of her husband's presence, just as a banana tree is troubled by a mad elephant.

3.14 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16:
Vidura asks Maitreya what was the reason for the fight between the demon king and Lord Boar. Maitreya narrates how Diti, daughter of Dakṣa, begged her husband, Kaśyapa, the son of Marīci, to have intercourse with her in the evening to beget a child.

Verses 17-33:
Kaśyapa pacifies his wife by glorifying her, and wives in general, for the invaluable service they render to the husband. Kaśyapa requests Diti to wait because the time was inauspicious as Lord Śiva, ghosts and evil spirits move during this time. Kaśyapa warns his wife not to underestimate the importance of Lord Śiva. Maitreya describes how Diti, pressed by sexual desire, caught hold of the clothing of the great brāhmaṇa sage, just like a shameless public prostitute. Kaśyapa being obligated to her engaged in sex with his wife even though the time was inauspicious.

Verses 34-37:
Diti prays to Kaśyapa for protection against the wrath of Lord Siva.. He is very prone to anger as well as quickly pacified (Rudra and Āśutoṣa). Diti knew that because of his being quickly angered he might spoil the pregnancy she had so unlawfully achieved. But because he was also Āśutoṣa, she implored her brāhmaṇa husband to help her in pacifying Lord Śiva, for her husband was a great devotee of Śiva.

Verses 38-50:
Kaśyapa explained to Diti that everything was inauspicious and thus she would have two contemptuous sons who will kill poor, faultless living entities, torture women. Then the Lord will descend and kill them. Kaśyapa further explained that because of Diti's lamentation, penitence and proper deliberation, ..unflinching faith in the SPG ,adoration for Lord Śiva and her husband, one of the sons [Prahlāda] of her son [Hiraṇyakaśipu] will be an approved devotee of the Lord… Kaśyapa then enumerates some of the qualities of Prahlāda.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Cooperation between husband & wife for spiritual advancement (17-21)
Qualities of Prahlāda (46-50)

(PrA) Comparison of Kaśyapa Muni to Haridāsa Ṭhākura. (31-32)
Role of Lord Śiva (23-29)

(M&M) The unique contribution of Lord Caitanya to human society. (38-40)

3.15 DESCRIPTION OF THE KINGDOM OF GOD

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. List some features of the Vaikuṇṭha planets. (13-27)
2. Describe sexual behavior in Vaikuṇṭha. (20)
3. Who are the most unfortunate persons & why are they unfortunate? (23)
4. Explain the general qualifications for entering Vaikuṇṭha (25, 32-34)
5. How were the four Kumāras able to reach the Vaikuṇṭha planets? (26)
6. What is the significance of the two doormen being of the same age? (27)
7. Analyze spiritual & material anger. (31)
8. Explain why the Kumāras cursed the doormen. (32-34)
9. Comment on the response of the doormen to the curse of the sages. (35-36)
10. Why did the Lord immediately appear after the doormen had been cursed? (37)
11. What was the qualification of the four Kumāras that enabled them to see the Lord directly? (46, 50)
12. What is the significance of the Kumāras not being afraid of being born in any hellish condition of life? (49)

Analogies

3.15.8: Sense gratification is just like salt. One cannot take too much or too little, but one must take some salt in order to make one's foodstuff palatable.

3.15.33: just as in a machine there are hundreds and thousands of parts yet they run in harmony to fulfill the function of the machine, in the Vaikuṇṭha planets the Lord is perfect, and the inhabitants also perfectly engage in the service of the Lord.

3.15.39: To commit an offense against a devotee is very dangerous in devotional service. Lord Caitanya therefore said that an offense to a devotee is just like a mad elephant run loose; when a mad elephant enters a garden, it tramples all the plants. Similarly, an offense unto the feet of a pure devotee murders one's position in devotional service.

3.15.49: …the holes of the ears are like the sky. As the sky can never be filled up, the quality of the ear is such that one may go on pouring in vibrations of various kinds, yet it is capable of receiving more and more vibrations.

3.15 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-10

Diti keeps the embryos in her womb for 100 years fearing that their birth will cause disturbance to the devotees. The demoniac influence of the sons in the womb of Diti expanded darkness throughout the universe. The demigods approached Brahmā for an explanation.

Verses 11-31

Brahmā explains how his sons, the four Kumāras, are free to travel throughout the material & spiritual skies. Brahmā then describes Vaikuṇṭhaloka. Brahmā explains the qualities required to enter the Kingdom of God. Brahmā describes how the four Kumāras entered into Vaikuṇṭha. Upon passing through the first six doors of Vaikuṇṭhapuri the Kumāras were stopped from entering the seventh door by the two doorkeepers there. After being checked the Kumāras became angry.

Verses 32-36

The Kumāras thought the two doorkeepers to be imposters because, considering the Kumāras enemies, their behavior was not in harmony with the Vaikuṇṭha mood. The Kumāras decided that, since the doorkeepers find duality in Vaikuṇṭha, they should be sent to the material world. Realizing they had been cursed by the sages, the doormen fell at their feet and requested that the illusion of forgetting the Lord would not come upon them.

Verses 37-50

At that moment Padmanābha, Lord Nārāyaṇa, arrived with associates and displayed to the Kumāras His beautiful form. When the breeze carrying the aroma of tulasī leaves from the toes of the lotus feet of the Lord entered the nostrils of those sages, they experienced a change from impersonal to personal understanding. The four Kumāras then offered prayers to the Lord.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Qualifications for entering Vaikuṇṭha (25, 32-34)
Spiritual anger (31)

(PrA) Description of Vaikuṇṭha (14-25, 32-33)
The four Kumāras change from impersonal to personal conception (43-50)
Four Kumāras cursing of Jaya & Vijay (32-34)
Beauty and qualities of Nārāyaṇa (38-42)

(M&M) Material disharmony, spiritual harmony & ISKCON (33-34)

3.16 The Two Doorkeepers of Vaikuṇṭha, Jaya and Vijaya, Cursed by the Sages

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain the comparison between the Kumāras and Haridāsa Ṭhākura. (2)
2. An offense by a devotee is considered to be what in relation to the Lord? (4-6)
3. What results from neglecting to care for the helpless under one's protection? (10)
4. How should one face a grievous situation created by a brāhmaṇa? (11)
5. Give evidence proving that once entered Vaikuṇṭha one can never fall down (12)
6. Examine how the Kumāras responded to the speech of the Lord. (14-16)
7. Explain why Laxmī Devī is sometimes envious of Tulasī Devī. (21)
8. Explain how the fighting spirit is present in the Lord. (26)
9. What was the real reason for the cursing of Jaya and Vijaya? (26)
10. What role did Laxmī Devī play in the cursing of Jaya and Vijaya? (30)
11. What is the result of remembering the Lord in anger? (31)
12. Explain the significance of this incident happening at the gate of Vaikuṇṭha. (32)

Analogies

3.16.5: A wrong act committed by a servant leads people in general to blame his master, just as a spot of white leprosy on any part of the body pollutes all of the skin.

3.16.23: When there is a fight between two persons, each of them protects the upper part of his body —the head, the arms and the belly. Similarly, for the actual advancement of human civilization, the best part of the social body, namely the brāhmaṇas, the kṣatriyas and vaiśyas (the intelligent class of men, the military class and the mercantile men) should be given special protection.

3.16.26: It was the Lord's desire to send them (Jaya and Vijaya) to the material world, not perpetually, but for some time. Therefore, just as on a theatrical stage someone takes the part of enemy to the proprietor of the stage, although the play is for a short time and there is no permanent enmity between the servant and the proprietor, so the sura janas (devotees) were cursed by the sages to go to the asura jana, or atheistic families.

3.16 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

1-12
Padmanābha told the four Kumāras that He approved of the curse. In fact He took responsibility for the mistake of the doormen and sought forgiveness from the Kumāras. The Lord explained that he would cut of His arm if it was hostile to His devotees & that because He is the servant of His devotees His lotus feet have become so pure. The Lord then requested that the doormen be allowed to return to His presence soon.

13-26
The Kumāras were astonished by the illuminating speech of the Lord because of its most profound significance. The Kumāras understood that they had cursed two faultless persons and were prepared to accept punishment from the Lord. Śrī-bhagavān explained that that the punishment inflicted by the Kumāras was originally ordained by Him. Therefore the doormen will fall to a birth in a demoniac family and will be firmly united with the Lord through intensified anger, and then return to His abode shortly.

27-32
The four Kumāras then circumambulated Padmanābha, offered obeisances and departed. The Lord explained to Jaya & Vijaya that their departure was foretold by Lakṣmī, because when she left His abode and then returned, they stopped her at the gate while He was sleeping. The Lord returned to His abode.

33-37
As Jaya & Vijaya, their luster diminished by the curse of the brāhmaṇas, fell from Vaikuṇṭha, the demigods roared with disappointment. Lord Brahmā explained that the doormen entered the womb of Diti and that the prowess of these twin demons was the cause of the darkness in the universe. Brahmā concluded that there was no remedy within his power because the Lord Himself desired all this and He alone will come to our rescue.

Discussion Topics

(PrA/ ThA) Falling down from Vaikuṇṭha. (12, 26-27, 32, 35)

(PrA) The Lord desires to fight in the material world. (26, 29, 36)
The Lord's affection to Jaya & Vijaya, & the four Kumāras. (1-12)

(SC) Seeing reverses as the grace of the Lord (36-37)

(M&M) Protection of the Vaiṣṇavas & brāhmaṇas. (4,6,8, 17, 23)
Ordered by Lord to preach.. cannot be counteracted by anyone (36)

Chapter 17: Victory of Hiraṇyākṣa Over All the Directions of the Universe.
Chapter 18: The Battle Between Lord Boar and the Demon Hiraṇyākṣa
Chapter 19: The Killing of the Demon Hiraṇyākṣa

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. By hearing from authority, the demigods were free from what emotion? (17.1)
2. List some of the ill omens you find particularly terrific. (17.2-15)
3. What is the significance of the natural disturbances on this planet? (17.4)
4. Explain how Hiraṇyākṣa, who was born first was considered younger than Hiraṇyakaśipu? (17.18)
5. How was the earth able to float on the water? (18.8)
6. How is the Lord distinguished from all the other residents of Vaikuṇṭha? (19.15)
7. How did the Lord feel about the attack of the demon? (19.16)
8. What happened to Diti shortly before the death of her demoniac son? (19.23)
9. The demon tried to crush the Lord in his embrace, but the Lord, to his surprise, stayed outside his arms. What is the lesson to be learned from this? (19.25)
10. How is one purified of sinful reactions simply by hearing the pastime of the Lord killing Hiraṇyākṣa? (19.27)
11. If the *Bhāgavatam* kicks out materially motivated religion why are "extraordinary merit, wealth, fame, [and] longevity" offered to hearers of this pastime? (19.28)

Analogies

3.18.6: But seeing that the earth on the ends of His tusks was frightened, He rose out of the water just as an elephant emerges with its female companion when assailed by an alligator.

3.18.24: the Lord could have killed the demon at once, but He played with him in the same way as a child plays with a snake before killing it.

3.19.16: Hit in this manner by the demon, O Vidura, the Lord, who had appeared as the first boar, did not feel the least quaking in any part of His body, any more than an elephant would when struck with a wreath of flowers.

3.18.13: The demon, being thus challenged by the Personality of Godhead, became angry and agitated, and *he trembled in anger like a challenged cobra.*

3.18.19: In their eagerness to win, they performed maneuvers of various kinds, and *their contest looked like an encounter between two forceful bulls for the sake of a cow.*

3.19.13: He now took a trident which was as rapacious as a flaming fire and *hurled it against the Lord, the enjoyer of all sacrifices, even as one would use penance for a malevolent purpose against a holy brāhmaṇa.*

3.19.26: His arms and legs broken and the hair on his head scattered, *he fell down dead, like a gigantic tree uprooted by the wind.*

3.17-19 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Chapter 17: Victory of Hiraṇyākṣa Over All the Directions of the Universe.
Verses 1-23
After hearing Brahmā's explanation of the darkness in the universe, the enlightened demigods returned to their respective abodes. At the time of birth of the two demons many ill omens occurred. The two demons were very strongly built. Hiraṇyākṣa traveled all over the universe in a challenging mood. The demigods left their abodes in the heavens in fear of him.

Verses 24-31
He entered the ocean and scattered the aquatics. He moved about the ocean for many years and eventually found Varuṇa, who he challenged in battle. Varuṇa responded that he was too old for battle and that Hiraṇyākṣa should approach Lord Viṣṇu to satisfy his fighting spirit.

Chapter 18: The Battle Between Lord Boar and the Demon Hiraṇyākṣa
Verses 1-28
On seeing the Lord lift the earth from the depths of the ocean, Hiraṇyākṣa challenged Him. The Lord spoke harsh words to the demon in retaliation. Lord Varāha and Hiraṇyākṣa begin to fight. Brahmā appears on the scene, and requests the Lord to kill Hiraṇyākṣa immediately.

Chapter 19: The Killing of the Demon Hiraṇyākṣa
Verses 1-38
The Lord and Hiraṇyākṣa continue to fight, and the Lord eventually kills him.
The demigods offer prayers to the Lord. Maitreya explained to Vidura that after killing the demon, the Lord returned to own abode. Suta Goswami explains the benefits of hearing from sages about this pastime of the Lord

Discussion Topics

(ThA) Birth of demons causes natural disturbances (17.4, 5, 15)
Garbhādhāna-saṁskāra for peace in the world (17.15)

(PrA) Demoniac attitude toward God (18.4, 6, 10)
Hear kṛṣṇa-kathā from proper authority (milk-snake analogy) (19.32-33, 37) The Lord is the protector of His devotees from all dangers (19.30, 35)

(M&M) Devotees overcome death blows (18.15)

(SC) Strong body means advanced nation (17.17)

(PeA) Feeling grateful for benedictions offered by the Lord. (19.36)

UNIT 9

CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 13-19

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Personal Application

1. Discuss how Lord Śiva is an ideal example for devotional life with reference to 3.14.29.

2. Discuss how you should face a grievous situation created by a brāhmaṇa with reference to 3.16.11. How can you personally apply the lessons given in this connection?

Preaching Application

3. Identify general principles from the example of Diti & Kaśyapa which are applicable in Krsna conscious gṛhastha life. Give appropriate references in your answer.

Mood & Mission

4. Discuss material disharmony, spiritual harmony and its relevance to ISKCON with reference to 3.15.33-34.

UNIT 9 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of the incident between Diti and Kaśyapa, Varāha-lila & the fall ofJaya & Vijaya from Vaikuṇṭha.

Evaluation

Identify principles regarding father & son relationships from the example of Brahmā and the Kumāras (13.7-11) & examine these principles in relation to current social & administrative issues in ISKCON.
Identify positive and negative aspects of Diti's actions and discuss their respective results.14.38-45

Personal Application

Give examples from Krsna conscious gṛhastha life how.. "…a faithful wife can cooperate with her husband" as in the case of Diti and Kaśyapa (14.17)
Discuss how Lord Śiva is an ideal example for devotional life (14.29)
Reflect on the Qualities of Prahlāda in relation to their personal application (14.46-50)
Discuss how should one face a grievous situation created by a brāhmaṇa (16.11)

Preaching Application

Identify general principles from the example of Diti & Kaśyapa which are applicable in Krsna conscious gṛhastha life
Discuss what the incident between Diti & Kaśyapa teaches us about the process of conceiving a child. (14.38-39)
Discuss the role of Lord Śiva (14.23-39)
Discuss the relationship between Śiva, ghosts & Māyāvādīs. (14.23-39)
Describe features of the Vaikuṇṭha planets. (15.13-28)
Explain the relevance for preaching of the Kumāras changing from impersonal to personal conception (15.43-50)
Discuss the issue of falling down from Vaikuṇṭha, from different points of view, in relation to the example of Jaya & Vijaya. (16.12, 26-27, 32, 35)
Discuss the relevance for ISKCON of general principles drawn from the example of the Lord reciprocating with the Kumāras 16. 6-12
Describe the demoniac attitude toward God with reference to the example of Hiraṇyākṣa (18.4-10)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Discuss the relationship between natural disturbances on this planet and increase of demoniac population (17.4-14)
Discuss the example of Jaya & Vijaya in regard to seeing apparent reverses as the grace of the Lord (16.36-37)

Mood & Mission

Discuss material disharmony, spiritual harmony and its relevance to ISKCON (15.33-34)

UNIT 10 KARDAMA MUNI & DEVAHUTI

(CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 20-24)

Scheduled Reading Assignments

Lesson 1

Overview of Chapter 20
Specific texts: 20.1; 4; 9; 18; 25
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 20

Lesson 2

Overview of Chapter 21
Specific texts: 21.1; .5; 13-22; 54-.55
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 21

Lesson 3

Overview of Chapter 22
Specific texts: 22.5-13; 19; 23; 33-37
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 22

Lesson 4

Overview of Chapter 23
Specific texts: 23.1- 8; 6; 10; 56
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 23

Lesson 5

Overview of Chapter 24
Specific texts: 24.1; 6; 13; 25-34
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 24

3.20 Conversation Between Maitreya and Vidura

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What is the duration of each Manu's period? (1)
2. What general principle does Prabhupāda draw from the example of Vidura's giving up the company of his elder brother? (2)
3. What is the effect of traveling to places of pilgrimage (4)
4. Why has Narottama dāsa Ṭhākura forbidden us to go to such places of pilgrimage? (4)
5. Explain the cause of material creation. (12)
6. What is the atheist's theory? (18)
7. Explain the significance of sex in regard to demoniac & divine life. (23)
8. Examine Prabhupāda's comment on homosexuality. (26)
9. What is meant by Brahmā 'giving up his present body'? (28)
10. The beginning of evening is the period for what? (30)
11. Analyze the difference between a demon and a devotee. (31, 34)
12. What is the purpose of sporting events with the opposite sex? (35)
13. Explain the difference between material and spiritual enjoyment (35)
14. Who are the Gandharvas and Apsarās? (38)
15. What are the results of the Śrāddha ceremony? (43)
16. Do the devotee need to perform such ritualistic ceremonies as śrāddha? (43)

Analogies

3.20.17: Just as a highly posted manager is almost as independent as the owner of a firm, Brahmā is described here as independent because, as the Lord's representative to control the universe, he is almost as powerful and independent as the Lord

3.20.35: A patient is advised by the experienced physician to refrain from ordinary enjoyment while in the diseased condition. A diseased person cannot enjoy anything; he has to restrain his enjoyment in order to get rid of the disease. Similarly, our material condition is a diseased condition. If one wants to enjoy real sense enjoyment, then one must get free of the entanglement of material existence.

3.20.36: As moths at night surround a fire and are killed, so the demons become victims of the movements of the ball-like breasts of a beautiful woman. The scattered hair of a beautiful woman also afflicts the heart of a lusty demon.

3.20 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11

Śrī Śaunaka asked Sūta Gosvāmī to continue narrating the talks between Vidura and Maitreya. Sūta Gosvāmī explained that Vidura, pleased to hear the narration of Lord Boar, then inquired how Brahmā created living beings after evolving the Prajāpatis, how the Prajāpatis created and evolved this universe, and how their wives assisted them.

Verses 12-16

Maitreya then summarizes sarga, the initial creation by Viṣṇu: When the equilibrium of the combination of the three modes of nature was agitated by the unseen activity of the living entity, by Mahā-Viṣṇu and by the force of time, the mahat-tattva was produced, which, in turn, produced three kinds of false ego, which in turn, evolved many groups of five principles. Combining with the help of the energy of the Supreme Lord, they produced a shining egg, which the Lord entered it as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, sprouting from His navel an effulgent lotus, the reservoir of all conditioned souls, and the birth place of Brahmā.

Verses 17-53

Maitreya then summarizes visarga, the secondary creation by Brahmā. Brahmā began by creating the five kinds of ignorance that cover the conditioned souls. When Brahmā threw off this body of ignorance, the Yakṣas and Rākṣasas seized it. Overpowered by hunger and thirst, they went to devour Brahmā. Next Brahmā produced the chief demigods, shining with goodness. After that he produced from his buttocks, demons who attacked him for sex life, and in fear Brahmā sought protection from the Lord. The Lord ordered Brahmā to cast off that subtle body which took the form of twilight. The deluded demons saw the twilight as a beautiful girl who awakened their lust. After speaking words of infatuation, they seized her. Next from Brahmā's own loveliness, he manifested the hosts of Gandharvas and Apsarās, from his sloth, the ghosts and fiends, from his navel, the Sādhyas and Pitās, from his power of invisibility came the Siddhas and Vidyādharas, from his reflection, Kimpuruṣas and Kinnaras, from his stretched out body, came the snakes, and from his mind, came man. The demigods and others praised the creation of man, who would please the demigods by acts of sacrifice. Lord Brahmā, having equipped himself with saintly qualities, manifested the great sages.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) The effect of traveling to places of pilgrimage (4)
Give up the sinful thought, it may be said that we give up the body. (28)

(PrA) The coverings of ignorance of the conditioned souls (18)
Kṛṣṇa consciousness is sum total of good work for family, society etc. (43)

(ThA) When the conditioned soul first desired to lord it over material nature (12)
Homosexuality is demoniac. (26)

BRAHMA'S CREATIONS (3.20.19-53)

1. Body of ignorance (night)	taken by Yaksas and Raksasas.
2. Boy of goodness (daytime)	taken by demigods
3. From buttocks	demons
4. Impure body (twilight)	mistaken for a beautiful damsel
5. Body of loveliness	Gandharvas and Apsaras
6. moonlight	Visvavasu and others
7. From sloth	ghosts and fiends
8. Sleep that causes drooling	ghosts and hobgoblins
9. From his invisible form (navel)	Sādhyas and Pitās.
10. Ability to be hidden from vision (Antardhána)	Siddhas and Vidyádharas
11. Reflection (shadowy form) (daybreak)	Kimpurusas and Kinnaras
12. Hair on his body (lying down)	snakes
13. Mind	Manus
14. From body strengthened by penance, adoration, mental concentration, absorption in devotion, dispassion	sages (beloved sons)

3. 21 Conversation Between Manu and Kardama

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Who were the two great sons of Svāyambhuva Manu? (2))
2. List some of the difficulties of practicing aṣṭāṅga-yoga in this age (6-8, 12).
3. How does a Kṛṣṇa conscious person accept the form of Kṛṣṇa is described in the Vedic literature? (11)
4. Explain the significance of the phrase "like disposition". (15)
5. In astrology, who is considered the most fortunate man? (15)
6. What is the advantage of worshiping the Lord for material enjoyment? (15)
7. Why did Kardama Muni want to enjoy material life in spite of his personally seeing and experiencing the Supreme Lord? (16)
8. Who can be freed from the primary necessities of the material body.(17)
9. Explain how the "wheel of time" cannot touch devotees (18).
10. What does one require before he can aspire for liberation? (21)
11. Examine how the Lord fulfills the desires of a sincere devotee. (23-24)
12. What was the Vedic system for selecting a suitable husband for a girl? (27)
13. What general principle does Prabhupāda draw fro the example of Kardama Muni and Devahūti having their respective desires fulfilled? (28-30)
14. Explain the difference between Vibhinnāṁśa, svāṁśa, and kalā expansions.(32)
15. Describe the flapping wings of the Lord's carrier, Garuḍa. (34)
16. Why didn"t Manu engage an agent to find a husband for his daughter? (36)
17. Describe Bindu-sarovara (39-44)
18. Comment on the sage Kardama's reception of the king. (51)

Analogies

3.21.32: Every candle has the full potential candlepower, but there is still the distinction that one candle is the first, another the second, another the third and another the fourth. Similarly, there is no difference between the immediate expansion of the Lord and His secondary expansion.

3.21.32: Even if a gem just taken from a mine looks unpolished, the luster of the gem cannot be stopped. Similarly, although Kardama was not properly dressed and his body was not properly cleansed, his overall appearance was gemlike.

3.21.54: They are like the sun (The divisions of varṇas and āśramas), a creation of God, and therefore will remain. Either covered by clouds or in a clear sky, the sun will continue to exist. Similarly, when the varṇāśrama system becomes degraded, it appears as a hereditary caste system

3.21 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11

Vidura inquired from Maitreya about the descendents of Svāyambhuva Manu. After mentioning Priyavrata and Uttānapāda, he inquired about his three daughters, first Devahūti, and then the others who married Ruci and Dakṣa. Maitreya explained how, commanded by Lord Brahmā to beget children in the worlds, Kardama Muni practiced penance for ten thousand years and pleased the Lord. The Lord revealed His transcendental form, with yellow dress, ornaments including the Kaustubha gem and mark of Srivatsa, His curling dark hair, with His usual four symbols in His four arms, except with a lily replacing the lotus, and His lotus feet placed on the shoulders of Garuḍa.

Verses 12-34

Kardama Muni bowed down to the Lord, with folded hands, and admitted that less intelligent people ask for material blessings from the Lord. He then asked for a wife of like disposition. He praised the Lord for his creation etc., being the benefactor of all. Seated on Garuḍa, the Lord spoke to Kardama, assuring him He already had arranged to fulfill his desire and that persons like Kardama who have given everything to Him never experience frustration. The Lord explained "Svāyambhuva Manu and his wife will come to deliver their daughter as your wife. She is just the kind of woman that you have been looking for. She will give you nine daughters and My own plenary portion will appear and I will instruct her in Sāṅkhya." The Lord returned to Vaikuṇṭha on Garuḍa, vibrating the Sāma Veda by his flapping wings…

Verses 35-56

Svāyambhuva Manu approached Kardama at Bindu-sarovara and saw him to be somewhat soiled, though invigorated from the Lord's sidelong glance, like an unpolished gem. Seeing that the monarch was bowing before him, the sage greeted him with benediction and received him with due honor. He praised the emperor for embodying the protecting energy of Śrī Hari and thereby saving the world from unrighteousness. Kardama asked him about the purpose of his visit, and promised to carry out his order.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Fulfillment of desires should be entrusted to the Supreme Lord (28-30)
brahmacārī .. look very healthy and lustrous. (47)

(PrA) Difficulties of practicing aṣṭāṅga-yoga in this age of Kali (6-8,12).
Material sound and spiritual sound are completely different (22)
Worshiping the Supreme Person for material enjoyment. (15, 21)
Boys and girls of similar dispositions were married (15)
Degradation of varṇas and āśramas. (52-56)

(M&M) Not compassionate to people in general = third-class devotee..
To award fearlessness to the common man is the greatest act of charity..
Householder has the duty to spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness at home (31)

(AMI) not everyone is competent to be liberated (16, 21, 34)

3.22 The Marriage of Kardama Muni and Devahūti

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Describe the reciprocal relationship of the brāhmaṇas and the kṣatriyas. (1-4)
2. Explain how the favor of the spiritual master is not received through any other part of the body but the ears. (7)
3. What is the right of a disciple who is perfectly in consonance with the spiritual master? (8)
4. What is considered to be a humbling of one's position in regard to seeking a wife? (12-13)
5. What can we learn from the incident of Svāyambhuva Manu, the emperor, offering his daughter to a poor brāhmaṇa, Kardama Muni? (13)
6. List the two kinds of brahmacārīs. (14)
7. What was the most important consideration made by Kardama Muni before accepting the daughter of Svāyambhuva Manu? (15)
8. What two interesting facilities of Vedic life are indicated by the incident concerning Viśvāvasu? (17)
9. Describe the two kinds of children born of good fathers (19)
10. Comment on the condition with which Kardama Muni agreed to accept Devahūti as his wife (19-20)
11. Parent's responsibility to their children continues until what point? (24)
12. Describe some of the qualities & activities of the citizens of Barhiṣmatī, that we can apply in our own lives. (28-38)

Analogies

3.22.4. One man thinks that the sun is on his head only, whereas five thousand miles away another man is thinking that the sun is only on his head. Similarly, the Supersoul, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is one, but He appears to individually oversee each individual soul.

3.22.35. As freshly prepared food is very tasteful but if kept for three or four hours becomes stale and tasteless, so the existence of material enjoyment can endure as long as life is fresh, but at the fag end of life everything becomes tasteless, and everything appears to be vain and painful.

3.22 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-14

After Kardama spoke of the emperor's exalted qualities, Manu explained how Brahmā created the *brāhmaṇas,* who are full of austerity and knowledge and are averse to sense gratification. The *brāhmaṇas* are said to be His heart and the *kṣatriyas* His arms. Manu explained that his daughter was seeking a suitable husband and by hearing from Nārada of Kardama's good qualities, she fixed her mind on him. He thus offered his daughter to the sage to be his wife. He recommended that the sage accept his offer, rather than reject it, and later have to look elsewhere, risking degradation.

Verses 15-27:

Kardama confirmed his desire to marry. He then glorified Devahūti's beauty, womanhood, and chastity. He mentions how a Gandharva captivated by her beauty, fell from his airplane after seeing her playing on the roof of the palace. Kardama agreed to the marriage proposal on the condition that after his wife had children, that he might accept the life of devotional service. Understanding the minds of his wife and daughter, Manu gladly gave his qualified daughter to the equally qualified Kardama, and his wife presented the couple with gifts. Relieved of his responsibility to get his daughter married, he cried tears of separation from his daughter, and he, his wife, and their retinue returned to their capital.

Verses 28-39:

Arriving at Barhiṣmatī, though he was greeted by his joyful subjects, he first worshiped the Lord. Then he entered his palace, which was filled with an atmosphere that eradicated the three miseries of material existence. He always acted according to religious principles and listened to the Lord's pastimes daily with love. Thus although absorbed in material happiness, he was not dragged to the lowest grade of life, for he always enjoyed his material happiness in a Kṛṣṇa conscious atmosphere. Because he ever engaged in hearing, contemplating, writing down and chanting the pastimes of the Lord, after his long life he attained the spiritual world. During his life Svāyambhuva Manu, out of compassion, taught the diverse sacred duties of men including *varṇāśrama* dharma. Maitreya next promised to speak of the flourishing of his daughter Devahūti.

Discussion Topics

(M&M) ..he requested this humble self to preach in the Western countries (5)
Everyone must promote devotional service for the pleasure of the Lord. (31)
Kṛṣṇa consciousness movement gives people best opportunity ... (34)

(PeA) A saintly person has power to give immediate liberation to conditioned soul (5-6)
Favor of the spiritual master is received through the ears only. (7)
Example of devotional service of Svāyambhuva Manu (32-38)

(PrA) Cooperation within Varṇāśrama-dharma (2-4)

3. 23 Devahūti's Lamentation

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What is the meaning of sādhvī? (1)
2. Briefly explain the ideal of a householder's life. (1)
3. Describe how a wife should deal with her husband (2-5)
4. What results from appropriately serving:
   a) a qualified husband, b) a qualified guru, c) the Supreme Lord? (7-8)
5. Explain the import of the word 'strī' (10)
6. Why did Devahūti want to a) improve her bodily condition, b) arrange for a suitable house? (11)
7. List some of the attractive features of Kardama Muni's aerial mansion (14-21)
8. Why had Devahūti neglected her bodily dress and comforts? (24, 37)
9. Briefly describe the qualifications of Kardama Muni (42)
10. How did traveling all over the universe, with her husband, affect Devahūti ? (44)
11. Why did Kardama Muni expand himself into nine forms? (44, 47)
12. What general principles can be drawn from the incident of Kardama Muni expanding himself into nine forms? (44)
13. What should be understood from the example of Kardama Muni preparing to leave home? (49)
14. Explain Devahūti's final request from her husband? (51-53)
15. Why did Devahūti lament? (54-57)

3.23 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11

Maitreya continued: After the departure of her parents, Devahūti, neglecting her own body, served her husband constantly with intimacy, great respect, love and sweet words. Kardama expressed his pleasure at her service and bestowed upon her the blessings of the Lord which he had received by his spiritual austerities. He also blessed her with the ability to appreciate such transcendental gifts. Devahūti was very satisfied. She then reminded her husband about his promise to have children with her and desired a suitable body and residence for that purpose.

Verses 12-38

Sage Kardama exercised his yogic power and instantly produced a very opulent and well decorated seven-story aerial mansion that could travel at his will. He also arranged one thousand Gandharva maidservants to bath, dress, and decorate Devahūti, so that she regained her former beauty as a princess, and he placed her on the mansion. Though seemingly attached to his beloved consort, the sage did not lose his glory, which was mastery over his self.

Verses 38-48

In that aerial mansion he traveled to the pleasure valleys of Mount Meru, in different heavenly gardens, and by the Mānasa-sarovara Lake, enjoying with his wife for many years. What is difficult to achieve for determined men who have taken refuge of the Supreme Lord's lotus feet? After showing his wife the globe of the universe and its different arrangements, the great yogī Kardama Muni returned to his own hermitage. He divided himself into nine personalities just to give pleasure to Devahūti, who was eager for sex life. He impregnated Devahūti with nine discharges of semen. Devahūti, and gave birth to charming daughters, fragrant with the scent of the red lotus flower.

Verses 49-57

When she saw her husband about to leave home, Devahūti requested Kardama to give her the gift of fearlessness, lamenting that they wasted so much time in sense gratification. She lamented that she obtained Kardama's association, which gives liberation from material bondage, but she did not seek such liberation.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) How a wife should deal with her husband (2-5)
Duty of the husband to liquidate his debt to his wife. (52)
Devahūti lamentation (54-57)

(AMI) Sexual appetite of a woman is nine times greater than that of a man (44)

3. 24 THE RENUNCIATION OF KARDAMA MUNI

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Who is called Svayambhū and why? (9)
2. Why is Brahmā sometimes called svarāṭ and aja? (10)
3. Explain the difference between kalā and aṁśa. (10)
4. How can one overcome the four defects? (12)
5. How should the son or disciple accept the words of his father or guru? (13)
6. How does Bhāgavatam foretell married life in this age of Kali? (15)
7. Summarize the main point of purport to verse 29.
8. List and briefly explain the two types of devotees mentioned in purport to verse 34.
9. Since God Himself was present in Kardama's home—why should he leave? (35)
10. Why is sannyāsa prohibited in this age of Kali-yuga? (35)
11. What is the main purpose of sannyāsa? (35)
12. What is the position of a woman who is left by her husband? (40)
13. Explain what is meant by 'going to the forest'? (41)
14. Why is a sannyāsī freed from the responsibility to offer fire sacrifice? (42)
15. Explain what is the last snare of māyā. (45)

Analogies

3.24.6: Fire is already present in wood, but by a certain process, fire is kindled. Similarly, God is all-pervading. He is everywhere, and since He may come out from everything, He appeared in His devotee's semen.

3.24.13: As a man cannot separate his life from his body, a disciple cannot separate the order of the spiritual master from his life.

3.24.39: Since the sunshine is the luster of the sun planet, by seeing the sun one automatically sees the sunshine; similarly, by seeing the Supreme Personality of Godhead one simultaneously sees and experiences the Paramātmā feature as well as the impersonal Brahman feature of the Supreme.

3.24.41: Alone in a field, if one falls into a blind well and no one is there to save him, he may cry for years, and no one will see or hear where the crying is coming from. Death is sure. Similarly, those who are forgetful of their eternal relationship with the Supreme Lord are in the blind well of family life; their position is very ominous.

3.24 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-8:
Recalling Lord Viṣṇu's words, Kardama Muni told Devahūti that the Lord would become her son, and he advised her to worship the Lord with great faith. Thus the Lord would vanquish the knot in Devahūti's heart by becoming her son and teaching knowledge of devotional service. After many years, the Lord entered the semen of Kardama & appeared in Devahūti.

Verses 9-25:
Brahmā, Marīci and other sages went to Kardama's hermitage because Brahmā knew that a portion of the Supreme Lord, had appeared in the womb of Devahūti. After worshiping the Lord, Brahmā glorified Kardama for carrying out his order as an ideal son, and he praised Kardama's nine daughters for helping to increase the population, urging Kardama to find them suitable husbands to assist them. Brahmā then glorified the Lord's descent as Kapila Muni. Brahmā, along with the Kumāras and Nārada then left for the higher planets. Then Kardama Muni handed over his nine daughters to the nine great sages.

Verses 26-40
When Kapiladeva had descended, Kardama approached Him, offered obeisances and praised His appearance. Kardama was grateful that Lord mercifully appeared in the home of an ordinary householder like him, and he praised Him for increasing the honor of His devotees and disseminating the process of real knowledge. Kardama surrendered to the lotus feet of Lord Kapila, and begged for the Lord's permission to renounce his family life.
Lord Kapila said He appeared to keep His promise to become Kardama's son and to explain Sāṅkhya philosophy, which is highly esteemed for self-realization by those desiring freedom from material bondage, because in time this path had been lost. The Lord sanctioned Kardama's sannyasa telling Kardama to surrender all activities to Him. The Lord promised to speak His sublime knowledge to His mother, so that she could also attain perfection.

Verses 41-47:
Kardama Muni circumambulated the Lord, and at once left for the forest. Accepting a vow of silence to think of God alone, without association, he traveled all over as a sannyāsī, without relationship with fire or shelter. He fixed his mind upon the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and thus became liberated from conditioned life and became self-situated in transcendental devotional service to the Personality of Godhead. He began to see that the Lord is seated in everyone's heart, and that everyone is existing on Him. Thus Kardama Muni attained the path back to Godhead.

Discussion Topics

(PrA/ThA) Modern marriage compared to Vedic Marriage (15)

(PrA) He always remains the Lord, even if He appears as son ... (6, 16)

(PeA) Acceptance of sannyāsa in Kali-yuga (34-35, 40-42)

UNIT 10 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of the meeting of Kardama Muni & Devahuti
Reconcile the apparent contradiction, to visit Pilgrimage places as Vidura did or not to visit (Narottama Das thakur's instruction) (20.4)
Summarize Visarga - Brahma's creation (3.20)

Personal Application

Explain the personal relevance of he following concept: "One who is attracted by the beauty of Radha and Krsna cannot be attracted by the false beauty of this material world." (20.31)
Comment on the significance of the relationship between the bonafide spiritual master and disciple (22.5-7)

Preaching Application

Present an explanation of the interrelationship brāhmaṇas and kṣatriyas (22.1-4)
Present an explanation of the purpose of sex life to a contempory audience (22.19)
Present the principle, as shown by Kardama Muni, of praying to the Lord in every transaction of material existenceto fulfill one's heart's desire. 21.24-28
Draw general principles from the ideal example of the husband & wife relationship between Devahuti Kardama Muni (23.1- 8)

Academic Integrity

Present an appropriate understanding of the example of Svāyambhuva Manu who enjoyed his material happiness in a Kṛṣṇa conscious atmosphere. (22.34)
Discuss appropriate & inappropriate application of the following principle, ".A girl is never allowed to select her own husband independently." (21.27)

Evaluation

Discuss, from various angles of vision, the performance of Śrāddha as mentioned in 20.43
Evaluate, in difference circumstances, the relevance of the following statements:

- Kardama Muni's prayers, in 21.13-17, regarding finding a suitable wife.
- A householder must leave home after his fiftieth year (24.34-35)

Sastric Authority

Comment on their acceptance of the following statement: "Each planet has its particular climatic influences and particular types of inhabitants" (.23.43)

MODULE 1 STUDENT PRESENTATION OBJECTIVES

During the presentation students should be able to:

35% Understanding
Accurately present an outline of a particular theme, event, or series of events from Cantos 1-3.
Clearly explain, in some depth, philosophical points and subtle nuances of meaning from the selected topic.
Resolve any apparent contradictions which may be found in the selected topic.
Identify particular Sanskrit words/phrases, from the selected text, related to the philosophical points presented.

10% Academic Integrity
Select material from the topic and explain how it could be misused. Explain the fallacy of its misuse.

15 % Mood and Mission
Present material from the topic which gives insight into Prabhupāda's mood and mission and that of ISKCON.
Discuss the relevant importance of the particular aspects of Prabhupāda's mood and mission presented.

25 % Preaching Application
Identify points, verses, concepts or issues particularly relevant for contemporary preaching or theological application.
Quote from memory at least two appropriate verses from the Bhāgavatam in general and give specific attention to some Sanskrit words in at least 1 of the verses.
Support the above points with scriptural references, examples or analogies, appropriate to the topic, from the Bhāgavatam in general and other bhakti-śāstras. (*e.g. Bhagavad-Gita, etc.*)
Present points suitable to the audience, making the topic accessible.
Present points within 30 minutes, leaving 5 to 10 minutes (**40 mins total**) for questions & answers.
Satisfactorily answer questions in relation to the selected topic.

15 % Personal Application
Present material from the selected theme, event, or series of events which is particularly relevant to you.
Explain how by applying the selected material you can overcome challenges you may be facing in your spiritual life. *(Optional)*

Each presentation will be assessed by the students and by the facilitator. Aggregate grade will be calculated 40% from the mean of the peer assessment and 60% from the facilitator.

UNIT 11 KAPILA SIKSHA 1

(CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 26-29)

Scheduled Reading Assignments

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 25.21-25; 38-41
Overview of Chapter 25
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 25

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 26.10-61
Overview of Chapter 26.10-61
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 26

Lesson 3

Specific texts: 27.1-9; 21-22
Overview of Chapter 27
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 27

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 28.13-33
Overview of Chapter 28
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 28.

Lesson 5

Specific texts: 29.8-26
Overview of Chapter 29
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 29

3. 25 The Glories of Devotional Service

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Briefly describe levels of consciousness in the three modes. (1)
2. What is the purpose of the Vedas? (1)
3. Why was Devahūti interested to hear transcendental messages? (7)
4. Explain why Devahūti said, "My engagement in sense gratification was also due to You." (10)
5. Explain how all activities but service to the Lord are sinful. (10)
6. Define puruṣa, prakṛti and saṁsāra. (11)
7. What does the example of drinking milk and maintaining a cow indicate? (13)
8. Explain what is meant by brahma-siddhi. (19)
9. Analyze the importance of attachment as explained by Śrī Kapiladeva in text 20.
10. What is the result of association with a sādhu? (20, 25)
11. Summarize Prabhupada's purport commenting on each of the 6 symptoms of a sādhu (21)
12. Examine the import of the phrase *mat-kṛte tyakta-karmāṇas* (22)
13. Explain the example of the cat, kittens and the rat (24)
14. Summarize the main point of text 30.
15. List reasons explaining how bhakti is superior to yoga and mukti (32-34, 36, 41)
16. Why does the Lord accept the form of the arcā-vigraha.(35)
17. Explain the importance of the word *vilāsa* (36)
18. Explain how the position of transcendental service cannot be destroyed. (38)
19. What is a devotees attitude toward temporary household or social life. (39-40).

Analogies

3.25.18: As the contamination of the germs of a particular disease can influence a weaker person, similarly the influence of material nature, or illusory energy, can act on the weaker, or conditioned, soul but not on the liberated soul.

3. 25 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-11:
Śaunaka asks Śrī Sūta Gosvāmī to describe Lord Kapila's activities and pastimes. Maitreya told Vidura that when Kardama left for the forest, Lord Kapila stayed at Bindu-sarovara to please His mother, Devahūti. Devahūti admits that due to false ego, she has been engaged by *māyā,* and has identified herself with her body. She inquires from Him as to the relationship between man and woman and between spirit and matter.

Verses 12-19:
Lord Kapila replied that when one is completely cleansed of the impurities of lust and greed produced from false identification one sees everything in the right perspective; he becomes indifferent to material existence. Perfection in self-realization cannot be attained by any kind of yogī unless he engages in bhakti.

Verses 20-27:
Lord Kapila explains that although attachment for the material is the soul's greatest entanglement, attachment to the self-realized devotees, opens the door of liberation, and he lists the sādhu's qualities, beginning with tolerance and mercy, advising his mother to take shelter of such holy souls. Devotional service increases, step by step, in the association of devotees.

Verses 28-44:
Devahūti asked (1) By what kind of devotional service can I immediately attain the service of Your lotus feet? (2) What is the mystic yoga system that completely ends material existence? (3) How many ways can we understand that yoga? In response Kapila described the Sāṅkhya system of philosophy, a combination of devotional service and mystic realization. He explained that when the mind's service spirit is engaged in the Lord's devotional service, without any motive, that is far better even than salvation. Such *bhakti* dissolves the subtle body of the living entity without separate effort, just as fire in the stomach digests all that we eat. Seeing and talking with the Lord, the pure devotee forgets everything else. Pure devotees do not desire anything up to liberation, but are satisfied hearing and chanting the Lord's glories, yet the Lord gives them material opulence, mystic perfections, and ultimately promotion to the kingdom of God.

Discussion Topics

(PeA/ M&M) Association with a sādhu (20, 24-26)
The symptoms of a sādhu (21-23)

(FC/PrA) The Path of Bhakti yoga (26-27)
The spirit of service is far better than siddhi / mukti (32-34, 36, 41)

(PeA/ AMI) Devotee's attitude toward temporary household or social life. (39-40).

3. 26 Fundamental Principles of Material Nature

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What is the result of understanding Sāṅkhya philosophy? (1)
2. How is the phrase *anādir ātmā puruṣo* relevant for preaching? (3)
3. Explain the import of *svayaṁ-jyotiḥ* (3)
4. Examine why this material world was created (5)
5. Explain the use of the term *nitya-baddha* (eternally conditioned) (5)
6. Respond to the Māyāvādī philosophy that the conditional existence of the living entity is his līlā, or pastime. (7-8)
7. Explain how the the living entity is the cause of his own suffering (8)
8. Explain the difference between the pradhāna and prakṛti (10).
9. How does the Lord speak to every conditioned soul? (16)
10. Briefly describe the function of the Supersoul. (18)
11. Briefly describe the function of the Supersoul. (27)
12. Examine the role of doubt in intelligence. (30)
13. What is the potency of sound in regard bondage and liberation? (32)
14. List some of the activities going on because of movements of the air. (37-38)
15. Summarize texts 32-49. (49)
16. What is the significance of Lord Brahmā's four heads? (52)
17. Examine the relationship between the discharge of semen and death. (57)
18. According to Āyur-veda how should one treat nervous instability & irregularity in hunger and thirst? (59-60)
19. How can we fix the purified mind in the service of the Supreme Lord? (61)
20. Explain the sum and substance of the Sāṅkhya philosophical system. (72)

Analogies

3.26.9: Prakṛti is connected with both the Supreme Lord and the living entities, just as a woman is connected with her husband as a wife and with her children as a mother.

3.26.9: An analogy may be made with the father and mother: the mother and the father exist, but sometimes the mother begets children. Similarly, this cosmic manifestation, which comes from the unmanifest material nature of the Supreme Lord, sometimes appears and again disappears.

3.26.17: As a woman cannot produce children unless impregnated by a man, material nature cannot produce or manifest anything unless it is impregnated by the Supreme Personality of Godhead in the form of the time factor.

3.26.17: As in the womb of a mother a child gradually grows different bodily parts, so in the universal womb the universal form of the Lord gives rise to the creation of various paraphernalia.

3.26 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-8:
Lord Kapila described to his mother the different categories [Sāṅkhya] of the Absolute Truth. The Lord is perceivable everywhere by His effulgence which maintains the creation, accepting the subtle material energy as a pastime. Material consciousness creates living entities' material life. Material nature is the cause of the material body and senses, and the senses' presiding deities. The feelings of happiness and distress are caused by the soul..

Verses 9-18:
Lord Kapila explained *pradhāna* & *prakṛti.* The aggregate elements, namely the five gross elements, the five subtle elements [smell, taste, color, touch and sound], the four internal senses [mind, intelligence, ego and contaminated consciousness], the five senses for gathering knowledge and the five outward organs of action [the organs for speaking, working, traveling, generating and evacuating], are known as the *pradhāna,* or the qualified Brahman. Time, the mixing element, is the twenty-fifth element. The Supreme Lord adjusts all these different elements, keeping Himself within as the Supersoul and without as time.

Verse 19-31:
Manifestation from the *mahat-tattva* of the subtle elements consciousness, false ego, intelligence, and mind are described along with their characteristics and predominating Deities.

Verses 32-49:
The manifestation from false ego of the sense objects or *tan-mātras* [sound, touch, form, taste and smell], their corresponding gross elements [ether, air, fire, water, and earth], and the senses that perceive them [sense of hearing, sense of touch, sense of sight, sense of taste, and sense of smell] are described. Since the cause exists in its effect as well, the characteristics of the former are observed in the latter

Verses 50-72:
When the Lord, along with time, work, and the modes of material nature, entered into the universe with the total material energy, an unintelligent egg arose, from which appeared the Cosmic Being. The universal egg is covered by layers of water, air, fire, sky, ego and mahat-tattva, increasing in thickness each layer is ten times bigger than the previous one, and the final outside layer is covered by *pradhāna.* Within this egg is the universal form of Lord Hari, of whose body the fourteen planetary systems are parts. For each sense, first the sense organ would appear in the universal form, and then the sense itself would appear, along with its presiding deity. All his material assets cannot arouse a sleeping man, but the Supersoul can arouse him. One should contemplate that Supersoul.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Relationship between the Lord, material nature & living entities (3-9)
The potency of sound in regard bondage and liberation (32)
Cause of disease & Āyur-veda treatment (37, 59-60)
Bhāgavatam is potential basis of great scientific research work (34)
A sleeping man can be aroused only when the Supersoul helps him (71)

COMPARISON OF KAPILA SANKHYA ATHEISTIC SĀṄKHYA

Kapila Sāṅkhya	Atheistic Sāṅkhya
Cause of creation	
Supreme Lord's glance	Prakrti (pradhana) Brahman - Produces purusa and prakrti
Cause of suffering	
Jiva misidentifying with prakrti	Prakrti, which is false
Concept of Truth	
Jiva is servant of isvara	Jiva is Isvara
Jiva is the doer	Prakrti is the doer
Life comes from life	Spirit comes from matter
Process	
Jiva surrenders to Isvara Devotional service with Knowledge of Sāṅkhya and mystic yoga	Analyzing the elements, practicing mystic yoga, Separating the soul to get liberation

3. 27 Understanding Material Nature

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Briefly summarize the theme of verses 1-4.
2. Explain how a devotee lives 'without intimate connections with anyone' (7)
3. Examine the application of the phrase *yadṛcchayopalabdhena santuṣṭo* (8)
4. Where should a devotee make his place of residence? (8)
5. Explain satya-dṛk (13-14)
6. Examine the terms *icchā-dveṣa* in relation to material bondage. (20)
7. How can one develop serious devotional service? (21)
8. How can one estimate his development of Kṛṣṇa consciousness? (22)
9. Analyze the two main diseases of material contamination.(23)
10. How does the living entity loose his independence? (24)
11. What are yogīs are generally attracted to? (30)

Analogies

3.27.1: As the reflection of the sun appears to be on the water but is many millions of miles away from the water, so one engaged in the bhakti-yoga process is nirguṇa, or unaffected by the qualities of material nature.

3.27.12: The room is dark, and the sun is far away in the sky, but the sun's reflection on the water illuminates the darkness of the room. A pure devotee can realize the presence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead in everything by the reflection of His energy.

3.27.14: The example given by Jīva Gosvāmī is that a green bird that enters a green tree appears to merge in the color of greenness, but actually the bird does not lose its individuality.

3.27.20: there is no benefit in husking the skin of an empty paddy; the rice is already gone. Similarly, simply by the speculative process one cannot be freed from material bondage, for the cause still exists.

3.27.21: As long as one does not commit criminal acts, even though there is a police department, he is not punished. Similarly, the liberated soul is not affected, although he is in the material nature

3. 27 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-16:

The Personality of Godhead Kapila first describes the consciousness and behavior of liberated and conditional souls, and then he tells, in great detail, how the conditioned soul can become liberated by executing pure devotional service. He explains how the liberated soul can see the Supreme Lord manifest in this world in different places as a reflection. He explains how although a devotee appears to be merged in the five material elements, the objects of material enjoyment, the material senses and material mind and intelligence, he is understood to be awake and to be freed from the false ego.

Verse 17-30:

Śrī Devahūti asks if material nature ever gives release to the spirit soul. Lord Kapila explains one can get liberation by seriously discharging devotional service unto Him and thereby hearing for a long time about Him or from Him. By thus executing one's prescribed duties, there will be no reaction, and one will be freed from the contamination of matter. Awakened souls see material life as nothing but a dream. Material nature's influence cannot harm them, even when they engage in material activities, because their minds are fixed on the Supreme Lord. After many years and births, one becomes reluctant to enjoy even the highest material planets [no desire for bhukti]. When a perfect yogī's attention is no longer attracted to the by-products of mystic powers [no desire for siddhi], his progress towards the Lord becomes unlimited, and thus the power of death cannot overcome him.

Discussion Topics

(M+M) Best service to the people in general is to awaken them to Kṛṣṇa c.. (4)
Try to convince others and propagate Kṛṣṇa consciousness (5)

(PeA) Śrī Kapiladeva's practical guidelines for devotional life (7-8)
Be satisfied with ones position as offered by the Lord (8)
A liberated soul is not affected, although he is in the material nature (21-26)
Pure and mixed devotional service (27)

(PrA) The illusory dream of lording it over material nature (4, 25)
Loving service to the Lord is actual independence (24)

3. 28 Kapila's Instructions on the Execution of Devotional Service

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Comment on the principle of sva-dharmācaraṇaṁ. (2)
2. How does the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam recommend one should eat? (3)
3. Describe the application of Asteyam, "to refrain from theft".(4)
4. What sitting posture will help one to concentrate his mind on the Lord? (8).
5. Identify some of the metaphors used by Kapiladeva to describe the form of the Lord in verses 13 to 33. (13-33)
6. Comment on the flowers in the spiritual sky. What do they indicate? (15)
7. List the eight kinds of forms recommended for the devotees to see (18)
8. List reasons why the process of hearing & chanting is superior to and fixing the mind on the pastimes of the Lord. (19)
9. Explain the meaning of nirvāṇa (35)
10. List the four principles of the Vaiṣṇava philosophic doctrine. (41)
11. List the four different divisions of species-living entities. (42)

Analogies

3.28.10: One can purify the mind either by the breathing process or by the chanting process, just as one can purify gold by putting it in a fire and fanning it with a bellows.

3.28.25: Just as a child is connected to his mother by the umbilical cord, so the first-born living creature, Brahmā, by the supreme will of the Lord, is connected to the Lord by a lotus stem.

3.28.28: The Supreme Lord keeps on His neck those living entities who are pure, as one protects the jewels and pearls on the bosom and neck of one's body.

3. 28 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-12:
Lord Kapila explained that one should do his prescribed duties competently and be satisfied with gain obtained by God's grace. One should worship the lotus feet of a guru. One should cease performing conventional religious practices, accepting only what leads to salvation. One should eat very frugally and live alone. One must be nonviolent and truthful, avoid thieving, be satisfied with life's bare necessities, abstain from sex life, perform austerity, be clean, study the *Vedas* and worship the Lord. One must practice *āsanas, prāṇāyāma*],*pratyāhāra* &*dhāraṇa*. Fixing the vital air and the mind in one of the six *cakras,* thus concentrating one's mind on the Lord's transcendental pastimes [*dhyāna*], is called *samādhi.* With the mind perfectly purified by yoga, one should concentrate on the tip of the nose with half-closed eyes and see the Lord's form.

Verses 13-33:
The form of the Supersoul is described in detail with various metaphors. Once devoting his mind to this, the yogī should not desire to see anything else.

Verses 34-44:
Such a yogī gradually develops pure love for Lord Hari. The hairs on his body stand erect through excessive joy, and he is constantly bathed in tears of intense love [*bhāva*]. Being dovetailed with the Supreme Lord the mind is experienced as one with Him, being freed from material qualities. The perfectly realized soul has no conception of how the material body is moving or acting, as an intoxicated person cannot tell if he is dressed. The body of such a liberated yogī is taken charge of by the Lord, functioning until its destined activities are finished. A person situated in *samādhi,* the highest perfectional stage of yoga, does not accept the by-products of the material body as his own, considering his bodily activities to be like the activities of a body in a dream.
The yogi should see the same soul in all manifestations, for all that exists is a manifestation of different energies of the Supreme, and thus he should see all living entities without distinction. Thus the yogī can be in the self-realized position after conquering the insurmountable spell of *māyā,* who presents herself as both the cause and effect of this material manifestation and is therefore very difficult to understand.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Astanga Yoga & Bhakti (4-11)
Hearing & chanting is superior to meditation on the pastimes of the Lord. (19, 34)
Transcendental beauty of Lord Viṣṇu. (13-33)
Nirvāṇa = dovetailed mind with Kṛṣṇa's desire. This is called oneness. (35)

(Und) nirbīja & sabīja-yoga. (34)
Four principles of the Vaiṣṇava philosophic doctrine. (40-41)

(AMI) Yogi forgets his bodily demands (36-38)

3. 29 Explanation of Devotional Service by Lord Kapila

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain the relationship between Sankhya Yoga and Bhakti yoga. (2)
2. To enter the darkest region of material existence means what? (3)
3. Elaborate on how the Lord is pleased with those devotees who are compassionate towards the conditioned souls. (5-6)
4. Define pure devotional service (8)
5. List the qualities of Vaiṣṇava's in the modes of ignorance, passion & goodness. (8-10)
6. What is a separatist? (9)
7. How many varieties of mixed devotion are there? (10)
8. List some of the characteristics of pure devotional service (11-13)
9. Explain how one can be situated in the transcendental stage. (14)
10. Why does a devotee not have to try for *ekatva* liberation separately? (14)
11. Comment on the word *nātihiṁsā*. (15)
12. List some of the recommended activities of a devotee on the intermediate level (16-18)
13. List points describing how does the Lord feels if someone disregards His presence everywhere as Supersoul and engages himself in the worship of the Deity in the temple. (21-24)
14. Explain the significance of the phrase *'sva-karma-kṛt'* (25)
15. Explain the use of the Sanskrit words *māna* and *dāna* (27)
16. What example does Prabhupāda give to illustrate equality with discrimination? (28)
17. List the gradations of living entities as explained in verses 28-36.

Analogies

3.29.20: As a breeze carrying a pleasant fragrance from a garden of flowers at once captures the organ of smell, so one's consciousness, saturated with devotion, can at once capture the transcendental existence of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who, in His Paramatma feature, is present everywhere, even in the heart of every living being.

3.29.24: Many valuable foodstuffs may be presented to a person, but if the person is not hungry, all such offerings are useless for him. Similarly, we may offer many valuable items to the Deity, but if we have no real sense of devotion and no real sense of the Lord's presence everywhere.. in such a state of ignorance, we cannot offer anything acceptable to the Lord.

3.29.35: When the poor man dovetails his desires with those of the rich man…then the enjoyment is shared equally…when the living entity enters into the kingdom of God and cooperates with the Supreme Lord by giving Him enjoyment, he enjoys the same facility or the same amount of pleasure as the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

3.29 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1- 14

After hearing about Sāṅkhya philosophy, Devahūti now requests Lord Kapila to explain to her the path of devotional service which she feels will help her to cultivate detachment from the activities of the material world. Lord Kapila replies that there are varieties of devotional service in ignorance, passion and goodness. Pure devotional service is spontaneous, uninterrupted and unalloyed meant only for Nārāyaṇa, Viṣṇu, or Kṛṣṇa. A pure devotee does not aspire for material prosperity or even the five kinds of liberation.

Verses 15-20

A devotee must execute his prescribed duties in devotional service to the Lord, without desire for profit. All types of devotees should perform deity worship. An intermediate devotee must see other living entities as spiritual sparks of the Supreme Lord. He should worship an acarya and should show compassion to spiritually impoverished souls. He should make friendship with persons who are on an equal level with himself, must always hear and chant, be simple and straightforward, and avoid the company of neophytes. The result of such behavior will be attraction to hearing about the Lord.

Verses 21- 35

Lord Kapila explains that one who is ignorant of the Lord's presence in all living entities never pleases Him by the worship of the Deity in the temple. Lord Kapila describes a hierarchy of living entities from inanimate objects to pure devotees.

Verses 36- 45

Devotees who know the time factor as another representation of the Lord have nothing to fear from the influence of time. All functions of creation, maintenance and destruction are carried out by the demigods in fear of the Lord.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Characteristics of mixed & pure devotional service (8-13)
Separatist mentality (9)
Recommended activities of a devotee on the intermediate platform (16-18)

(M+M) Lord is pleased with compassionate devotees (5-6)
Deity worship & seeing the Lord's presence everywhere (21-24)
Devotees are expected to carry the message of Lord to conditioned souls (23)
Distribution of prasāda is essential for persons who make offerings to the Lord (24)

(PrA) One should not commit more violence than necessary (15, 23)
Gradations of living entities. (28-36)

(SC) Nature is working out of fear of the Lord (40-45)

UNITS 10-11

CANTO 3 CHAPTER 20 TO CHAPTER 29

OPEN BOOK ASSESSMENT

Keep your responses to the following to within 200 words (2-3 paragraphs)

Understanding

1. Write in your own words a brief summary of the Sankhya philosophy given by Lord Kapila in Canto 3 Chapters 25-29.

Śāstra-cakṣusā

2. Discuss the relevance, for society in general, of association with sadhus, with reference to 3.25.20.

Personal Application

3. Select some qualities of a sadhu mentioned in 3.25.21- 24, which you find particularly inspiring. Discuss your plan to further develop these qualities in yourself.

4. Explain mixed and pure devotional service with reference to 3.29.7-13. Discuss how this is relevant for your own spiritual life?

Evaluation

5. With reference to 3.21.15 verse & purport, comment on on the advantages of arranged marriage over love marriage in society today. Discuss divorces within ISKCON with reference to these principles.

UNIT 11 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

List the characteristics of intelligence (26.30)
Discuss the sense activities which are required to wake the virat-purusa (26.62)
Compare Sankhya philosophy & Bhakti-yoga. (3.29.1-2)

Personal Application

Identify challenges faced in applying Kapiladeva's statement: "attachment for the material is the greatest entanglement of the spirit soul …attachment, when applied to the self-realized devotees, opens the door of liberation." (25.20)
Discuss the qualities of a sadhu in relation to their personal lives. (25.21-24)
Discuss the activities of devotee in relation to their personal lives. (27.3-9; 15-18)

Preaching Application

Present an overview of Lord Kapila's instructions from this section.
Present a brief overview of creation (26.10-61)
Present an analysis of devotional service in the modes (27.8-10)

Śāstra-cakṣusā

Reflect on the relevance in their own lives of Kapiladeva's statement: "Devotees cannot be deprived of their possessions at any time." (25.38)

UNIT 12 KAPILA SIKSHA 2

(CANTO 3 CHAPTERS 30-33)

SCHEDULED READING ASSIGNMENTS

Lesson 1

Specific texts: 30.8-34
Overview of Chapter 30
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 30

Lesson 2

Specific texts: 31.1-41
Overview of Chapter 31
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 31

Lesson 3

Overview of Chapter 32
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 32

Lesson 4

Specific texts: 33.1-7; 12-13, 20-22, 28
Overview of Chapter 33
Revise Pūrva-svādhyāya questions for Chapter 33

3.30 Description by Lord Kapila of Adverse Fruitive Activities

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain the terms prakṣepātmikā & āvaraṇātmikā. (4-5)
2. Describe family relationships in the material world & in Kṛṣṇaloka (7)
3. List points you find interesting from Lord Kapiladeva's description of:
    a. family life (8-18)
    b. miseries afflicted to the sinner on the way to Yamaraja's planet. (19- 24)
    c. hellish punishments for materialist (25 -28)
4. What important function do the dogs engaged by Yamarāja perform? (21)
5. Why are hellish punishments sometimes visible on this planet also? (29)

Analogies

3.30.1: As a mass of clouds does not know the powerful influence of the wind, a person engaged in material consciousness does not know the powerful strength of the time factor, by which he is being carried.

3.30.8: Family life within the kingdom of illusory energy, maya, is just like a prison for the eternal living entity. In prison a prisoner is shackled by iron chains and iron bars. Similarly, a conditioned soul is shackled by the charming beauty of a woman, by her solitary embraces and talks of so-called love, and by the sweet words of his small children.

3.30.13: Seeing him unable to support them, his wife and others do not treat him with the same respect as before, even as miserly farmers do not accord the same treatment to their old and worn-out oxen.

3.30.32: When a man steals some money, if he is caught and agrees to return it, he is not freed from the criminal punishment. By the law of the state, even though he returns the money, he has to undergo the punishment. Similarly, the money earned by a criminal process may be left by the man when dying, but by superior arrangement he carries with him the effect, and therefore he has to suffer hellish life.

3.30 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-6

Lord Kapila explains how the materialist wastes his life absorbed in economic development which will be destroyed by time. The attached materialist is ignorant of the temporary situation he is in. In whatever species of life he is in, by the influence of Maya he finds some happiness. Māyā has two phases of activities called āvaraṇātmikā which means "covering," and prakṣepātmikā "pulling down."

Verses 7-17

A materialistic man gives heart and senses to a woman, who falsely charms him with māyā and he forgets his real duty. The love of the woman at home and the talk of the children make him a secure prisoner. With sinful acts he secures money by committing violence and he goes to hell for those for whom he earned the money. The family members are never satisfied with his service and when he is unable to support them he is treated like an old useless ox. Thus he remains at home just like a pet dog and eats whatever is so negligently given to him. Even though his life becomes less than a dog's he still does not become averse to family attachment.

Verses 18-24

At death he remains absorbed in anxiety over family concerns. He sees the Yamadutas come before him and in great fear he passes stool and urine. Just like a criminal is arrested, the Yamadūtas bind him by the neck with strong rope and cover his subtle body so that he may undergo severe punishment. Having gone through all the miserable, hellish conditions and having passed in a regular order through the lowest forms of animal life prior to human birth, and having thus been purged of his sins, he is reborn again as a human being.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Relationship between material advancement, time & Kṛṣṇa consciousness (1-3)
Prakṣepātmikā & āvaraṇātmikā potencies (4-5, 29)
The spell of māyā… Indra forgets heaven and is satisfied with hog's life… (5)

(PeA) Means of livelihood of those trying to advance in Kṛṣṇa consciousness (31-33)

(SC) Lord Kapiladeva's description of materialistic family life. (8-18)
Suffering after death for a materialist. (19-34)

(M+M) there is no institution to train them to control the senses (21)
Kṛṣṇa consciousness..protects all human beings from gliding down to hell (34)

3.31 Lord Kapila's Instructions on the Movements of the Living Entities

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. By what two factors is a living entity made to enter into the womb of a woman? (1)
2. Describe the condition of the child in the womb. (5 -9)
3. Why does the human soul in the womb pray to the Lord? (11-13)
4. Why does the living entity not wish to depart from the mother's abdomen? (20)
5. What general principle does Prabhupāda draw from the fact that the child can be fully Kṛṣṇa conscious within the womb of the mother? (21)
6. Why is the tendency to be attracted by beauty natural? (39)
7. What is the special significance of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa worship? (38)
8. Explain the meaning of anādi karama-phale. (44)

Analogies

3.31.19: The evolutionary process of different types of bodies is something like that of a fructifying flower. Just as there are different stages in the growth of a flower -- the bud stage, the blooming stage and the full -- fledged, grown-up stage of aroma and beauty -- similarly, there are 8,400,000 species of bodies in gradual evolution, and there is systematic progress from the lower species of life to the higher.

3.31.40: .one who associates with such māyā(form of woman) by accepting services must certainly know that this is the way of death, just like a blind well covered with grass…Sometimes it happens that a rejected well is covered by grass, and an unwary traveler who does not know of the existence of the well falls down, and his death is assured.

3.31.42: A woman, therefore, should consider her husband, her house and her children to be the arrangement of the external energy of the Lord for her death, just as the sweet singing of the hunter is death for the deer.

3.31.44: Materialistic life involves a series of actions and reactions. It is a long film spool of actions and reactions, and one life-span is just a flash in such a reactionary show.

3.31 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-10

Under the supervision of the Lord and according to his karma, the living entity is made to enter into the womb of a woman through the particle of male semen. Kapiladeva describes the gradual development of the body in the womb. Encaged in an abominable residence of stools and urine and a bitten by worms, the child becomes unconscious because of the terrible condition. If the child is fortunate, he can remember all the troubles of his past one hundred births and thus pray with folded hands, appealing to the Lord, who has put him in that condition.

Verses 11-22

Realizing that conditional life is due to his forgetfulness of his relationship with the Supersoul, the human soul prays to the Lord to be released from his confinement. Even though he is in a terrible condition in the womb he prays to the Lord not to come out since he will fall again into the bodily concept of life. The child expresses his determination to remain Krsna conscious and thus be saved from entering into wombs again.

Verses 22-31

The child takes birth in great agony, loses its superior knowledge. After coming out of the womb also the child suffers since he is given to the care of persons who are unable to understand what he wants. During childhood and youth he suffers pain over desires to get things he cannot achieve. By ignorance the living entity accepts the material body as himself.

Verses 32-48

Due to bad association with people attached to sex and the tongue, he again goes towards hell. The Lord's energy Maya in the shape of a woman is very strong and only the sage Narayana is immune. One who aspires to render service unto the Lord should never associate with women. Woman is the representation of Maya. For woman, man is Maya and she should consider her husband, her house and her children to be the arrangement of the external energy of the Lord for her death, just as the sweet singing of the hunter is death for the deer. As per his karma the living entity gets his next body. When the reaction of his particular activity comes to an end, that end is called death, and when a particular type of reaction begins, that beginning is called birth. Through devotional service one should practice real renunciation.

Discussion Topics

(PeA) Prayers by the soul in the womb. (12-21)
Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa worship (material sex desire is perverted reflection) (38-39)

(PrA) Condition of the child within the womb. (1-10) / Miseries of birth. (22-27)
Man and woman should live together as householders in relationship with Kṛṣṇa (42)

(AMI) Association of women is the gateway to hellish life (38-40)
Body of a man has greater opportunity to get out of the material clutches (41)

(SC) Woman is wonderful creation of māyā to keep the conditioned soul in shackles. (32-39)

3.32 Entanglement in Fruitive Activities

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. Explain the difference between pravṛtti & nivṛtti dharma. (6)
2. Describe the destination of persons who are worshipers of Hiraṇyagarbha. (8)
3. Why are the materialists compared to stool-eating hogs? (19)
4. Explain how for a devotee there is no question of agreeable or disagreeable.(25)
5. List briefly the different activities prescribed for the four orders of the social system to elevate one to the platform of self-realization. (34-36)
6. List the two symptoms of advancement in the process of devotional service (34-36)
7. Summarize the main points of Prabhupāda's purport to verse (40)
8. Explain what it means to be a bhakti. (42)

Analogies

3.32.34-36: A hungry man feels strength and satisfaction from eating, and at the same time he gradually becomes detached from eating any more. Similarly, with the execution of devotional service, real knowledge develops, and one becomes detached from all material activities.

3.32 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1- 4

The Lord describes the gṛhamedhī, the person who enjoys material benefits by performing religious rituals. Such persons are bereft of Kṛṣṇa consciousness and are not interested in devotional service to the Lord. They are elevated to the heavenly planets, but they have to come back to earth. At the time of dissolution, the heavenly planets are destroyed.

Verses 5- 22

There are persons who perform prescribed duties for gratification of the Supreme Lord. Such persons attain the kingdom of God. Worshippers of Hiranyagarbha, and yogis go to Brahmaloka until the time of dissolution after which they enter the kingdom of God along with Brahma. Brahma and other great sages attain the first purusa, Maha Visnu but have to take birth again in the next creation because of their independent nature. Persons who are interested only in Dharma, Artha and Kama, are compared to stool-eating hogs. Such people go to Pitrloka but they come down to earth again and take birth in their own families. Therefore Lord Kapila advises Mother Devahuti to take shelter of the Lord with devotion.

Verses 23- 38

By devotional service transcendental knowledge and detachment develop. A devotee is equipoised in his vision and does not see anything as superior or inferior. Those who are averse to the Lord speculate with their imperfect senses about the nature of the Absolute Truth. Only persons who engage in devotional service in full Kṛṣṇa consciousness can become absorbed in full samādhi. There are different activities are prescribed for different persons so that they may be elevated to the platform of self-realization and from there to Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

Verses 39- 42

The instructions given by Lord Kapila are not to be given to persons who are too greedy, too attached to family life, nondevotees and those who are envious of the Lord. Rather they should be given to the faithful devotee who is respectful to the spiritual master, nonenvious, friendly to all kinds of living entities, eager to render service with faith and sincerity and who have taken the Supreme Personality of Godhead to be more dear than anything else. Anyone who once meditates upon Lord Kapila with faith and affection, who hears and chants about Him, surely goes back home, back to Godhead.

Discussion Topics

(PrA) Result of pious activities are temporary. (3-4, 20-21)

(PeA) Qualifications for hearing Kapiladeva's instructions. (40-42)
A Godbrother is more enlightened and advanced in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, one should accept him as almost equal to the spiritual master (42)

3.33 Activities of Kapila

Pūrva-svādhyāya

1. What stage was achieved by Devahūti? (1)
2. Why is Devahūti astonished? (2)
3. What type of utterence of the holy name is required to immediately become eligible to perform Vedic sacrifices? (6-7)
4. What does the example of Ṭhākura Haridāsa show? (7)
5. How can we see if one is a jīvan-mukta? (10)
6. Why did Kapiladeva leave home? (12)
7. What was the way of Vedic civilization in regard to household paraphernalia? (17)
8. What general principles can be drawn from Devahūti attachment to her son? (20-22)
9. To where was Devahūti promoted? (30)

Analogies

3.33.6: Sri Sanatana Gosvami: "As a base metal like bell metal can be changed into gold by a chemical process, any person can similarly be changed into a brahmana by diksa-vidhana, the initiation process".

3.33.7: If one is seated on the bench of a high-court and is giving judgment on cases, it means that he has already passed all legal exams and is better than those who are engaged in the study of law ... In a similar way, persons who are chanting the holy name are transcendental to those who are factually performing the Vedic rituals and those who expect to be qualified.

3.33.28: It is customary in the renounced order of life that one should not take any service from a servant or maid, but Devahuti was being served by the celestial maidservants. This may appear to be against the spiritual concept of life, but just as fire is still beautiful even when surrounded by smoke, she looked completely pure although it seemed that she was living in a luxurious way.

3.33 ADHYĀYA-KATHĀ-SĀRA

Verses 1-12

Devahūti expresses astonishment about the Lord's taking birth in her womb. Devahūti glorifies the Holy Name of the Lord. The chanters of the Holy Name have already performed all kinds of Vedic rituals and sacrifices. Devahūti summarizes that Lord Kapila is Lord Viṣṇu. Lord Kapila says that if you traverse this path of self-realization perfectly, surely you shall be freed from fearful material contamination and shall ultimately reach Me. Lord Kapila leaves home after instructing His mother.

Verses 13-32

Devahūti begins to practice yoga in Kardama Muni's ashram. Kardama Muni's ashram is so opulent that the denizens of heaven envy it. Devahūti gives up all comforts, however was aggrieved at the separation from her son because He was the Lord. Engaging seriously in devotional service and accepting only necessities of the body, she becomes purified. Devahūti was promoted to Vaikuṇṭha planet known as Kapila Vaikuṇṭha, to reside in the company of her transcendental son. The place where Devahūti achieves perfection is called Siddhapada. The material elements of her body melted into water and are now a flowing river. Anyone who bathes in that river also attains perfection.

Verses 33-37

After leaving home, Lord Kapila and headed for north east. Celestial denizens, munis and apsaras offered Him respects. The ocean offered Him oblations and a place of residence still known as Gaṅgā-sāgara. Even now Kapila Muni is staying there in trance for the deliverance of the conditioned souls in the three worlds, and all the ācāryas, or great teachers, of the system of Sāṅkhya philosophy are worshiping Him. The description of the dealings of Kapiladeva and His mother is very confidential, and anyone who hears or reads this narration becomes a devotee of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and enters His abode.

Discussion Topics

(Und) Lord licks His toe to taste the nectar for which the devotees always aspire. (4)

(PeA) To be too fat is not very good for spiritually advanced life. (14)

(PrA) Glorious effects of chanting the Holy Name. (6-7)
Kapiladeva's departure from and Devahūti's remaining at home (12-13, 20-22, 28)

UNIT 12 PAṬHANA-PRAYOJANAM (EDUCATIONAL GOALS)

By the end of the unit students should be able to:

Understanding

Present an overview of Kapiladeva's teachings in this section.

Personal Application

Discuss the relevance in their own lives, and in ISKCON in general, of Prabhupāda's statements regarding the means of livelihood of those trying to advance in Kṛṣṇa consciousness (30.31-33)

Preaching Application

Select points from Lord Kapiladeva's descriptions of

- Materialistic family life (30.8-18),
- Sufferings after death for a materialist (30.19-34)
- Condition of the child within the womb (31.1-10)
- Prayers by the soul in the womb (31.12-21)
- The miseries of birth (31.22-27)
- Sexual entanglement (31.38-41)

and discuss how to present them to a contemporary audience.

Discuss what general principles, relevant for preaching, can be drawn from Kapiladeva's departure from and Devahūti's remaining at home (33.12-13, 20-22, 28)

BHAKTIVAIBHAVA MODULE 1 ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW

Closed Book Assessment
Closed book tests will be given at the end of each unit assessing student's knowledge and memory of that unit. No additional summative closed book tests will be given. Closed book tests will comprise of approximately ten questions drawn from Pūrva-svādhyāya (Preliminary Self Study questions & analogies). Memorization slokas will be assessed orally on an individual basis. Sloka assessment must be completed prior to two weeks before the end of the module. Discuss with the facilitator for a suitable time to have your sloka assessment.

Open Book Assessment
Approximately 10 open book questions, assessing student's educational achievements for each unit, will be given at beginning of each Unit. These open book questions will be based upon the Paṭhana-prayojanam (educational goals or learning objectives) for each unit, which are provided in the Student Handbook. Student's answers to the open book questions must be submitted before the commencement of the subsequent unit. Late submissions may incur a penalty of 5% at the discretion of the facilitator.

Presentations
Students will make two Presentations, a Group Presentation and an Individual Presentation during the Module

Grades
Your overall grade for the module will be the aggregate of the following:

Closed Book Tests & slokas 35%
- Closed Book Tests 20%
- Slokas 15%

Open Book Questions 30%

Presentations 35%
- Individual Presentation 25%
- Group Presentation 10%

Students complete all 12 units, and achieving an overall grade of over 65%, will be credited with a pass in the Module. Students' overall grades will be submitted to MI's Assessment Board for final approval. Marginal cases may be requested to appear for an interview, or resubmit part or all of the assessment. Students may appeal to ISKCON's Examination Board if they are dissatisfied with the decision of MI's Assessment Board. Students achieving a pass in both Modules 1 & 2 will be awarded an ISKCON Examinations Board Bhaktibhaibhava Degree.

ŚRĪMAD-BHĀGAVATAM ŚLOKAS

1.1.1

oṁ namo bhagavate vāsudevāya
janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñaḥ svarāṭ
tene brahma hṛdā ya ādi-kavaye muhyanti yat sūrayaḥ
tejo-vāri-mṛdāṁ yathā vinimayo yatra tri-sargo 'mṛṣā
dhāmnā svena sadā nirasta-kuhakaṁ satyaṁ paraṁ dhīmahi

om—O my Lord; namaḥ—offering my obeisances; bhagavate—unto the Personality of Godhead; vāsudevāya—unto Vāsudeva (the son of Vasudeva), or Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord; janma-ādi—creation, sustenance and destruction; asya—of the manifested universes; yataḥ—from whom; anvayāt—directly; itarataḥ—indirectly; ca—and; artheṣu—purposes; abhijñaḥ—fully cognizant; sva-rāṭ—fully independent; tene—imparted; brahma—the Vedic knowledge; hṛdā—consciousness of the heart; yaḥ—one who; ādi-kavaye—unto the original created being; muhyanti—are illusioned; yat—about whom; sūrayaḥ—great sages and demigods; tejaḥ—fire; vāri—water; mṛdām—earth; yathā—as much as; vinimayaḥ—action and reaction; yatra—whereupon; tri-sargaḥ—three modes of creation, creative faculties; amṛṣā—almost factual; dhāmnā—along with all transcendental paraphernalia; svena—self-sufficiently; sadā—always; nirasta—negation by absence; kuhakam—illusion; satyam—truth; param—absolute; dhīmahi—I do meditate upon.

O my Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, son of Vasudeva, O all-pervading Personality of Godhead, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You. I meditate upon Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa because He is the Absolute Truth and the primeval cause of all causes of the creation, sustenance and destruction of the manifested universes. He is directly and indirectly conscious of all manifestations, and He is independent because there is no other cause beyond Him. It is He only who first imparted the Vedic knowledge unto the heart of Brahmājī, the original living being. By Him even the great sages and demigods are placed into illusion, as one is bewildered by the illusory representations of water seen in fire, or land seen on water. Only because of Him do the material universes, temporarily manifested by the reactions of the three modes of nature, appear factual, although they are unreal. I therefore meditate upon Him, Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who is eternally existent in the transcendental abode, which is forever free from the illusory representations of the material world. I meditate upon Him, for He is the Absolute Truth.

1.1.2

dharmaḥ projjhita-kaitavo 'tra paramo nirmatsarāṇāṁ satāṁ
vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śivadaṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam
śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte kiṁ vā parair īśvaraḥ
sadyo hṛdy avarudhyate 'tra kṛtibhiḥ śuśrūṣubhis tat-kṣaṇāt

dharmaḥ—religiosity; projjhita—completely rejected; kaitavaḥ—covered by fruitive intention; atra—herein; paramaḥ—the highest; nirmatsarāṇām—of the one-hundred-percent pure in heart; satām—devotees; vedyam—understandable; vāstavam—factual; atra—herein; vastu—substance; śivadam—well-being; tāpa-traya—threefold miseries; unmūlanam—causing uprooting of; śrīmat—beautiful; bhāgavate—the Bhāgavata Purāṇa; mahā-muni—the great sage (Vyāsadeva); kṛte—having compiled; kim—what is; vā—the need; paraiḥ—others; īśvaraḥ—the Supreme Lord; sadyaḥ—at once; hṛdi—within the heart; avarudhyate—become compact; atra—herein; kṛtibhiḥ—by the pious men; śuśrūṣubhiḥ—by culture; tat-kṣaṇāt—without delay.

Completely rejecting all religious activities which are materially motivated, this Bhāgavata Purāṇa propounds the highest truth, which is understandable by those devotees who are fully pure in heart. The highest truth is reality distinguished from illusion for the welfare of all. Such truth uproots the threefold miseries. This beautiful Bhāgavatam, compiled by the great sage Vyāsadeva [in his maturity], is sufficient in itself for God realization. What is the need of any other scripture? As soon as one attentively and submissively hears the message of Bhāgavatam, by this culture of knowledge the Supreme Lord is established within his heart.

1.1.3

nigama-kalpa-taror galitaṁ phalaṁ
śuka-mukhād amṛta-drava-saṁyutam
pibata bhāgavataṁ rasam ālayam
muhur aho rasikā bhuvi bhāvukāḥ

nigama—the Vedic literatures; kalpa-taroḥ—the desire tree; galitam—fully matured; phalam—fruit; śuka—Śrīla Śukadeva Gosvāmī, the original speaker of Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam; mukhāt—from the lips of; amṛta—nectar; drava—semisolid and soft and therefore easily swallowable; saṁyutam—perfect in all respects; pibata—do relish it; bhāgavatam—the book dealing in the science of the eternal relation with the Lord; rasam—juice (that which is relishable); ālayam—until liberation, or even in a liberated condition; muhuḥ—always; aho—O; rasikāḥ—those who are full in the knowledge of mellows; bhuvi—on the earth; bhāvukāḥ—expert and thoughtful.

O expert and thoughtful men, relish Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, the mature fruit of the desire tree of Vedic literatures. It emanated from the lips of Śrī Śukadeva Gosvāmī. Therefore this fruit has become even more tasteful, although its nectarean juice was already relishable for all, including liberated souls.

1.1.10

prāyeṇālpāyuṣaḥ sabhya
kalāv asmin yuge janāḥ
mandāḥ sumanda-matayo
manda-bhāgyā hy upadrutāḥ

prāyeṇa—almost always; alpa—meager; āyuṣaḥ—duration of life; sabhya—member of a learned society; kalau—in this age of Kali (quarrel); asmin—herein; yuge—age; janāḥ—the public; mandāḥ—lazy; sumanda-matayaḥ—misguided; manda-bhāgyāḥ—unlucky; hi—and above all; upadrutāḥ—disturbed.

O learned one, in this iron age of Kali men have but short lives. They are quarrelsome, lazy, misguided, unlucky and, above all, always disturbed.

1.1.19

vayaṁ tu na vitṛpyāma
uttama-śloka-vikrame
yac-chṛṇvatāṁ rasa-jñānāṁ
svādu svādu pade pade

vayam—we; tu—but; na—not; vitṛpyāmaḥ—shall be at rest; uttama-śloka—the Personality of Godhead, who is glorified by transcendental prayers; vikrame—adventures; yat—which; śṛṇvatām—by continuous hearing; rasa—humor; jñānām—those who are conversant with; svādu—relishing; svādu—palatable; pade pade—at every step.

We never tire of hearing the transcendental pastimes of the Personality of Godhead, who is glorified by hymns and prayers. Those who have developed a taste for transcendental relationships with Him relish hearing of His pastimes at every moment.

1.2.4

nārāyaṇaṁ namaskṛtya
naraṁ caiva narottamam
devīṁ sarasvatīṁ vyāsaṁ
tato jayam udīrayet

nārāyaṇam—the Personality of Godhead; namaḥ-kṛtya—after offering respectful obeisances; naram ca eva—and Nārāyaṇa Ṛṣi; nara-uttamam—the supermost human being; devīm—the goddess; sarasvatīm—the mistress of learning; vyāsam—Vyāsadeva; tataḥ—thereafter; jayam—all that is meant for conquering; udīrayet—be announced.

Before reciting this Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, which is the very means of conquest, one should offer respectful obeisances unto the Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa, unto Nara-nārāyaṇa Ṛṣi, the supermost human being, unto mother Sarasvatī, the goddess of learning, and unto Śrīla Vyāsadeva, the author.

1.2.5

munayaḥ sādhu pṛṣṭo 'haṁ
bhavadbhir loka-maṅgalam
yat kṛtaḥ kṛṣṇa-sampraśno
yenātmā suprasīdati

munayaḥ—O sages; sādhu—this is relevant; pṛṣṭaḥ—questioned; aham—myself; bhavadbhiḥ—by all of you; loka—the world; maṅgalam—welfare; yat—because; kṛtaḥ—made; kṛṣṇa—the Personality of Godhead; sampraśnaḥ—relevant question; yena—by which; ātmā—self; suprasīdati—completely pleased.

O sages, I have been justly questioned by you. Your questions are worthy because they relate to Lord Kṛṣṇa and so are of relevance to the world's welfare. Only questions of this sort are capable of completely satisfying the self.

1.2.6

sa vai puṁsāṁ paro dharmo
yato bhaktir adhokṣaje
ahaituky apratihatā
yayātmā suprasīdati

saḥ—that; vai—certainly; puṁsām—for mankind; paraḥ—sublime; dharmaḥ—occupation; yataḥ—by which; bhaktiḥ—devotional service; adhokṣaje—unto the Transcendence; ahaitukī—causeless; apratihatā—unbroken; yayā—by which; ātmā—the self; suprasīdati—completely satisfied.

The supreme occupation [dharma] for all humanity is that by which men can attain to loving devotional service unto the transcendent Lord. Such devotional service must be unmotivated and uninterrupted to completely satisfy the self.

1.2.7

vāsudeve bhagavati
bhakti-yogaḥ prayojitaḥ
janayaty āśu vairāgyaṁ
jñānaṁ ca yad ahaitukam

vāsudeve—unto Kṛṣṇa; bhagavati—unto the Personality of Godhead; bhakti-yogaḥ—contact of devotional service; prayojitaḥ—being applied; janayati—does produce; āśu—very soon; vairāgyam—detachment; jñānam—knowledge; ca—and; yat—that which; ahaitukam—causeless.

By rendering devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, one immediately acquires causeless knowledge and detachment from the world.

1.2.8

dharmaḥ svanuṣṭhitaḥ puṁsāṁ
viṣvaksena-kathāsu yaḥ
notpādayed yadi ratiṁ
śrama eva hi kevalam

dharmaḥ—occupation; svanuṣṭhitaḥ—executed in terms of one's own position; puṁsām—of humankind; viṣvaksena—the Personality of Godhead (plenary portion); kathāsu—in the message of; yaḥ—what is; na—not; utpādayet—does produce; yadi—if; ratim—attraction; śramaḥ—useless labor; eva—only; hi—certainly; kevalam—entirely.

The occupational activities a man performs according to his own position are only so much useless labor if they do not provoke attraction for the message of the Personality of Godhead.

1.2.9

dharmasya hy āpavargyasya
nārtho 'rthāyopakalpate
nārthasya dharmaikāntasya
kāmo lābhāya hi smṛtaḥ

dharmasya—occupational engagement; hi—certainly; āpavargyasya—ultimate liberation; na—not; arthaḥ—end; arthāya—for material gain; upakalpate—is meant for; na—neither; arthasya—of material gain; dharma-eka-antasya—for one who is engaged in the ultimate occupational service; kāmaḥ—sense gratification; lābhāya—attainment of; hi—exactly; smṛtaḥ—is described by the great sages.

All occupational engagements are certainly meant for ultimate liberation. They should never be performed for material gain. Furthermore, according to sages, one who is engaged in the ultimate occupational service should never use material gain to cultivate sense gratification.

1.2.10

kāmasya nendriya-prītir
lābho jīveta yāvatā
jīvasya tattva-jijñāsā
nārtho yaś ceha karmabhiḥ

kāmasya—of desires; na—not; indriya—senses; prītiḥ—satisfaction; lābhaḥ—gain; jīveta—self-preservation; yāvatā—so much so; jīvasya—of the living being; tattva—the Absolute Truth; jijñāsā—inquiries; na—not; arthaḥ—end; yaḥ ca iha—whatsoever else; karmabhiḥ—by occupational activities.

Life's desires should never be directed toward sense gratification. One should desire only a healthy life, or self-preservation, since a human being is meant for inquiry about the Absolute Truth. Nothing else should be the goal of one's works.

1.2.11

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
brahmeti paramātmeti
bhagavān iti śabdyate

vadanti—they say; tat—that; tattva-vidaḥ—the learned souls; tattvam—the Absolute Truth; yat—which; jñānam—knowledge; advayam—nondual; brahma iti—known as Brahman; paramātmā iti—known as Paramātmā; bhagavān iti—known as Bhagavān; śabdyate—it so sounded.

Learned transcendentalists who know the Absolute Truth call this nondual substance Brahman, Paramātmā or Bhagavān.

1.2.12

tac chraddadhānā munayo
jñāna-vairāgya-yuktayā
paśyanty ātmani cātmānaṁ
bhaktyā śruta-gṛhītayā

tat—that; śraddadhānāḥ—seriously inquisitive; munayaḥ—sages; jñāna—knowledge; vairāgya—detachment; yuktayā—well equipped with; paśyanti—see; ātmani—within himself; ca—and; ātmānam—the Paramātmā; bhaktyā—in devotional service; śruta—the Vedas; gṛhītayā—well received.

The seriously inquisitive student or sage, well equipped with knowledge and detachment, realizes that Absolute Truth by rendering devotional service in terms of what he has heard from the Vedānta-śruti.

1.2.13

ataḥ pumbhir dvija-śreṣṭhā
varṇāśrama-vibhāgaśaḥ
svanuṣṭhitasya dharmasya
saṁsiddhir hari-toṣaṇam

ataḥ—so; pumbhiḥ—by the human being; dvija-śreṣṭhāḥ—O best among the twice-born; varṇa-āśrama—the institution of four castes and four orders of life; vibhāgaśaḥ—by the division of; svanuṣṭhitasya—of one's own prescribed duties; dharmasya—occupational; saṁsiddhiḥ—the highest perfection; hari—the Personality of Godhead; toṣaṇam—pleasing.

O best among the twice-born, it is therefore concluded that the highest perfection one can achieve by discharging the duties prescribed for one's own occupation according to caste divisions and orders of life is to please the Personality of Godhead.

1.2.16

śuśrūṣoḥ śraddadhānasya
vāsudeva-kathā-ruciḥ
syān mahat-sevayā viprāḥ
puṇya-tīrtha-niṣevaṇāt

śuśrūṣoḥ—one who is engaged in hearing; śraddadhānasya—with care and attention; vāsudeva—in respect to Vāsudeva; kathā—the message; ruciḥ—affinity; syāt—is made possible; mahat-sevayā—by service rendered to pure devotees; viprāḥ—O twice-born; puṇya-tīrtha—those who are cleansed of all vice; niṣevaṇāt—by service.

O twice-born sages, by serving those devotees who are completely freed from all vice, great service is done. By such service, one gains affinity for hearing the messages of Vāsudeva.

1.2.17

śṛṇvatāṁ sva-kathāḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
puṇya-śravaṇa kīrtanaḥ
hṛdy antaḥ stho hy abhadrāṇi
vidhunoti suhṛt satām

śṛṇvatām—those who have developed the urge to hear the message of; sva-kathāḥ—His own words; kṛṣṇaḥ—the Personality of Godhead; puṇya—virtues; śravaṇa—hearing; kīrtanaḥ—chanting; hṛdi antaḥ sthaḥ—within one's heart; hi—certainly; abhadrāṇi—desire to enjoy matter; vidhunoti—cleanses; suhṛt—benefactor; satām—of the truthful.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, who is the Paramātmā [Supersoul] in everyone's heart and the benefactor of the truthful devotee, cleanses desire for material enjoyment from the heart of the devotee who has developed the urge to hear His messages, which are in themselves virtuous when properly heard and chanted.

1.2.18

naṣṭa-prāyeṣv abhadreṣu
nityaṁ bhāgavata-sevayā
bhagavaty uttama-śloke
bhaktir bhavati naiṣṭhikī

naṣṭa—destroyed; prāyeṣu—almost to nil; abhadreṣu—all that is inauspicious; nityam—regularly; bhāgavata—Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, or the pure devotee; sevayā—by serving; bhagavati—unto the Personality of Godhead; uttama—transcendental; śloke—prayers; bhaktiḥ—loving service; bhavati—comes into being; naiṣṭhikī—irrevocable.

By regular attendance in classes on the Bhāgavatam and by rendering of service to the pure devotee, all that is troublesome to the heart is almost completely destroyed, and loving service unto the Personality of Godhead, who is praised with transcendental songs, is established as an irrevocable fact.

1.2.19

tadā rajas-tamo-bhāvāḥ
kāma-lobhādayaś ca ye
ceta etair anāviddhaṁ
sthitaṁ sattve prasīdati

tadā—at that time; rajaḥ—in the mode of passion; tamaḥ—the mode of ignorance; bhāvāḥ—the situation; kāma—lust and desire; lobha—hankering; ādayaḥ—others; ca—and; ye—whatever they are; cetaḥ—the mind; etaiḥ—by these; anāviddham—without being affected; sthitam—being fixed; sattve—in the mode of goodness; prasīdati—thus becomes fully satisfied.

As soon as irrevocable loving service is established in the heart, the effects of nature's modes of passion and ignorance, such as lust, desire and hankering, disappear from the heart. Then the devotee is established in goodness, and he becomes completely happy.

1.2.20

evaṁ prasanna-manaso
bhagavad-bhakti-yogataḥ
bhagavat-tattva-vijñānaṁ
mukta-saṅgasya jāyate

evam—thus; prasanna—enlivened; manasaḥ—of the mind; bhagavat-bhakti—the devotional service of the Lord; yogataḥ—by contact of; bhagavat—regarding the Personality of Godhead; tattva—knowledge; vijñānam—scientific; mukta—liberated; saṅgasya—of the association; jāyate—becomes effective.

Thus established in the mode of unalloyed goodness, the man whose mind has been enlivened by contact with devotional service to the Lord gains positive scientific knowledge of the Personality of Godhead in the stage of liberation from all material association.

1.2.21

bhidyate hṛdaya-granthiś
chidyante sarva-saṁśayāḥ
kṣīyante cāsya karmāṇi
dṛṣṭa evātmanīśvare

bhidyate—pierced; hṛdaya—heart; granthiḥ—knots; chidyante—cut to pieces; sarva—all; saṁśayāḥ—misgivings; kṣīyante—terminated; ca—and; asya—his; karmāṇi—chain of fruitive actions; dṛṣṭe—having seen; eva—certainly; ātmani—unto the self; īśvare—dominating.

Thus the knot in the heart is pierced, and all misgivings are cut to pieces. The chain of fruitive actions is terminated when one sees the self as master.

1.2.28-29

vāsudeva-parā vedā
vāsudeva-parā makhāḥ
vāsudeva-parā yogā
vāsudeva-parāḥ kriyāḥ
vāsudeva-paraṁ jñānaṁ
vāsudeva-paraṁ tapaḥ
vāsudeva-paro dharmo
vāsudeva-parā gatiḥ

vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; parāḥ—the ultimate goal; vedāḥ—revealed scriptures; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; parāḥ—for worshiping; makhāḥ—sacrifices; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; parāḥ—the means of attaining; yogāḥ—mystic paraphernalia; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; parāḥ—under His control; kriyāḥ—fruitive activities; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; param—the supreme; jñānam—knowledge; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; param—best; tapaḥ—austerity; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; paraḥ—superior quality; dharmaḥ—religion; vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; parāḥ—ultimate; gatiḥ—goal of life.

In the revealed scriptures, the ultimate object of knowledge is Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. The purpose of performing sacrifice is to please Him. Yoga is for realizing Him. All fruitive activities are ultimately rewarded by Him only. He is supreme knowledge, and all severe austerities are performed to know Him. Religion [dharma] is rendering loving service unto Him. He is the supreme goal of life.

1.3.28

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ
kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam
indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokaṁ
mṛḍayanti yuge yuge

ete—all these; ca—and; aṁśa—plenary portions; kalāḥ—portions of the plenary portions; puṁsaḥ—of the Supreme; kṛṣṇaḥ—Lord Kṛṣṇa; tu—but; bhagavān—the Personality of Godhead; svayam—in person; indra-ari—the enemies of Indra; vyākulam—disturbed; lokam—all the planets; mṛḍayanti—gives protection; yuge yuge—in different ages.

All of the above-mentioned incarnations are either plenary portions or portions of the plenary portions of the Lord, but Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead. All of them appear on planets whenever there is a disturbance created by the atheists. The Lord incarnates to protect the theists.

1.3.40

idaṁ bhāgavataṁ nāma
purāṇaṁ brahma-sammitam
uttama-śloka-caritaṁ
cakāra bhagavān ṛṣiḥ
niḥśreyasāya lokasya
dhanyaṁ svasty-ayanaṁ mahat

idam—this; bhāgavatam—book containing the narration of the Personality of Godhead and His pure devotees; nāma—of the name; purāṇam—supplementary to the Vedas; brahma-sammitam—incarnation of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa; uttama-śloka—of the Personality of Godhead; caritam—activities; cakāra—compiled; bhagavān—incarnation of the Personality of Godhead; ṛṣiḥ—Śrī Vyāsadeva; niḥśreyasāya—for the ultimate good; lokasya—of all people; dhanyam—fully successful; svasti-ayanam—all-blissful; mahat—all-perfect.

This Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is the literary incarnation of God, and it is compiled by Śrīla Vyāsadeva, the incarnation of God. It is meant for the ultimate good of all people, and it is all-successful, all-blissful and all-perfect.

1.3.43

kṛṣṇe sva-dhāmopagate
dharma-jñānādibhiḥ saha
kalau naṣṭa-dṛśām eṣa
purāṇārko 'dhunoditaḥ

kṛṣṇe—in Kṛṣṇa's; sva-dhāma—own abode; upagate—having returned; dharma—religion; jñāna—knowledge; ādibhiḥ—combined together; saha—along with; kalau—in the Kali-yuga; naṣṭa-dṛśām—of persons who have lost their sight; eṣaḥ—all these; purāṇa-arkaḥ—the Purāṇa which is brilliant like the sun; adhunā—just now; uditaḥ—has arisen.

This Bhāgavata Purāṇa is as brilliant as the sun, and it has arisen just after the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa to His own abode, accompanied by religion, knowledge, etc. Persons who have lost their vision due to the dense darkness of ignorance in the age of Kali shall get light from this Purāṇa.

1.5.10

na yad vacaś citra-padaṁ harer yaśo
jagat-pavitraṁ pragṛṇīta karhicit
tad vāyasaṁ tīrtham uśanti mānasā
na yatra haṁsā niramanty uśik-kṣayāḥ

na—not; yat—that; vacaḥ—vocabulary; citra-padam—decorative; hareḥ—of the Lord; yaśaḥ—glories; jagat—universe; pavitram—sanctified; pragṛṇīta—described; karhicit—hardly; tat—that; vāyasam—crows; tīrtham—place of pilgrimage; uśanti—think; mānasāḥ—saintly persons; na—not; yatra—where; haṁsāḥ—all-perfect beings; niramanti—take pleasure; uśik-kṣayāḥ—those who reside in the transcendental abode.

Those words which do not describe the glories of the Lord, who alone can sanctify the atmosphere of the whole universe, are considered by saintly persons to be like unto a place of pilgrimage for crows. Since the all-perfect persons are inhabitants of the transcendental abode, they do not derive any pleasure there.

1.5.11

tad-vāg-visargo janatāgha-viplavo
yasmin prati-ślokam abaddhavaty api
nāmāny anantasya yaśo 'ṅkitāni yat
śṛṇvanti gāyanti gṛṇanti sādhavaḥ

tat—that; vāk—vocabulary; visargaḥ—creation; janatā—the people in general; agha—sins; viplavaḥ—revolutionary; yasmin—in which; prati-ślokam—each and every stanza; abaddhavati—irregularly composed; api—in spite of; nāmāni—transcendental names, etc.; anantasya—of the unlimited Lord; yaśaḥ—glories; aṅkitāni—depicted; yat—what; śṛṇvanti—do hear; gāyanti—do sing; gṛṇanti—do accept; sādhavaḥ—the purified men who are honest.

On the other hand, that literature which is full of descriptions of the transcendental glories of the name, fame, forms, pastimes, etc., of the unlimited Supreme Lord is a different creation, full of transcendental words directed toward bringing about a revolution in the impious lives of this world's misdirected civilization. Such transcendental literatures, even though imperfectly composed, are heard, sung and accepted by purified men who are thoroughly honest.

1.5.17

tyaktvā sva-dharmaṁ caraṇāmbujaṁ harer
bhajann apakvo 'tha patet tato yadi
yatra kva vābhadram abhūd amuṣya kiṁ
ko vārtha āpto 'bhajatāṁ sva-dharmataḥ

tyaktvā—having forsaken; sva-dharmam—one's own occupational engagement; caraṇa-ambujam—the lotus feet; hareḥ—of Hari (the Lord); bhajan—in the course of devotional service; apakvaḥ—immature; atha—for the matter of; patet—falls down; tataḥ—from that place; yadi—if; yatra—whereupon; kva—what sort of; vā—or (used sarcastically); abhadram—unfavorable; abhūt—shall happen; amuṣya—of him; kim—nothing; kaḥ vā arthaḥ—what interest; āptaḥ—obtained; abhajatām—of the nondevotee; sva-dharmataḥ—being engaged in occupational service.

One who has forsaken his material occupations to engage in the devotional service of the Lord may sometimes fall down while in an immature stage, yet there is no danger of his being unsuccessful. On the other hand, a nondevotee, though fully engaged in occupational duties, does not gain anything.

1.5.18

tasyaiva hetoḥ prayateta kovido
na labhyate yad bhramatām upary adhaḥ
tal labhyate duḥkhavad anyataḥ sukhaṁ
kālena sarvatra gabhīra-raṁhasā

tasya—for that purpose; eva—only; hetoḥ—reason; prayateta—should endeavor; kovidaḥ—one who is philosophically inclined; na labhyate—is not obtained; yat—what; bhramatām—wandering; upari adhaḥ—from top to bottom; tat—that; labhyate—can be obtained; duḥkhavat—like the miseries; anyataḥ—as a result of previous work; sukham—sense enjoyment; kālena—in course of time; sarvatra—everywhere; gabhīra—subtle; raṁhasā—progress.

Persons who are actually intelligent and philosophically inclined should endeavor only for that purposeful end which is not obtainable even by wandering from the topmost planet [Brahmaloka] down to the lowest planet [Pātāla]. As far as happiness derived from sense enjoyment is concerned, it can be obtained automatically in course of time, just as in course of time we obtain miseries even though we do not desire them.

1.7.4

bhakti-yogena manasi
samyak praṇihite 'male
apaśyat puruṣaṁ pūrṇaṁ
māyāṁ ca tad-apāśrayam

bhakti—devotional service; yogena—by the process of linking up; manasi—upon the mind; samyak—perfectly; praṇihite—engaged in and fixed upon; amale—without any matter; apaśyat—saw; puruṣam—the Personality of Godhead; pūrṇam—absolute; māyām—energy; ca—also; tat—His; apāśrayam—under full control.

Thus he fixed his mind, perfectly engaging it by linking it in devotional service [bhakti-yoga] without any tinge of materialism, and thus he saw the Absolute Personality of Godhead along with His external energy, which was under full control.

1.7.6

anarthopaśamaṁ sākṣād
bhakti-yogam adhokṣaje
lokasyājānato vidvāṁś
cakre sātvata-saṁhitām

anartha—things which are superfluous; upaśamam—mitigation; sākṣāt—directly; bhakti-yogam—the linking process of devotional service; adhokṣaje—unto the Transcendence; lokasya—of the general mass of men; ajānataḥ—those who are unaware of; vidvān—the supremely learned; cakre—compiled; sātvata—in relation with the Supreme Truth; saṁhitām—Vedic literature.

The material miseries of the living entity, which are superfluous to him, can be directly mitigated by the linking process of devotional service. But the mass of people do not know this, and therefore the learned Vyāsadeva compiled this Vedic literature, which is in relation to the Supreme Truth.

1.7.10

ātmārāmāś ca munayo
nirgranthā apy urukrame
kurvanty ahaitukīṁ bhaktim
ittham-bhūta-guṇo hariḥ

sūtaḥ uvāca—Sūta Gosvāmī said; ātmārāmāḥ—those who take pleasure in ātmā (generally, spirit self); ca—also; munayaḥ—sages; nirgranthāḥ—freed from all bondage; api—in spite of; urukrame—unto the great adventurer; kurvanti—do; ahaitukīm—unalloyed; bhaktim—devotional service; ittham-bhūta—such wonderful; guṇaḥ—qualities; hariḥ—of the Lord.

All different varieties of ātmārāmas [those who take pleasure in ātmā, or spirit self], especially those established on the path of self-realization, though freed from all kinds of material bondage, desire to render unalloyed devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead. This means that the Lord possesses transcendental qualities and therefore can attract everyone, including liberated souls.

1.8.21

kṛṣṇāya vāsudevāya
devakī-nandanāya ca
nanda-gopa-kumārāya
govindāya namo namaḥ

kṛṣṇāya—the Supreme Lord; vāsudevāya—unto the son of Vasudeva; devakī-nandanāya—unto the son of Devakī; ca—and; nanda-gopa—Nanda and the cowherd men; kumārāya—unto their son; govindāya—unto the Personality of Godhead, who enlivens the cows and the senses; namaḥ—respectful obeisances; namaḥ—obeisances.

Let me therefore offer my respectful obeisances unto the Lord, who has become the son of Vasudeva, the pleasure of Devakī, the boy of Nanda and the other cowherd men of Vṛndāvana, and the enlivener of the cows and the senses.

1.8.22

namaḥ paṅkaja-nābhāya
namaḥ paṅkaja-māline
namaḥ paṅkaja-netrāya
namas te paṅkajāṅghraye

namaḥ—all respectful obeisances; paṅkaja-nābhāya—unto the Lord who has a specific depression resembling a lotus flower in the center of His abdomen; namaḥ—obeisances; paṅkaja-māline—one who is always decorated with a garland of lotus flowers; namaḥ—obeisances; paṅkaja-netrāya—one whose glance is as cooling as a lotus flower; namaḥ te—respectful obeisances unto You; paṅkaja-aṅghraye—unto You, the soles of whose feet are engraved with lotus flowers (and who are therefore said to possess lotus feet).

My respectful obeisances are unto You, O Lord, whose abdomen is marked with a depression like a lotus flower, who are always decorated with garlands of lotus flowers, whose glance is as cool as the lotus and whose feet are engraved with lotuses.

1.8.25

vipadaḥ santu tāḥ śaśvat
tatra tatra jagad-guro
bhavato darśanaṁ yat syād
apunar bhava-darśanam

vipadaḥ—calamities; santu—let there be; tāḥ—all; śaśvat—again and again; tatra—there; tatra—and there; jagat-guro—O Lord of the universe; bhavataḥ—Your; darśanam—meeting; yat—that which; syāt—is; apunaḥ—not again; bhava-darśanam—seeing repetition of birth and death.

I wish that all those calamities would happen again and again so that we could see You again and again, for seeing You means that we will no longer see repeated births and deaths.

1.8.26

janmaiśvarya-śruta-śrībhir
edhamāna-madah pumān
naivārhaty abhidhātuṁ vai
tvām akiñcana-gocaram

janma—birth; aiśvarya—opulence; śruta—education; śrībhiḥ—by the possession of beauty; edhamāna—progressively increasing; madaḥ—intoxication; pumān—the human being; na—never; eva-ever; arhati—deserves; abhidhātum—to address in feeling; vai—certainly; tvām—You; akiñcana-gocaram—one who is approached easily by the materially exhausted man.

My Lord, Your Lordship can easily be approached, but only by those who are materially exhausted. One who is on the path of [material] progress, trying to improve himself with respectable parentage, great opulence, high education and bodily beauty, cannot approach You with sincere feeling.

1.8.42

tvayi me 'nanya-viṣayā
matir madhu-pate 'sakṛt
ratim udvahatād addhā
gaṅgevaugham udanvati

tvayi—unto You; me—my; ananya-viṣayā—unalloyed; matiḥ—attention; madhu-pate—O Lord of Madhu; asakṛt—continuously; ratim—attraction; udvahatāt—may overflow; addhā—directly; gaṅgā—the Ganges; iva—like; ogham—flows; udanvati—down to the sea.

O Lord of Madhu, as the Ganges forever flows to the sea without hindrance, let my attraction be constantly drawn unto You without being diverted to anyone else.

1.13.10

bhavad-vidhā bhāgavatās
tīrtha-bhūtāḥ svayaṁ vibho
tīrthī-kurvanti tīrthāni
svāntaḥ-sthena gadābhṛtā

bhavat—your good self; vidhāḥ—like; bhāgavatāḥ—devotees; tīrtha—the holy places of pilgrimage; bhūtāḥ—converted into; svayam—personally; vibho—O powerful one; tīrthī-kurvanti—make into a holy place of pilgrimage; tīrthāni—the holy places; sva-antaḥ-sthena—having been situated in the heart; gadā-bhṛtā—the Personality of Godhead.

My Lord, devotees like your good self are verily holy places personified. Because you carry the Personality of Godhead within your heart, you turn all places into places of pilgrimage.

1.13.47

ahastāni sahastānām
apadāni catuṣ-padām
phalgūni tatra mahatāṁ
jīvo jīvasya jīvanam

ahastāni—those who are devoid of hands; sa-hastānām—of those who are endowed with hands; apadāni—those who are devoid of legs; catuḥ-padām—of those who have four legs; phalgūni—those who are weak; tatra—there; mahatām—of the powerful; jīvaḥ—the living being; jīvasya—of the living being; jīvanam—subsistence.

Those who are devoid of hands are prey for those who have hands; those devoid of legs are prey for the four-legged. The weak are the subsistence of the strong, and the general rule holds that one living being is food for another.

2.1.2

śrotavyādīni rājendra
nṛṇāṁ santi sahasraśaḥ
apaśyatām ātma-tattvaṁ
gṛheṣu gṛha-medhinām

śrotavya-ādīni—subject matters for hearing; rājendra—O Emperor; nṛṇām—of human society; santi—there are; sahasraśaḥ—hundreds and thousands; apaśyatām—of the blind; ātma-tattvam—knowledge of self, the ultimate truth; gṛheṣu—at home; gṛha-medhinām—of persons too materially engrossed.

Those persons who are materially engrossed, being blind to the knowledge of ultimate truth, have many subject matters for hearing in human society, O Emperor.

2.1.3

nidrayā hriyate naktaṁ
vyavāyena ca vā vayaḥ
divā cārthehayā rājan
kuṭumba-bharaṇena vā

nidrayā—by sleeping; hriyate—wastes; naktam—night; vyavāyena—sex indulgence; ca—also; vā—either; vayaḥ—duration of life; divā—days; ca—and; artha—economic; īhayā—development; rājan—O King; kuṭumba—family members; bharaṇena—maintaining; vā—either.

The lifetime of such an envious householder is passed at night either in sleeping or in sex indulgence, and in the daytime either in making money or maintaining family members.

2.1.4

dehāpatya-kalatrādiṣv
ātma-sainyeṣv asatsv api
teṣāṁ pramatto nidhanaṁ
paśyann api na paśyati

deha—body; apatya—children; kalatra—wife; ādiṣu—and in everything in relation to them; ātma—own; sainyeṣu—fighting soldiers; asatsu—fallible; api—in spite of; teṣām—of all of them; pramattaḥ—too attached; nidhanam—destruction; paśyan—having been experienced; api—although; na—does not; paśyati—see it.

Persons devoid of ātma-tattva do not inquire into the problems of life, being too attached to the fallible soldiers like the body, children and wife. Although sufficiently experienced, they still do not see their inevitable destruction.

2.1.11

etan nirvidyamānānām
icchatām akuto-bhayam
yogināṁ nṛpa nirṇītaṁ
harer-nāmānukīrtanam

etat—it is; nirvidyamānānām—of those who are completely free from all material desires; icchatām—of those who are desirous of all sorts of material enjoyment; akutaḥ-bhayam—free from all doubts and fear; yoginām—of all who are self-satisfied; nṛpa—O King; nirṇītam—decided truth; hareḥ—of the Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa; nāma—holy name; anu—after someone, always; kīrtanam—chanting.

O King, constant chanting of the holy name of the Lord after the ways of the great authorities is the doubtless and fearless way of success for all, including those who are free from all material desires, those who are desirous of all material enjoyment, and also those who are self-satisfied by dint of transcendental knowledge.

2.3.10

akāmaḥ sarva-kāmo vā
mokṣa-kāma udāra-dhīḥ
tīvreṇa bhakti-yogena
yajeta puruṣaṁ param

akāmaḥ—one who has transcended all material desires; sarva-kāmaḥ—one who has the sum total of material desires; vā—either; mokṣa-kāmaḥ—one who desires liberation; udāra-dhīḥ—with broader intelligence; tīvreṇa—with great force; bhakti-yogena—by devotional service to the Lord; yajeta—should worship; puruṣam—the Lord; param—the supreme whole.

A person who has broader intelligence, whether he be full of all material desire, without any material desire, or desiring liberation, must by all means worship the supreme whole, the Personality of Godhead.

2.3.17

āyur harati vai puṁsām
udyann astaṁ ca yann asau
tasyarte yat-kṣaṇo nīta
uttama-śloka-vārtayā

āyuḥ—duration of life; harati—decreases; vai—certainly; puṁsām—of the people; udyan—rising; astam—setting; ca—also; yan—moving; asau—the sun; tasya—of one who glorifies the Lord; ṛte—except; yat—by whom; kṣaṇaḥ—time; nītaḥ—utilized; uttama-śloka—the all-good Personality of Godhead; vārtayā—in the topics of.

Both by rising and by setting, the sun decreases the duration of life of everyone, except one who utilizes the time by discussing topics of the all-good Personality of Godhead.

2.3.19

śva-viḍ-varāhoṣṭra-kharaiḥ
saṁstutaḥ puruṣaḥ paśuḥ
na yat-karṇa-pathopeto
jātu nāma gadāgrajaḥ

śva—a dog; viṭ-varāha—the village hog who eats stool; uṣṭra—the camel; kharaiḥ—and by the asses; saṁstutaḥ—perfectly praised; puruṣaḥ—a person; paśuḥ—animal; na—never; yat—of him; karṇa—ear; patha—path; upetaḥ—reached; jātu—at any time; nāma—the holy name; gadāgrajaḥ—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the deliver from all evils.

Men who are like dogs, hogs, camels and asses praise those men who never listen to the transcendental pastimes of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the deliverer from evils.

2.4.18

kirāta-hūṇāndhra-pulinda-pulkaśā
ābhīra-śumbhā yavanāḥ khasādayaḥ
ye 'nye ca pāpā yad-apāśrayāśrayāḥ
śudhyanti tasmai prabhaviṣṇave namaḥ

kirāta—a province of old Bhārata; hūṇa—part of Germany and Russia; āndhra—a province of southern India; pulinda—the Greeks; pulkaśāḥ—another province; ābhīra—part of old Sind; śumbhāḥ—another province; yavanāḥ—the Turks; khasa-ādayaḥ—the Mongolian province; ye—even those; anye—others; ca—also; pāpāḥ—addicted to sinful acts; yat—whose; apāśraya-āśrayāḥ—having taken shelter of the devotees of the Lord; śudhyanti—at once purified; tasmai—unto Him; prabhaviṣṇave—unto the powerful Viṣṇu; namaḥ—my respectful obeisances.

Kirāta, Hūṇa, Āndhra, Pulinda, Pulkaśa, Ābhīra, Śumbha, Yavana, members of the Khasa races and even others addicted to sinful acts can be purified by taking shelter of the devotees of the Lord, due to His being the supreme power. I beg to offer my respectful obeisances unto Him.

2.10.1

atra sargo visargaś ca
sthānaṁ poṣaṇam ūtayaḥ
manvantareśānukathā
nirodho muktir āśrayaḥ

śrī-śukaḥ uvāca—Śrī Śukadeva Gosvāmī said; atra—in this Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam; sargaḥ—statement of the creation of the universe; visargaḥ—statement of subcreation; ca—also; sthānam—the planetary systems; poṣaṇam—protection; ūtayaḥ—the creative impetus; manvantara—changes of Manus; īśa-anukathāḥ—the science of God; nirodhaḥ—going back home, back to Godhead; muktiḥ—liberation; āśrayaḥ—the summum bonum.

Śrī Śukadeva Gosvāmī said: In the Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam there are ten divisions of statements regarding the following: the creation of the universe, subcreation, planetary systems, protection by the Lord, the creative impetus, the change of Manus, the science of God, returning home, back to Godhead, liberation, and the summum bonum.

2.10.6

nirodho 'syānuśayanam
ātmanaḥ saha śaktibhiḥ
muktir hitvānyathā rūpaṁ
sva-rūpeṇa vyavasthitiḥ

nirodhaḥ—the winding up of the cosmic manifestation; asya—of His; anuśayanam—the lying down of the puruṣa incarnation Mahā-Viṣṇu in mystic slumber; ātmanaḥ—of the living entities; saha—along with; śaktibhiḥ—with the energies; muktiḥ—liberation; hitvā—giving up; anyathā—otherwise; rūpam—form; sva-rūpeṇa—in constitutional form; vyavasthitiḥ—permanent situation.

The merging of the living entity, along with his conditional living tendency, with the mystic lying down of the Mahā-Viṣṇu is called the winding up of the cosmic manifestation. Liberation is the permanent situation of the form of the living entity after he gives up the changeable gross and subtle material bodies.

3.15.43

tasyāravinda-nayanasya padāravinda-
kiñjalka-miśra-tulasī-makaranda-vāyuḥ
antar-gataḥ sva-vivareṇa cakāra teṣāṁ
saṅkṣobham akṣara-juṣām api citta-tanvoḥ

tasya—of Him; aravinda-nayanasya—of the lotus-eyed Lord; pada-aravinda—of the lotus feet; kiñjalka—with the toes; miśra—mixed; tulasī—the tulasī leaves; makaranda—fragrance; vāyuḥ—breeze; antaḥ-gataḥ—entered within; sva-vivareṇa—through their nostrils; cakāra—made; teṣām—of the Kumāras; saṅkṣobham—agitation for change; akṣara-juṣām—attached to impersonal Brahman realization; api—even though; citta-tanvoḥ—in both mind and body.

When the breeze carrying the aroma of tulasī leaves from the toes of the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead entered the nostrils of those sages, they experienced a change both in body and in mind, even though they were attached to the impersonal Brahman understanding.

3.25.21

titikṣavaḥ kāruṇikāḥ
suhṛdaḥ sarva-dehinām
ajāta-śatravaḥ śāntāḥ
sādhavaḥ sādhu-bhūṣaṇāḥ

titikṣavaḥ—tolerant; kāruṇikāḥ—merciful; suhṛdaḥ—friendly; sarva-dehinām—to all living entities; ajāta-śatravaḥ—inimical to none; śāntāḥ—peaceful; sādhavaḥ—abiding by scriptures; sādhu-bhūṣaṇāḥ—adorned with sublime characteristics.

The symptoms of a sādhu are that he is tolerant, merciful and friendly to all living entities. He has no enemies, he is peaceful, he abides by the scriptures, and all his characteristics are sublime.

3.25.22

mayy ananyena bhāvena
bhaktiṁ kurvanti ye dṛḍhām
mat-kṛte tyakta-karmāṇas
tyakta-svajana-bāndhavāḥ

mayi—unto Me; ananyena bhāvena—with undeviated mind; bhaktim—devotional service; kurvanti—perform; ye—those who; dṛḍhām—staunch; mat-kṛte—for My sake; tyakta—renounced; karmāṇaḥ—activities; tyakta—renounced; sva-jana—family relationships; bāndhavāḥ—friendly acquaintances.

Such a sādhu engages in staunch devotional service to the Lord without deviation. For the sake of the Lord he renounces all other connections, such as family relationships and friendly acquaintances within the world.

3.25.23

mad-āśrayāḥ kathā mṛṣṭāḥ
śṛṇvanti kathayanti ca
tapanti vividhās tāpā
naitān mad-gata-cetasaḥ

mat-āśrayāḥ—about Me; kathāḥ—stories; mṛṣṭāḥ—delightful; śṛṇvanti—they hear; kathayanti—they chant; ca—and; tapanti—inflict suffering; vividhāḥ—various; tāpāḥ—the material miseries; na—do not; etān—unto them; mat-gata—fixed on Me; cetasaḥ—their thoughts.

Engaged constantly in chanting and hearing about Me, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the sādhus do not suffer from material miseries because they are always filled with thoughts of My pastimes and activities.

3.25.25

satāṁ prasaṅgān mama vīrya-saṁvido
bhavanti hṛt-karṇa-rasāyanāḥ kathāḥ
taj-joṣaṇād āśv apavarga-vartmani
śraddhā ratir bhaktir anukramiṣyati

satām—of pure devotees; prasaṅgāt—through the association; mama—My; vīrya—wonderful activities; saṁvidaḥ—by discussion of; bhavanti—become; hṛt—to the heart; karṇa—to the ear; rasa-ayanāḥ—pleasing; kathāḥ—the stories; tat—of that; joṣaṇāt—by cultivation; āśu—quickly; apavarga—of liberation; vartmani—on the path; śraddhā—firm faith; ratiḥ—attraction; bhaktiḥ—devotion; anukramiṣyati—will follow in order.

In the association of pure devotees, discussion of the pastimes and activities of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is very pleasing and satisfying to the ear and the heart. By cultivating such knowledge one gradually becomes advanced on the path of liberation, and thereafter he is freed, and his attraction becomes fixed. Then real devotion and devotional service begin.

3.29.13

sālokya-sārṣṭi-sāmīpya-
sārūpyaikatvam apy uta
dīyamānaṁ na gṛhṇanti
vinā mat-sevanaṁ janāḥ

sālokya—living on the same planet; sārṣṭi—having the same opulence; sāmīpya—to be a personal associate; sārūpya—having the same bodily features; ekatvam—oneness; api—also; uta—even; dīyamānam—being offered; na—not; gṛhṇanti—do accept; vinā—without; mat—My; sevanam—devotional service; janāḥ—pure devotees.

A pure devotee does not accept any kind of liberation—sālokya, sārṣṭi, sāmīpya, sārūpya or ekatva—even though they are offered by the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

3.31.1

karmaṇā-daiva-netreṇa
jantur dehopapattaye
striyāḥ praviṣṭa udaraṁ
puṁso retaḥ-kaṇāśrayaḥ

śrī-bhagavān uvāca—the Supreme Personality of Godhead said; karmaṇā—by the result of work; daiva-netreṇa—under the supervision of the Lord; jantuḥ—the living entity; deha—a body; upapattaye—for obtaining; striyāḥ—of a woman; praviṣṭaḥ—enters; udaram—the womb; puṁsaḥ—of a man; retaḥ—of semen; kaṇa—a particle; āśrayaḥ—dwelling in.

The Personality of Godhead said: Under the supervision of the Supreme Lord and according to the result of his work, the living entity, the soul, is made to enter into the womb of a woman through the particle of male semen to assume a particular type of body.

3.33.6

yan-nāmadheya-śravaṇānukīrtanād
yat-prahvaṇād yat-smaraṇād api kvacit
śvādo 'pi sadyaḥ savanāya kalpate
kutaḥ punas te bhagavan nu darśanāt

yat—of whom (the Supreme Personality of Godhead); nāmadheya—the name; śravaṇa—hearing; anukīrtanāt—by chanting; yat—to whom; prahvaṇāt—by offering obeisances; yat—whom; smaraṇāt—by remembering; api—even; kvacit—at any time; śva-adaḥ—a dog-eater; api—even; sadyaḥ—immediately; savanāya—for performing Vedic sacrifices; kalpate—becomes eligible; kutaḥ—what to speak of; punaḥ—again; te—You; bhagavan—O Supreme Personality of Godhead; nu—then; darśanāt—by seeing face to face.

To say nothing of the spiritual advancement of persons who see the Supreme Person face to face, even a person born in a family of dog-eaters immediately becomes eligible to perform Vedic sacrifices if he once utters the holy name of the Supreme Personality of Godhead or chants about Him, hears about His pastimes, offers Him obeisances or even remembers Him.

3.33.7

aho bata śva-paco 'to garīyān
yaj-jihvāgre vartate nāma tubhyam
tepus tapas te juhuvuḥ sasnur āryā
brahmānūcur nāma gṛṇanti ye te

aho bata—oh, how glorious; śva-pacaḥ—a dog-eater; ataḥ—hence; garīyān—worshipable; yat—of whom; jihvā-agre—on the tip of the tongue; vartate—is; nāma—the holy name; tubhyam—unto You; tepuḥ tapaḥ—practiced austerities; te—they; juhuvuḥ—executed fire sacrifices; sasnuḥ—took bath in the sacred rivers; āryāḥ—Āryans; brahma anūcuḥ—studied the Vedas; nāma—the holy name; gṛṇanti—accept; ye—they who; te—Your.

Oh, how glorious are they whose tongues are chanting Your holy name! Even if born in the families of dog-eaters, such persons are worshipable. Persons who chant the holy name of Your Lordship must have executed all kinds of austerities and fire sacrifices and achieved all the good manners of the Āryans. To be chanting the holy name of Your Lordship, they must have bathed at holy places of pilgrimage, studied the Vedas and fulfilled everything required.

mad-eka-bandho mat-saṇgin
mad-guro man-mahā-dhana
man-niṣṭaraka mad-bhāgya
mad-ānanda namo `stu te

O Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, O my only friend, O my companion, O my teacher, O my great wealth, O my deliverer, O my good fortune, O my bliss, I offer respectful obeisances unto you.

Selected Verses for Assessment

Canto 1	Canto 2	Canto 3
1.1.1	2.1.2	3.15.43
1.1.2	2.1.3	3.25.21
1.1.10	2.1.4	3.25.22
1.2.4	2.3.10	3.25.25
1.2.6	2.3.17	3.29.13
1.2.7	2.3.19	3.31.1
1.2.8	2.4.18	3.33. 6
1.2.11	2.10.1	3.33. 7
1.2.13		
1.2.17		
1.2.18		
1.2.19		
1.2.20		
1.3.28		
1.3.43		
1.5. 10		
1.5. 11		
1.5. 17		
1.7.10		
1.8.25		
1.8.26		
1.13.10		
Total 22	Total 8	Total 8
		Total 38